CHENNAI - FRIDAY - FEBRUARY 27, 2026

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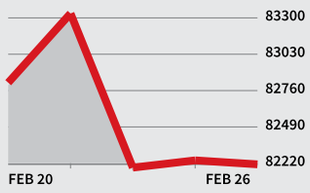

IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	25496.55	+14.05
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	22.58	-0.01
US Dollar (in ₹)	90.90	-0.04
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	157389.00	-982
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	260667.00	-4750

ERODING SHARE. **India's onion exports** face mounting pressure this year as key buyers reduce imports amid rising competition **p10**

GIFT CITY GOES GLOBAL. **Cyprus-based Ellinas Finance,** in a first, will soon list its equity shares on the NSE IX **p8**

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QUICKLY.

ACCURATE ESTIMATE

New GDP series to use 600 price indicators

New Delhi: The Ministry of Statistics will significantly expand the data used to calculate Gross Domestic Product in the upcoming series with base year 2022-23, aiming to improve the accuracy of growth estimates. The revised series, scheduled for release on Friday, will use nearly 600 item-level price indicators under the double deflation method, more than three times the current 180 items used for price adjustment. **p3**

IPO PROCESS

NSE taps investment banks, law firms for advisory roles

Mumbai: The National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) has reached out to investment banks and legal firms to advise for its long-awaited initial public offering, said sources. The exchange has circulated requests for proposals (RFPs) to multiple investment banks and law firms as part of the process to appoint intermediaries for the share sale. **p6**

Compensate content creators: IT Minister to online platforms

GIVES ULTIMATUM. If not done voluntarily, there are legal ways to enforce it: Vaishnaw

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Digital platforms must ensure fair revenue share with news publishers and content creators, Union IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said on Thursday. If this is not done voluntarily, there are clear legal pathways, already shown by other countries, to mandate them, he added.

Speaking at the Digital News Publishers Association (DNPA) Conclave 2026, Vaishnaw said, "Platforms must share revenue in a fair way with the people who are creating the content, whether it is news persons, conventional media, creators sitting in far-flung areas, influencers, the professors and researchers who are disseminating their work using the platforms... This is a major concern that the entire society is raising. Everywhere, the principle now has to be set right."

"I will request all the platforms to rethink your revenue sharing policies. And if this is not done voluntarily, there are so many countries which have shown the path to get it done in a legal way," the Minister said.

ENSURING FAIR PLAY. Minister of Electronics & IT Ashwini Vaishnaw addressing the Digital News Publishers Association Conclave in New Delhi on Thursday

EQUITABLE SHARE

News organisations and industry bodies have been raising the issue of equitable revenue share with tech giants for some time now. Several countries, such as Australia and Canada, have either enacted laws, while others have brought in different frameworks that mandate or encourage revenue-sharing arrangements between tech giants and news publishers.

Pointing out that original content had powered society's growth historically, he cautioned that if intellectual property is not respected and fairly compensated, the growth of society, science, technology, arts and literature will all be stunted.

Simultaneously, Vaishnaw stated that platforms must take responsibility for the content hosted by them and proactively take measures to ensure online safety of children and citizens from harmful or misleading content.

He added that every institution is based on the fundamental tenet of trust, which is under threat particularly from deepfakes, disinformation and synthetically generated content using faces and voices of public figures.

CONTENT RESPONSIBILITY

The Minister said platforms are no longer pure intermediaries but hosts which need to take responsibility.

"Today, platforms have become powerful media outlets. And like media organisations, platforms must take responsibility for the content that is hosted by them. Non-adherence to these principles will definitely make them responsible because the nature of the internet has changed now.

"Also, synthetic content should not be generated without the consent of the person whose face or voice or personality has been used to create the content. Time has come to make that big inflectional change," Vaishnaw stated.

Flyers to get 48-hour free cancellation, change window

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

In a major relief to air travellers, the Director-General of Civil Aviation has mandated a 'look-in option' that allows passengers to cancel or amend flight tickets without additional charges within 48 hours of the initial booking.

The new Civil Aviation Requirement (CAR) comes after the DGCA received a large number of complaints on delayed refunds and restrictive airline policies.

'LOOK-IN' PROVISION

Accordingly, under the new 'look-in' provision, passengers can cancel or change their tickets within 48 hours of booking at no additional charge, except for any prevailing fare difference for the revised flight. This facility is available for domestic flights booked at least seven days in advance and international flights booked 15 days prior to departure through airline websites.

Beyond the initial booking flexibility, the CAR prescribes rigorous timelines for the return of funds.

businessline was the first publication to report about this in November 2025.

Read more p9

SEBI allows equity MF schemes to invest in gold, silver

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Capital markets regulator SEBI has allowed equity-oriented mutual fund schemes to invest the 'residual portion' (beyond the core investment) of their funds in gold and silver, in addition to REITs and InvITs.

In the equity category schemes, mutual funds may invest the 'residual portion' in equity, money market instruments and other liquid instruments, as also gold and silver instruments as permitted by SEBI and in InvITs, subject to the ceilings set out in MF regulations with respect to the respective asset class, said SEBI in a circular issued on Thursday.

At the end of January, equity funds had ₹34.86 lakh crore worth assets under management.

RESIDUAL PORTION

SEBI defines the 'residual portion' as part of a scheme's corpus not invested in its main, core asset classes as provided in the scheme characteristics. For instance, large-cap funds have to mandatorily invest 80 per cent of the corpus in top-100 companies and the remaining 20 per cent, that is, the 'residual portion', can now be invested in precious metals and debt instruments.

DP Singh, Deputy Managing Director and Joint CEO, SBI Mutual Fund, said allowing equity schemes to invest in gold and silver opens up another asset class for fund managers.

It is good for investors as they can get exposure to bullion even while capturing the equity growth in their core portfolio.

LARGE ASSETS

At the end of January, equity funds had ₹34.86 lakh crore assets under management

Also read p6

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QUICKLY.

JFS infuses ₹2,000 crore capital in NBFC arm

Mumbai: Jio Financial Services (JFS) on Thursday said it has invested nearly ₹2,000 crore in its wholly-owned subsidiary, Jio Credit Ltd (JCL), by subscribing to 3,35,71,923 equity shares at a premium of ₹585.70 per share. The transaction did not require governmental or regulatory approval. JCL's total disbursements stood at ₹8,615 crore in Q3FY26, up two times y-o-y and 30 per cent sequentially. Its Pre-Provisioning Operating Profit increased to ₹99 crore, up 24 per cent on a quarterly basis. OUR BUREAU

Vedanta to raise ₹3,000 cr via debentures

New Delhi: The committee of Directors of Vedanta Ltd has approved raising up to ₹3,000 crore through debentures on a private placement basis. The fundraise is aimed at further strengthening the company's capital structure while optimising borrowing costs. The company has informed the bourses that it will issue up to 3 lakh unsecured, rated, listed and redeemable non-convertible debentures with a face value of ₹1,00,000 each, aggregating to ₹3,000 crore. The NCDs will be listed on the BSE. Previous issues of debt instruments and bonds have attracted significant investor interest. PTI

CAQM proposes mandating only EV taxis from April 2027

TIMELINE CONCERNS. Experts warn of impact to ride-hailing companies & Bharat Taxi

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

The Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) has convened a meeting of its expert committee on Friday with select stakeholders to discuss measures to curb vehicular emissions in the Delhi-National Capital Region (NCR) and adjoining areas.

The move could have significant implications for taxi and ride-hailing services in Delhi as the committee is understood to be considering a proposal to allow only electric vehicles (EVs) to be registered as taxis in Delhi-NCR from April 1, 2027.

In what industry observers describe as an unusual step, the CAQM has not invited major cab aggregators, such as Ola Cabs and Uber, fleet operators or the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM) to the meeting.

Instead, invitations have reportedly been sent to select automobile manufacturers, including Maruti Suzuki India, Tata Motors, Hyundai Motor India, Mahindra & Mahindra, Toyota Kirloskar Motor, Skoda Auto Volkswagen India, Honda Cars India and Mercedes-Benz India.

FAR-REACHING GOAL. All private vehicles would be required to adhere to ZTE norms from April 2030

The expert committee is chaired by Ashok Jhunjhunwala of IIT-Madras. Sources familiar with the discussions said the panel is proposing that only zero tailpipe emission (ZTE) four-wheeler taxis, effectively zero-emission vehicles (ZEVs), be registered in Delhi-NCR from April 1, 2027.

BEVS, FCEVS

The primary vehicle categories under consideration include battery electric vehicles (BEVs) and hydrogen fuel cell electric vehicles (FCEVs).

The proposal also extends to two-wheeler taxis, food delivery vehicles and all three-wheelers, both passenger and goods carriers, which would be required to be ZTE vehicles from the same date.

From April 2028, the committee is said to be recommending similar restrictions for larger segments, such as buses and trucks.

The most far-reaching recommendation, according to sources, is for April 2030, when all private vehicles, both two- and four-wheelers, would be required to be ZTE vehicles.

The CAQM is mandated to review and coordinate policies related to clean mobility across Delhi-NCR, including Bharat Stage (BS) emission norms, electric mobility initiatives and fuel efficiency standards.

However, the proposed timeline has raised questions within the industry. "The Committee is proposing that all taxis be EVs from April 2027, and from April 2030 all private vehicles too should be ZTEs. But in the interim, the Home Minister has launched Bharat Taxi, under which nearly three lakh taxis have reportedly been registered, about 90 per cent of them running on CNG. Lakhs of drivers are enrolled on the platform. If EVs are made mandatory, where will these vehicles and drivers go?" asked a sector expert.

The expert added that a calibrated approach with a mix of technologies may be more practical, particularly given cost concerns. Lower- and middle-income commuters, who constitute the bulk of users of taxis and three-wheelers, could face higher fares if operators are compelled to shift entirely to EVs, given the upfront cost of electric vehicles.

The recommendations are expected to trigger wider consultations before any final notification is issued.

NRI deposit inflows fall 16% in FY26 due to weak rupee

Yashaswani Chauhan
New Delhi

NRI deposit inflows declined 16 per cent to $11.2 billion during April-December FY26, reversing a sharp 42.8 per cent surge to $13.33 billion in the corresponding period of FY25.

DATA FOCUS.

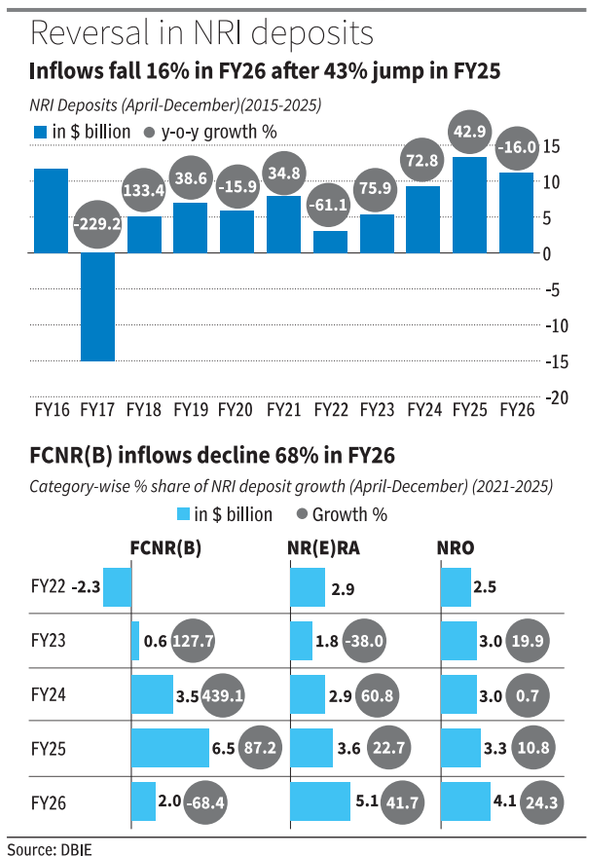
The moderation comes after two years of strong growth. Inflows had risen 72.7 per cent in FY24 and 42.8 per cent in FY25, marking a sharp recovery from the 61.1 per cent contraction recorded in FY22. Over the past decade, flows have remained episodic, swinging between double-digit growth and sharp contractions.

"Growth in NRI deposits has always been very episodic and inconsistent," said Anil Sood of the Institute for Advanced Studies in Complex Choices. He noted that inflows had stabilised around $6 billion annually between 2017-18 and 2022-23 before rising to $9 billion in 2023-24 and $13 billion in 2024-25. The current reduction may just be bringing flows back to the normal level of less than $10 billion.

Vivek Iyer, Partner and Financial Services Risk Advisory Leader, Grant Thornton Bharat, attributed the latest slowdown to currency expectations. "NRI deposits slowed down because of an expectation of a weaker rupee amid global geopolitical uncertainties. It was more of a timing game to ensure that more rupees were received for the same amount of dollars," he said, adding that the change appears tactical rather than structural.

FCNR (B) DEPOSITS

Category-wise data show that the decline in overall NRI deposit flows was led by FCNR(B) accounts, where inflows declined sharply by 68.4 per cent year-on-year to $2.04 billion in FY26 compared to $6.46 billion in the same period last year.



Source: DBIE

FCNR(B) deposits are foreign currency-denominated term deposits that protect investors from exchange rate risks, as both principal and interest are maintained in foreign currency.

In contrast, NRE deposits grew 41.7 per cent to $5.06 billion in FY26, up from $3.57 billion a year earlier. These accounts are rupee-denominated deposits where both principal and interest are fully repatriable and tax-free in India.

Meanwhile, NRO accounts, which are rupee-denominated accounts used to manage income earned in India, such as rent or dividends, and offer limited repatriation benefits, expanded 24.3 per cent to $4.09 billion in FY26, compared to $3.29 billion in the corresponding period last year.

Nearly 80 per cent of NRI deposits are held in repatriable accounts — FCNR(B) and NRE — making them sensitive to interest rate differentials and currency expectations. According to Sood, macroeconomic stability combined with relatively higher interest rates, driven at times by RBI incentives, has historically supported inflows.

Experts pointed out that FCNR(B) deposits have historically been more volatile, as investors in these foreign currency accounts are more yield-sensitive and wary of exchange rate risks. In contrast, NRE deposits, which are largely held by workers with long-term ties to India, tend to be more stable and less sensitive to short-term currency fluctuations.

They also added that in a phase of rupee depreciation, NRE accounts, being rupee-denominated, become more attractive as they translate into higher rupee returns for the same dollar inflow.

Looking ahead, analysts expect flows to stabilise rather than surge. "We may see stable flows only if INR is stable and the RBI does not cut policy rate," Sood said, cautioning that rate cuts or expectations of depreciation could deter deposits.

Japanese auto firms plan green investment in UP

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Automobile and auto components companies like Suzuki Motor (SMC), Honda Motor (HMC) and Minda Corporation have offered to invest in Uttar Pradesh towards green mobility and sustainable industrial growth.

Senior leadership of these companies met Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath in Japan and discussed future plans. For instance, Yogi met Toshihiro Suzuki, President of SMC, and Hisashi Takeuchi, Managing Director and CEO, Maruti Suzuki India, who proposed a compressed biogas plant.

4 DAY VISIT

As per the State government, during his four-day visit, the Chief Minister held successful investment road shows in Singapore and Japan.

In Singapore, the State government received investment proposals worth around ₹1 lakh crore and signed MoUs worth ₹60,000 crore. Similarly, it received investment proposals worth ₹1.5 lakh crore and inked MoUs worth ₹90,000 crore in Japan.

"Discussions focused on Suzuki's proposed entry into the renewable energy sector through a compressed biogas plant, along with expansion of its supplier ecosystem to strengthen the automotive value chain and generate employment," Yogi said in a social media post.

He apprised the delegation about land parcels available at competitive rates for auto clusters. "[The government] offered land at competitive rates in the Bundelkhand Industrial Development Authority for renewable energy projects and suitable land parcels across Uttar Pradesh for development of auto clusters, reinforcing our shared vision of sustainable industrial growth and green mobility," he said.

Similarly, Honda Motor which houses its first factory and corporate office in Greater Noida for the last 30 years, said that 30 per cent of its investment had been made in Uttar Pradesh.

Though Honda Cars India has discontinued making cars in the Greater Noida factory and does it only from its Tapukara plant in Rajasthan, it still retains the corporate headquarters out in Greater Noida.

"Uttar Pradesh is the home of Honda Motor Company in automobiles as well as the byproducts... 30 per cent of the investment that we have made in India is in Uttar Pradesh. We see a lot of potential in Uttar Pradesh," Noriya Kaihara, Director, Executive Vice President and Representative Executive Officer, HMC, said.

Edtech M&As rise on outcome-led growth focus

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

Mergers and acquisitions are beginning to gather pace in India's edtech sector, signalling a phase of consolidation after a prolonged funding slowdown and a series of high-profile corrections.

Investors say the market is entering a more disciplined cycle, with strategic integrations and product depth taking precedence over the hyper-growth playbook that defined the previous funding boom.

Aditya Singh, Partner and Co-founder at All In Capital, said the next phase of growth will be led by product-first companies focused on delivering measurable outcomes.

"The earlier generation of companies often prioritised scale and growth over product depth, but that phase is now behind us. Today, outcomes drive trust — and when outcomes are strong, brand value follows organically," he said.

Singh added that historically, large funding rounds in a sector attract more founders and capital, while acquisition signals and successful exits catalyse the launch of new ventures.

"These triggers are important indicators, and we are closely watching them," he said, suggesting that consolidation could spur fresh entrepreneurial activity in skilling and employability.

DEAL STRUCTURES

On deal structures, Singh said investors are likely to be more cautious following setbacks such as those involving Byju's. Venture capital firms are becoming more outcome-focused, backing startups that can demonstrate strong product performance and tangible results.

Valuation frameworks have also evolved. Earlier, metrics such as gross merchandise value, user additions and top-line growth commanded premium multiples. "Today, retention has become a critical driver of valuation," Singh said.

Another investor, who did not wish to be named, said, "Mergers and acquisitions will become more common now as the market has seen high-profile corrections. However, the sector will see new companies and fresh capital injection too, however not in the same valuations as seen earlier."

Recent transactions indicate early signs of this consolidation trend. upGrad has acquired early-talent marketplace Internshala in a deal structured as a 90 per cent stock swap. While the companies did not disclose the deal value, people aware of the matter pegged it at around ₹100 crore.

The acquisition comes a month after upGrad's advanced talks to acquire Unacademy for $300–$400 million were called off due to valuation disagreements, underscoring the sharper pricing discipline in the sector.

'Indian IT ecosystem needs its own champions'

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Indian companies must identify new champions for cloud, semiconductors and deep-tech verticals in the tech ecosystem to continue their pace in the AI race, industry experts told *businessline* at the Nasscom Technology Leaders Forum (NTLF).

Domestic tech giants such as Wipro, Infosys, Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), Cognizant, HCL Technologies — known by the acronym WITCH — have led the tech sector in India, but as the world enters the AI age, analysts feel that the ecosystem needs to come up with new trailblazers beyond the services sector.

In its recent report, BCG outlined segments such as semiconductors, data centres and hyperscalers as

the next 'big bets' which offer high market attractiveness, although India's "right to win" in these categories is limited today. It suggested that Indian tech companies must place targeted bets to invest in the future while accelerating services, GCCs, BPO and ER&D segments and building adjacencies like an India stack.

"I would urge all of us to think beyond services. Not to say services is not important but the question is where are the next WITCH companies coming from? What is going to be the WITCH of semiconductors or data centres or deeptech? That is absent. I'm assuming the WITCH leaders and all corresponding companies will also think about this," said Rajiv Gupta, Managing Director and Senior Partner at BCG, while listing Zoho as a possible contender.

Leaders like TCS CEO K Krithivasan also talked about new revenue streams or opportunities that "are not being explored properly." He encouraged employees to leverage AI for solutions even if it leads to cannibalisation of revenues.

The pivot is all the more significant considering analysts firms like PL Capital and McKinsey anticipated price contractions for IT services going forward. In a report, PL Capital said IT services will see a volatile intermittent period with uncertainty on growth and margins. Pallav Jain, Senior Partner at McKinsey, said these contractions can be mitigated by expansion into new services.

MARKET EXPANSION

"Players, who are more commercially savvy, understand that there will be pressure on existing services but they are investing with clients into new innovation areas so that they can expand their share of the market," he said.

Regarding the recent IT stocks rout, Jain said the trend was to some extent a knee jerk reaction. However, he still anticipated clear winners and losers with a consolidation trend in services. Meanwhile, Gupta said India still ranks among the top three tech leaders of the world by a distance.

TVS Motor Company announces re-entry into South African market

Our Bureau
Chennai

TVS Motor Company (TVSM) has announced its re-entry into the South African market. It has entered into a partnership with The Nexus Collective, a specialised distributorship backed by the Bidvest Group Ltd, South Africa's largest automotive distributor.

With this launch, TVSM becomes the only two-wheeler brand in South Africa to operate across multiple product forms and segments simultaneously, according to a release.

INTERNATIONAL BIZ

The expansion is a cornerstone of TVSM's international growth strategy.

As of 2025, international business accounts for 25 per cent of the company's total sales, with Africa representing over half of global operational revenue and nearly 70 per cent of export unit volumes.

South Africa is a strategically important market for TVSM, said Peyman Kargar, President – International Business.

"Our focus will be on building a scalable distribution footprint and creating sustainable long-term value in South Africa's evolving mobility ecosystem," he said.

TVSM is also introducing seven proven products tailored for diverse applications, including daily commuting, leisure, delivery utility and shared mobility, the release said.

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BRND.ME completes India domicile shift

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Consumer brands company BRND.ME has completed its domicile shift from Singapore to India in under 10 months, following regulatory approvals from the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) and the High Court of Singapore.

The restructuring simplifies the company's governance framework and sets the stage for a potential IPO within the next 12 to 18 months. The move positions BRND.ME among the first such corporate restructurings of 2026, following similar reverse flips, where India-founded companies redomicile back from overseas holding structures to India, by PhonePe, Groww, Razorpay and Zepto.

The merger of Mensa Brands Singapore with its Indian holding company, Mensa India, received all requisite approvals across both jurisdictions. The NCLT Chandigarh Bench sanctioned the scheme on February 20, 2026, following prior approval from the High Court of Singapore.

Ananth Narayanan, Founder and CEO, said: "We have not only moved our domicile but executed a complex cross-border merger across Singapore and India in under 10 months. It sets us up with a much stronger foundation as we look ahead to the next phase of growth, including our path to becoming a public company."

Tata Motors to deploy 40 green hydrogen-powered trucks at VOC port

Our Bureau
Chennai

Tata Motors has signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with the VO Chidambaranar Port Authority (VOCPA) in Thoothukudi, Tamil Nadu, to deploy 40 green hydrogen internal combustion engine-powered (H2 ICE) prime movers at the port.

The MoU was signed in the presence of Sarbananda Sonowal, Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, on Monday.

As part of the MoU, Tata Motors will commence trials with a hydrogen-powered prime mover, followed by the phased deployment of H2 ICE-powered prime movers over the next two years.

The project will be funded by the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways, according to a release.

SETTING BENCHMARK

Susanta Kumar Purohit, Chairperson, VOCPA, said the deployment of green hydrogen-powered trucks will significantly decarbonise cargo handling operations while setting a benchmark for sustainable port-led logistics in India. To support the phased induction of the green hydrogen trucks, the port is progressing plans to establish a 2 MW electrolyser and a dedicated hydrogen refuelling station.

Rajesh Kaul, Vice President and Business Head–Trucks, Tata Motors Ltd, said, "Over the past several months, we have worked closely with the port authorities to assess pathways for hydrogen trucks in cargo handling applications. This pilot will help demonstrate the potential of assessing the TCO parity and with green hydrogen in supporting the transition of India's ports towards cleaner and more sustainable logistics solutions."

New GDP series to use 600 item level data

FOCUS ON ACCURACY. The revised series will adopt double deflation for sharper growth estimates

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The Ministry of Statistics will significantly expand the data used to calculate India's Gross Domestic Product (GDP) in the upcoming series with base year 2022-23, aiming to improve the accuracy of growth estimates.

The revised series, scheduled for release on Friday, will use nearly 600 item level data indicators under the double deflation method, more than three times the current 180 level data used for price adjustment.

CHANGES AFOOT

- Annual quarterly estimates for 2022-23 to 2025-26 to be released on Friday
- Back series data are expected to be released by December 2026
- Statistics Ministry says the revised series is in sync with the international statistical standards
- Major methodological improvements include reduction in allocation-based methods in favour of direct estimation for some sectors/sub-sectors, and reduction in reliance on fixed ratios and proxies, besides others

NEW GROWTH DATA

A senior official said once the national GDP numbers under the new base year are released, work will begin on compiling revised growth data for States and Union Territories.

At the heart of the revision is the shift to full adoption of double deflation method for key sectors such as manufacturing and agriculture and complete elimination of single deflation method. Under this approach, the value of output and the cost of inputs are adjusted separately for price changes before calculating real growth. In simple terms, GDP aims to measure how much the economy is producing in real terms, that is after removing the impact of inflation. To do this, statisticians use price indices or deflators.

Under double deflation, the prices of finished goods (output) are adjusted separately. The prices of raw materials and services used to produce them (inputs) are also adjusted separately.

For example, if a factory produces shoes, bags and coats, statisticians must adjust the sales value of each product for changes in their prices. At the same time, they must separately adjust the cost of leather, rubber, glue and other materials used to make those products. Since output prices and input prices often move differently, using separate adjustments gives a more accurate picture of actual production growth. Previously, India used a mix of single and double deflation. In the new series, single deflation has been eliminated in the sectors concerned, a move that is expected to make GDP estimates more robust and internationally aligned.

However, the Wholesale Price Index will continue to be used as the main deflator until its own base year is updated. The expansion from 180 level data to nearly 600 item level data indicators means statisticians will track a much wider basket of goods and services to strip out inflation effects. According to international practice, including IMF guidance, double deflation is data-intensive and requires detailed price information across industries.

Officials said the broader price base will improve reliability of real growth numbers, especially in sectors where input costs fluctuate differently from output prices.

SURVEY-BASED DATA

The new GDP series will also rely more heavily on administrative and survey-based data rather than proxy estimates. Among the key changes are: household sector estimates will now be based on actual annual surveys such as the Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (ASUSE) and the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS), instead of interpolations between survey years. GST data will be used more extensively to allocate private corporate sector output across States and to cross-verify annual and quarterly estimates.

E-Vahan data will help estimate household spending on road transport services. Public Finance Management System data will be used to compile Central government expenditure and distribute it across States.

India, Israel to expedite negotiations for early signing of FTA

Our Bureau
New Delhi

India and Israel on Thursday gave fresh momentum to bilateral trade ties by expediting negotiations for an early signing of a free trade agreement (FTA) even as the two countries elevated their relationship to a special strategic partnership for peace, innovation and prosperity.

OPERATION ISRAEL. Prime Minister Narendra Modi with the cast of *Fauda* in Jerusalem on Thursday ANI

A NEW DIRECTION

Jointly addressing the media in Tel Aviv, along with Israeli counterpart Benjamin Netanyahu on the last day of his two-day state visit to Israel, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said they discussed imparting a new direction and faster pace to bilateral cooperation. "In today's meeting, we discussed giving a new direction and a faster pace to our cooperation. Our economic cooperation is the engine of growth, innovation and shared prosperity. To encourage mutual investment, we entered into a bilateral investment agreement last year.

"We will also soon finalise a mutually beneficial FTA," he said.

The next round of negotiations for the FTA will be held in May, the Commerce Ministry said. An Israeli delegation is here to hold talks.

The statement came after the two countries concluded the first round of four-day talks that discussed a wide range of issues, including trade in goods and services, rules of origin, sanitary and phyto-sanitary measures, technical barriers to trade, customs procedures, intellectual property rights and digital trade.

MODI'S SECOND VISIT

In his second visit to Israel in nine years, Modi also held talks with President Isaac Herzog, interacted with the Indian diaspora, and the cast and crew of the global hit Israeli television show *Fauda* on Thursday before flying back to India.

The push to the FTA comes alongside the India-Israel Bilateral Investment Agreement signed in September 2025, aimed at strengthening investor protection and dispute resolution mechanisms.

In a move with commercial implications, the two sides also agreed to explore linking India's Unified Payments Interface (UPI) with Israel's payment system.

An MoU between NPCI International and MASAV was signed to examine cross-border digital payment interoperability, potentially easing transactions for businesses and travellers.

TRADE TALKS

FOR BETTER DAYS. Commerce & Industry Minister Piyush Goyal with US Secretary of Commerce Howard Lutnick (left) and US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor in New Delhi on Thursday ANI

Tiruppur knitwear industry seeks Centre's aid for worker housing to retain labour

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

With India signing a series of free trade agreements (FTAs), the knitwear industry in Tiruppur has sought the Centre's support for the construction of large-scale affordable rental housing for workers, citing growing challenges in labour retention.

ON HIRING SPREE

Industry sources said organised worker accommodation is critical to attract and retain labour as Tiruppur is expected to see a sharp increase in hiring over the next few months following higher order inflows triggered by the FTAs and the recent tariff changes announced by the US.

At present, individual companies arrange accommodation for employees. However, exporters are now willing to pool resources and develop large hostels with government support.

The proposal draws inspiration from the large housing facilities built for mobile phone manufacturing units in the Oragadam-Sriperumbudur industrial cluster, leveraging the affordable rental housing component under PMAY-U 2.0.

According to the Tiruppur Exporters' Association (TEA), the estimated cost of establishing hostel facilities is around ₹2 lakh per bed.

It has proposed hostel capacities ranging from 250 to 1,000 beds, and has sought the removal of the 18 per cent GST on rent deducted towards workers' accommodation.

Tiruppur employs nearly 10 lakh workers, of whom 3.5-4.5 lakh are migrants from 19 States.

Women account for nearly 70 per cent of the workforce. Nearly one lakh workers commute daily from nearby districts.

MAJOR CONSTRAINT

"The lack of organised, affordable housing has become a major constraint in sustaining growth and meeting export commitments," said N Thirukkumaran, Chairman, Esstee Exports India Ltd, Tiruppur, and Secretary of TEA.

In a representation to the Centre, the association said investment in worker housing will yield tangible productivity gains.

A company official said housing is essential to ensure business continuity, retain skilled workers and meet delivery schedules.

CHENNAI
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FRIDAY - FEBRUARY 27, 2026

Last mile finance

Local body finances need boost, with more transparency

Debates on Finance Commission awards revolve around the share of revenues to be shared with States and the norms for sharing between States. However, what is less discussed are the financial needs of local bodies, rural and urban. They do need more funds — the question is the form in which this should be provided or raised (grants or own taxes), and the terms, if any, that should accompany grants.

The need to provide more funds is a Constitutional imperative. The 73rd and 74th Amendment mandate regular elections to rural and urban local bodies, respectively. The corollary is that these bodies need the funds to be effective. The 16th Finance Commission has earmarked ₹7.9 lakh crore as grants for local bodies for the 2026-31 period. Such sums have been rising sharply every five years. The latest panel has increased the allocation of grants by 84 per cent in the case of rural bodies to ₹4.35 lakh crore over the 15th panel, and by 230 per cent to ₹3.56 lakh crore for urban local bodies. The rural to urban ratio here is lower than in the past, as there's a sharp push this time to promote smaller towns and cities. Even so, assuming an average tax devolution to States, from the Centre, of about ₹16 lakh crore annually over this period (41 per cent share), the overall allocation of ₹7.9 lakh crore over five years is still less than 10 per cent.

The key question is whether this share should be raised, or these bodies should be encouraged to step up their own resources. Urban local bodies raise 50 per cent of their resources on their own, but it is also true that they are faced with rising urbanisation and its challenges, such as pollution, poverty and natural disasters. This explains the role of municipal bonds as well as green finance. Rural local bodies raise less than 10 per cent of the resources through own revenues, while supporting over half the population. The Economic Survey FY18 which dwells on transfers to local bodies in depth, raises the question of whether, in the case of rural bodies, the low own taxes share works as a convenient arrangement — where the elected representatives fight shy of antagonising their small voter base. The Survey also cites the basic maxim of taxpayers having a stake in the system and holding it accountable, more so where governments are in proximity. In that case, the power to collect taxes could be shifted to the district level, linking some transfers with rewards for performance. In fact, for new financial instruments to take root, better records and audits are a must; the 16th finance panel recognises this. Half the basic grants accounting for 80 per cent of the total are tied to waste and water management, while performance grants are linked to raising own resources. The devolution between local bodies is based largely on population (90 per cent) and area (10 per cent).

Finally, political and economic institutions for grassroots governance have not done well enough. Elections to panchayats and municipalities are delayed for years. Financial and political reform must go together.

OTHER VOICES.

The Guardian

Saving Westminster: parliament should leave London

MPs and peers face a looming choice: stay put or move out to allow billions of pounds of urgent repairs to the crumbling Palace of Westminster. That was the conclusion of a report from MPs, peers and lay members on the restoration and renewal client board this month. The palace, rebuilt after a fire destroyed it in 1834, is falling apart. There have been 36 "fire incidents" since 2016. Water leaks, heating failures and sewerage problems plague the heart of this Unesco world heritage site. Fixing Westminster would save money in the long run. An upgrade is also a matter of safety and legacy. "The building is just waiting for some disaster," says the Tory peer Michael Dobbs, who advises visitors that if they see someone running, they should run too. Labour's Peter Hain is blunter still, calling it "a Notre Dame inferno in the making". LONDON, FEBRUARY 25

CHINA DAILY

Opportunity to reflect on folly of tariff war

The United States Supreme Court pulled the emergency brake on a tariff train that had been barreling down the tracks in the name of national crisis, powered largely by political theatrics and a fondness for blunt instruments. The ruling striking down last year's sweeping tariffs imposed under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act should have been a moment of reflection in the White House — a time to realize that governing the country's economy is not the same as hosting the finale of a television reality show. Instead, the response has been to rummage through the legal attic for replacement weapons: Section 122, global tariffs, and the ever-reliable Section 301 investigations. US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer insists this is about "continuity", a word that in Washington often means doing the same thing with a different acronym. BEIJING, FEBRUARY 26

Securities Bill has a problematic Section

ANTI-MARKET. An omnibus exemption for public sector companies from governance norms risks weakening accountability and competitive neutrality

GETTY IMAGES

MS SAHOO
CKG NAIR

The Securities Market Code Bill, 2025 is a significant and overdue attempt to modernise India's securities law architecture. It has many positives. Yet, one provision, Section 65(2), risks diluting the reformist ethos that the Bill otherwise seeks to advance.

Section 65(2) empowers the Centre, in public interest, to exempt any listed public sector company (PSC) from any or all requirements relating to the issue of capital, minimum offer size, issue and transfer of securities, corporate governance, disclosures, substantial acquisition and takeover regulations, public shareholding norms, concentration and prudential norms, risk management, and incidental matters. In effect, it enables the executive to suspend core securities market disciplines for an entire ownership class. It strikes at the philosophical core of India's post-1991 reforms.

Economic liberalisation was not merely about allowing private entry; it was about redefining the state's role in markets. The doctrine of the 'commanding heights', where public enterprises dominated key sectors under preferential policy regimes, was gradually dismantled. Sectoral reservations were reduced and ultimately abolished; competition was introduced in banking, telecom, and insurance; and disinvestment diluted state ownership in commercial enterprises. The reform consensus rested on a simple proposition: the State would move from a privileged market participant to a rule-maker and referee. Section 65(2) unsettles that equilibrium by reintroducing regulatory asymmetry based purely on ownership.

SHORT SHRIFT TO NEUTRALITY

A central pillar of the reform has been competitive neutrality. Public and private enterprises operating in the same market have been subject to the same competition law, the same disclosure standards, and the same governance expectations. If an enterprise raises capital from public markets, it must submit to public market discipline. The proposed exemption provision departs from this fundamental logic. It creates a dual regime, one in which private companies remain fully bound by governance, disclosure, and takeover norms, while listed PSCs may be relieved from them through executive notification. That disturbs the level playing field and injects uncertainty into regulatory expectations.

More fundamentally, the provision creates an anomalous relationship between market access and market discipline. Listed PSCs access equity markets, attract institutional and foreign portfolio investors, benefit from liquidity and price discovery, and rely on market valuation to support disinvestment programmes. Yet, under Section 65(2), they may be exempted from the very rules that underpin investor confidence: public shareholding requirements, takeover protections, governance standards, and risk management norms.

Markets operate on reciprocity: access to capital is conditional upon transparency, predictability, and adherence to uniform standards. To enjoy the benefits of the market without being fully subject to its discipline is to create regulatory free riders. Over time, such asymmetry can irretrievably weaken confidence in the system, painstakingly built over decades.

The justification offered is 'public interest'. But public interest cannot be presumed solely from state ownership. Many listed PSCs operate in sectors where private firms of comparable scale compete directly: banking, insurance, energy, infrastructure, and financial services. If a public sector steel company and a private sector steel company serve the same customers and access the same capital market, the rationale for exempting one from governance norms while holding the other to full compliance becomes difficult to sustain.

> **To enjoy the benefits of the market without being fully subject to its discipline is to create** regulatory free riders. Over time, such asymmetry can irretrievably weaken confidence in the system

Several public sector entities already operate under special statutes that confer bespoke governance structures. Where differentiation was necessary, Parliament has consciously provided it. Section 65(2) adds a further, sweeping executive override atop these arrangements. Such a notification-based power inevitably raises questions about regulatory autonomy and predictability.

Independent securities regulation evolved precisely to ensure that rule-making is stable, transparent, and insulated from short-term pressures. The prospect of selective exemptions for an issuer or class of issuers may unsettle investor perception, particularly among global institutions that value consistency of regulatory treatment.

There is little evidence that regulatory relaxation enhances enterprise value. In recent decades, private peers in several sectors have commanded stronger valuation multiples than public sector counterparts of similar scale. Markets reward governance quality, board independence, disclosure rigour, and credible minority shareholder protection. Diluting these disciplines may not improve performance; it may simply increase perceived governance risk and the cost of capital.

NEED FOR SAFEGUARDS

Minority shareholders in listed PSCs, including retail investors, pension funds, and domestic institutions, rely on takeover norms, public float requirements, and disclosure standards for protection. When the state is both the controlling shareholder and rule-maker, such safeguards assume greater significance. Any measure that sidelines these standards runs counter to the stated objective of listing more PSCs and deepening divestment.

It is natural for the state to protect its enterprises, particularly where public resources and policy objectives are intertwined. But excessive protection can be counterproductive.

The Bill is an opportunity to reinforce India's commitment to deep, credible, and globally competitive capital markets. That commitment rests on equality before regulation, institutional clarity, and competitive neutrality. Section 65(2), in its present form, risks signalling that ownership may once again determine regulatory obligation.

If public enterprises seek capital from public markets, they must accept the discipline that accompanies it. Section 65(2), which permits the government to exempt listed PSCs from core securities market disciplines, risks reversing three decades of economic reform.Genuine sector-specific challenges can be addressed through transparent consultation, regulatory amendments applicable to all similarly situated entities, or targeted legislative changes debated in Parliament.

Ownership, by itself, cannot become the basis for differential regulatory treatment in competitive markets. A modern securities code must reinforce equal rules and institutional credibility, not dilute them.

Sahoo is former Chairperson, Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India; Nair is former Director, National Institute of Securities Markets

Reimagining FCI to raise farm incomes

The revamp of FCI must be in sync with MSP and fertilizer subsidy reforms. Curbing grain wastage must also be a priority

Amit Kapoor
Pradeep Puri
Ananya Khurana

The Food Corporation of India (FCI) was set up in 1965 as a bulwark against hunger, responsible for procuring grain at assured prices, stabilising markets, and feeding millions through the Public Distribution System (PDS).

Six decades on, the mission remains vital, but the context has shifted dramatically. Today, India stands at a point of opportunity: managing abundant cereal stocks, building resilience against climate variability, and optimising fiscal resources.

FCI should pivot from open-ended physical MSP procurement to a more calibrated role focused primarily on maintaining buffer stocks for food security, while reducing unnecessary costs. This basically implies delinking procurement volumes from storage capacity so that procurement responds to buffer stock norms and does not exceed them by default.

Modern silo capacity and smarter buffer stock management, aligned with domestic price stabilisation objectives, can transform price stabilisation from a reactive exercise into a predictable, rules-based system. FCI cannot be revamped standalone or in one stroke. It must evolve alongside reforms in MSP and fertilizer subsidies through Direct Benefit Transfers (DBT), guided by broad stakeholder consultation and consensus. This could address chronic storage inefficiencies, reduce fiscal burdens, and eventually support India's ambition to reach $100 billion in agricultural exports by 2030.

Buffer stocks act as economic insurance as they are procured in surplus to prevent price crashes and released during shortages to curb inflation. Norms are set quarterly to meet the National Food Security Act (NFSA) requirements, strategic reserves, and contingencies, yet stocks often exceed these levels.

As of July 1, 2025, rice and wheat reserves stood at 736.61 lakh tonne against norms of 411.20 lakh tonne, forcing Open Market Sale Scheme (OMSS) releases to moderate prices. Such overhangs inflate carrying costs, risk quality loss, and add logistics expenses, implying the need for smarter storage and faster rotation. It is excess procurement, not capacity constraints, that generates today's inefficiencies.

In 2023-24, FCI spent a staggering ₹1,87,834 crore on procurement, logistics, employee remuneration, and depreciation on its traditional storage capacity, translating to ₹22,347.62 per tonne. Of the total expenditure, the Comptroller and Auditor General flagged ₹62.76 crore spent on storage and supervision of food stock as avoidable costs in Punjab and Haryana alone. Set this beside a modern domestic silo operator that manages similar functions at around ₹534 per tonne, illustrating how technology and incentives dramatically lower costs.

REFORMING. Food management SRINATH M

ADVANTAGE SILOS

While conventional FCI godowns cost about ₹915 crore per million tonnes to build, modern silos cost only marginally more at about ₹1,000 crore, whereas global benchmarks hover around ₹207-₹373 crore. Even with higher upfront costs, silos slash losses, improve quality, and deliver long-term savings.

India's rapid rollout of Public-Private Partnership (PPP) silos is a step in that direction. The six modern facilities (50,000 tonne each) commissioned in Bihar, Punjab, and Gujarat promise scientific storage, bulk handling, and rail integration. Silo capacity is projected to rise from 2.8 million tonne to 9 million tonne across 250 locations in three years, with long leases and per-tonne storage charges creating clear performance incentives. The payoff is real: scientific storage of wheat can reduce losses to 0.3-2 per cent, preserving quality and lowering re-bagging, fumigation, and shrinkage. These efficiency gains matter because they ensure that even if MSP procurement is scaled back, food security remains intact as long as buffer-stock norms under the National Food Security Act (NFSA) are maintained.

All this hinges on policy discipline. Rule-based OMSS bands should automatically trigger releases whenever stocks exceed buffer norms, with reserve prices calibrated to regional wholesale indices and transport costs. Faster OMSS releases could generate fiscal savings that can be redirected toward DBT, agronomic extension, and support for lagging regions.

Eliminating wastage of nearly 28 per cent of subsidised foodgrains could unlock savings of about ₹70,125 crore, allowing reinvestment in scientific storage that preserves grain quality, cuts losses, and improves realised farm returns.

At the same time, predictable price stabilisation would reduce crash risk and encourage diversification away from water-intensive cereals toward pulses and oilseeds. Crucially, this does not dismantle food security.

Kapoor is chair, Puri is Senior Fellow and Ananya Khurana is senior researcher at the Institute for Competitiveness

LETTERS TO EDITOR

Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

PSBs shine bright

With reference to the Editorial 'Rhetoric to reality' (February 26), it is highly creditable that public sector banks have started performing better than their private sector counterparts and brought out their inherent potential to the fore in the last quarter.

While State Bank of India led the profit growth with lion's share, a few other PSBs also have posted double digit growth. Treasury operations of PSBs also contributed significantly to the profitability with major gains reaped by Canara Bank and Bank of Baroda.

Another significant performance point to be noted is the recoveries made in technically written off accounts by PSBs, especially PNB, SBI and Central Bank.

If PSBs can improve their customer service as well, they have the potential to overtake private sector banks in future as well.

Kosaraju Chandramouli
Hyderabad

Apropos, 'Rhetoric to reality', (February 26), public sector banks are healthier today because sustained structural clean-up and tighter institutional discipline have fundamentally reengineered balance-sheet quality and risk governance.

Years of aggressive recognition and time-bound resolution of stressed assets compressed legacy NPAs and restored transparency. Improved recoveries through insolvency and settlement frameworks have strengthened cash flows.

Above all, tighter regulatory supervision by RBI has embedded prudent underwriting, continuous monitoring and compliance culture. Collectively, these reforms have revived market confidence, lowered systemic fragility for sustainable credit expansion nationwide today.

N Sadhasiva Reddy
Bengaluru

Push disinvestment

This refers to the article 'Disinvestment must gather pace' (February 26). Disinvestment is one of the important capital receipts of the government.

With rising capital expenditure, achieving the disinvestment target (₹80,000 crore for 2026-27) can lessen the government's fiscal deficit considerably.

Having said that, one feels, the government should monitor the performance of undertakings post-disinvestment phase and get the views of the stakeholders. Privatisation at the expense of public welfare is unwelcome.

S Ramakrishnasayee
Chennai

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A holistic semicon push

Mission 2.0 seeks to create a robust ecosystem

Vishnu Sudarsan
Priyanka Barik
S Santosh

Semiconductors are the foundation of the digital economy, enabling sectors ranging from telecommunications and artificial intelligence to defence, electric mobility, and renewable energy systems. The need for government to control the semiconductor supply chains has therefore become a strategic priority, particularly in light of recent geopolitical tensions and pandemic-induced disruptions.

In this context, Budget 2026-27 marked a meaningful shift in India's technology and industrial policy with the formal rollout of India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) 2.0 and the enhancement of the Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme (ECMS) to an outlay of ₹40,000 crore.

These initiatives, taken together, reflect a shift from assembly-oriented manufacturing towards building a comprehensive semiconductor ecosystem based on IP. While the previous approaches focused on fabrication capacity in isolation, ISM 2.0 seeks to position manufacturing within a broader framework consisting of design, materials, equipment, and institutional capability.

FOCUS. Shifting to design, materials and equipment

INITIAL FOCUS

The initial phase of the India Semiconductor Mission, approved in December 2021 with a total outlay of ₹76,000 crore, was largely focused on developing domestic fabrication and packaging capacity. ISM 1.0 was successful in attracting large anchor investments, such as Tata Electronics' fabrication facility in Gujarat, Micron's ATMP unit at Sanand, and CG Power's OSAT operations. The regulatory approach during this phase depended heavily on upfront capital subsidies, complemented by State-level fiscal and infrastructure incentives.

These tools proved effective in lowering entry barriers in a sector defined by extreme capital intensity and technological risk, and they played a key role in placing India on the global semiconductor investment map. At the same time, ISM 1.0 remained largely focused on downstream manufacturing outcomes.

The upstream segments such as domestic production of fabrication equipment, specialty materials, advanced wafers, and design infrastructure received comparatively limited attention. As a result, while fabrication and packaging capacity began to take shape, the supporting ecosystem continued to depend heavily on imports and foreign technology.

ISM 2.0 seeks to address these gaps through a more integrated and institutionally anchored policy framework.

Although the Budget allocation for FY 2026-27 is modest in absolute terms, it is strategically directed towards three interlinked priorities: (a) domestic production of equipment and materials, (b) development of full-stack Indian IP, and (c) creation of industry-led research and training infrastructure.

The expanded ECMS plays a central role in strengthening component and material manufacturing, including specialised chemicals, gases, wafers, precision machinery, and advanced packaging services. In parallel, the emphasis on research centres and skilling hubs reflects a shift towards non-fiscal regulatory instruments, embedding human capital development and institutional capacity within industrial policy.

From an investment structuring perspective, the continuation of concessional customs duty regimes, the absence of sector-specific levies, and the promotion of cluster-based development models further improve project viability, enhance supply-chain resilience, and facilitate coordinated infrastructure development.

ISM 2.0 represents a transition from incentive oriented capacity creation towards ecosystem-led industrial policy. By combining fiscal support with measures for research, design, skilling, and supplier development, the Government has sought to create a balanced and sustainable semiconductor framework.

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GURBACHAN SINGH

REUTERS

The large US public debt, and the way forward

MONEY MATTERS. More than financing fiscal deficits, the solution lies in cutting them

The tariffs in the US have been repeatedly in the news, and understandably so. However, there is another very important issue which is, in the process, getting much less attention. This is the very large US public debt. US government securities have been a very useful asset internationally. However, the US public debt now stands at about 120 per cent of the GDP. The interest payments on the public debt now exceed the military spending. The international reserve currency status for the US is increasingly in question; the sell-off of US government securities by China over time is just one prominent example. How is the US handling the whole situation?

For a clear understanding, we need to first go back in time. In the aftermath of the Global Financial Crisis in 2007, the US public debt rose substantially. However, the interest cost was low for a long time. This is because the Fed used quantitative easing. The so-called base money expanded massively and the Fed bought government securities on a large scale.

Most of the additional base money issued by the Fed was, in turn, held by the banks; this money is more familiar as reserves held by banks with the Fed. The latter started paying interest on reserve balances in October 2008. This made reserves relatively attractive. Though this interest is a part of the monetary policy, it helped with financing of the fiscal deficits as well.

THE LCR MANDATE

Now we come to what is less well understood. In 2015, the liquidity coverage ratio (LCR) was initiated and it was in force fully by 2019. The banks needed to hold high quality liquid assets. Basically, banks are required to hold a good amount of US government securities directly, or indirectly through their holdings of reserves with the Fed. The latter, in turn, holds government securities. Though the LCR requirement is a prudential norm, this too has helped in financing the fiscal deficits.

It is true that the high quality liquid assets actually held by banks are, in any case, significantly more than the requirement. Nevertheless, the regulation matters because the assets held for this reason are effectively illiquid in the normal course of banking! So, additional reserves and government securities are needed for normal banking.

This is partly the reason for "excess" liquid assets with banks; the other reason was that the credit off-take was not strong for many years.

Completing the story on base money, though this expanded massively, the *time path of money in circulation with the public* hardly changed till the time of Covid-19 crisis. Relatedly, the time path of bank deposits did not rise for a long time. This is on the liabilities side of the banks' balance sheets. On the assets side, the time path of bank loans was at a lower level, given that banks held large reserves. This is consistent with the relatively low growth of GDP for many years.

Though the banks' direct and indirect holdings of the US public debt are not massive, they are large enough to provide confidence at the margin to the other main buyers. The prices of US government securities did not fall substantially and consistently, which is to say that the yields did not jump even though the debt was large. This contributed synthetically in meeting the sustainability condition for public debt.

After the crisis due to Covid-19 showed up, conditions changed. Though the interest rates fell further for a while, there was soon good economic recovery. Relatedly, the interest rates rose and so did the interest burden on the existing debt. Moreover, the additional debt was very large — the treasury sent cheques to its citizens.

> **The voluntary demand for reserves by banks is softening, which is to say that their indirect** demand for the US government securities has been weakening

SITUATION DETERIORATING

Overall, the situation on the US debt front and its financing has been deteriorating. The voluntary demand for reserves by banks is softening, which is to say that their indirect demand for the US government securities has been weakening. Again related, the Fed had been moving for some time to quantitative tightening, which is a reversal of quantitative easing. Also, the treasury may be now somewhat increasing the fiscal deficit with its recent Big Beautiful Bill.

It is true that some new positive developments too have been happening for the financing of the public debt. The mortgaged-backed securities that have been held by the Fed are maturing, and some reinvestment is being done in the US government securities. Also, there are new buyers of government securities like the companies that issue, what is called, Stablecoin.

The GENIUS Act, 2025 helped here though the amount reached so far is small. The quantitative tightening has now been stopped by the Fed. The US leadership may do more to manage the situation. It may exercise various selling or licensing rights, and even use its gold reserves. And, the high inflation seen over the period 2021-23 may happen yet again in future. This could again help in eroding a part of the real debt. We have here the non-transparent 'inflation tax'.

It has helped that hedge funds are now holding a good amount of the long-term US government securities but we have derivatives, short-term financing, etc. This has its own fragility issues. Relatively more stable, the Fed uses 'reserve management' and the treasury intervenes now and then to deal with some frictions.

The point is that the focus has been, by and large, on financing the fiscal deficits. However, the basic policy solution lies in cutting down the fiscal deficits. This can be done in two ways. The treasury needs to cut public spending on some fronts. And, it can raise the tax revenues, given that the tax-GDP ratio is low compared to many other developed countries. Otherwise, the debt is very hard to sustain without serious adverse implications.

There is scope for course correction — more so when the US has a strong and innovative economy. But it is not clear if the correction is happening anytime soon.

The writer is an independent economist. He taught at Ashoka University, ISI (Delhi) and JNU

US 'de-funding' mRNA research was a mistake

Ashleigh Furlong
Mishal Husain

The US made a mistake when it pulled almost $500 million of funding from research into the technology that generated Covid shots, according to World Health Organization Chief Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus. "De-funding mRNA research is the wrong decision. I hope they will reconsider," Tedros said in an interview on Bloomberg's The Mishal Husain Show. "We are in the molecular age and this technology has a huge potential," he said, pointing to the possibility of using mRNA vaccines to treat cancers in the future.

He also expressed belief that the US would rejoin the public health agency, which it formally exited last month, within a decade. President Donald Trump announced the withdrawal plan a year ago and left behind an unpaid debt of roughly $260 million. Trump has railed against the global public health agency, arguing it lacked accountability to the US — formerly its largest donor — and failed to respond adequately to the pandemic.

IMMUNISATION PULL-BACK

The US Department of Health and Human Services curtailed plans to develop vaccines using mRNA technology from companies including Moderna Inc., CSL Seqirus, Pfizer, Sanofi and AstraZeneca Plc. The move came as US health secretary Robert F Kennedy Jr. overhauled the nation's immunisation approach, including adding vaccine critics to a key advisory panel and paring back the number of shots recommended for America's children. The disagreement over vaccination is an intensely personal matter for Tedros, who became emotional when talking about his younger brother's death from what he now believes was measles.

WHO CHIEF. Sees huge potential in mRNA vaccines REUTERS

"I'm the lucky one and he was not the lucky one. I survived," Tedros said.

Despite the disagreements, Tedros said he still communicates with Kennedy over text and the phone. The WHO chief said he agrees with Kennedy's approach to non-communicable diseases, as well as the US push to lower drug prices.

Asked whether he thinks the US will rejoin the WHO in the next decade, Tedros answered with the affirmative. The two groups "still work together," he said, and the US understands the organisation's value in terms of health security. Kennedy's view that health is created in homes, schools and the environment — not hospitals — is one Tedros said he stands by. "You can still work together while disagreeing on some issues and agreeing on other issues," he said. BLOOMBERG

thehindu businessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

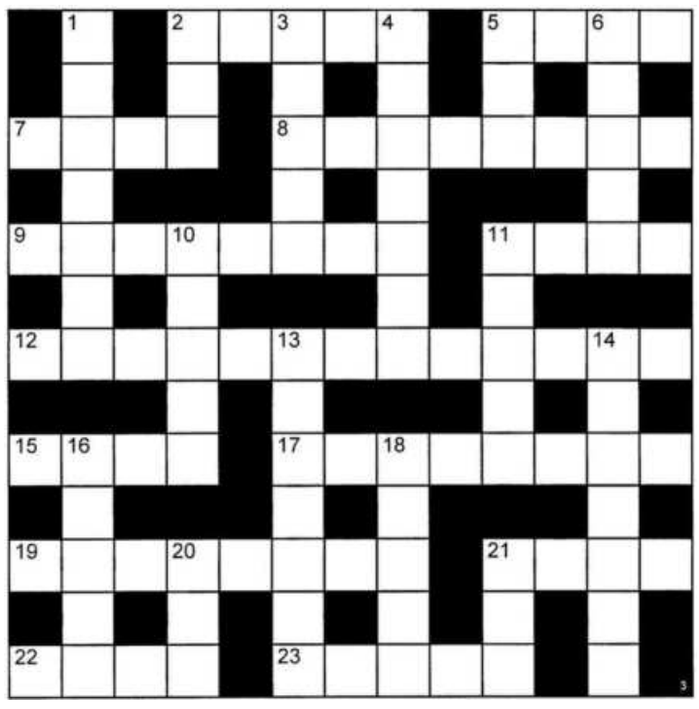
February 27, 2006

Higher tax breaks likely for health insurance
Insurance reforms could well be one of the predominant flavours of the forthcoming Union Budget. On February 28, the Finance Minister, Mr P. Chidambaram, could overhaul the insurance laws that could pave way for a higher cap on foreign direct investment (FDI) in the sector and lower capital requirement for the stand-alone health insurance companies.

Drug cos may be allowed to fix prices
The new Pharmaceutical Pricing Policy may give companies more flexibility in fixing prices. Instead of the National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA) fixing the prices of certain drugs based on the cost of the raw materials, the companies may be allowed to do so. However, they would have to file their pricing structure with the Authority.

Package to compensate CST loss on the anvil
The Finance Minister, Mr P. Chidambaram, is likely to unveil in his Budget speech a compensation package to the States for the revenue losses that would arise from the proposed Central Sales Tax (CST) ceiling rate reduction from four per cent to two per cent.

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2626



EASY

ACROSS
2. 'Denver boot' (5)
5. Short broad-headed nail (4)
7. Substance of trees (4)
8. A sham (8)
9. French Mister (8)
11. At what time (4)
12. A bringing back from unconsciousness (13)
15. Imperfection (4)
17. To steep, soften in liquid (8)
19. Unchanging (8)
21. Haricot (4)
22. Employed (4)
23. Linger, hang behind (5)

DOWN
1. Start an argument (7)
2. Food brought back to be chewed again (3)
3. Forbidden fruit of the Garden of Eden (5)
4. White-faced buffoon in loose garb (7)
5. Foot digit (3)
6. Secret store (5)
10. Wife of a brave (5)
11. Irrigate (5)
13. Face-powder case (7)
14. Gross offence (7)
16. Big cats (5)
18. Provide food for (5)
20. Tristful (3)
21. Coastal inlet (3)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS
2. A heap of potatoes may stop the motorist moving (5)
5. Change a course of food generally (4)
7. A lot of trees would sound like this (4)
8. Ten might creep around in make-believe (8)
9. Mr French was the king's eldest brother (8)
11. What do you say to limiting your drink consumption? (4)
12. Bringing of one back to consciousness in cruise station upset (13)
15. Defect to Florida West (4)
17. Soak it for the cream tea to be prepared (8)
19. That it is a fixed mathematical quantity is true (8)
21. If one hasn't got a pulse one must be ... broke! (4)
22. To get accustomed to its not being new (4)
23. Stay behind, looking black (5)

DOWN
1. Show it's true it's about all right to harass one (7)
2. It gives copper starting duty something to chew over (3)
3. Fruit that gave Eve the pip (5)
4. White-faced clown one got porter to shift (7)
5. Lower front part starts taking over eclipse (3)
6. A hoard that gives Conservative leader some pain (5)
10. It's a brave wife who will complain loudly and unendingly (5)
11. Dilute it with one's tears (5)
13. Fitted closely together by mutual agreement (7)
14. Our great indignation at our gate getting broken (7)
16. The pride of those playing rugby for Britain (5)
18. Provide for such a cousin to be an intimate friend (5)
20. Is said, after one is lost, to be unhappy (3)
21. Reddish brown laurel (3)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2625

ACROSS 1. Wedding march 8. Overcome 9. Cola 11. Motto 12. Erratum 13. Nick 15. Arms 19. Ennoble 20. Racer 22. Look 23. Pitiless 24. Home from home

DOWN 2. Event 3. Doctor 4. Number 5. Rooster 6. Headmistress 7. Commonwealth 10. Fry 14. Conform 16. Ebb 17. Merino 18. Wraith 21. Cream

For BSE/NSE live quotes, scan the QR code or click the link https://bit.ly/2FpossK

CHENNAI
businessline.
FRIDAY - FEBRUARY 27 - 2026

QUICKLY.

Markets end flat as trading remains lacklustre

Mumbai: Markets closed virtually flat on Thursday, amid lackadaisical trading. The BSE monthly futures and options expiry-day jitters, persistent global uncertainty and weak banking and FMCG stocks kept bulls on the back foot — even as a last-hour recovery pulled the Nifty back from the day's lows. The Sensex ended at 82,248.61, down 27.46 points or 0.03 per cent, while the Nifty 50 settled at 25,496.55, gaining a marginal 14.05 points or 0.06 per cent. The session's intraday range on the Nifty was a tight 172 points, underscoring the absence of any strong directional trigger. OUR BUREAU

PNGS Reva Diamond IPO subscribed 1.23 times

New Delhi: The initial public offer of PNGS Reva Diamond Jewellery Ltd got subscribed 1.23 times on the final day of bidding on Thursday. The ₹380-crore IPO received bids for 70.32 lakh shares against 57.06 lakh shares on offer, as per NSE data. The portion for non-institutional investors fetched 1.54 times subscription, while the quota for Retail Individual Investors got subscribed 1.29 times. The Qualified Institutional Buyers category received 1.04 times the subscription. PNGS Reva Diamond Jewellery on Monday said it has raised nearly ₹171 crore from anchor investors. The company has fixed a price band of ₹367-386 per share. The IPO is entirely a fresh issue of equity shares with no offer for sale component. PTI

NSE reaching out to investment banks, law firms to speed up IPO process

ON FAST TRACK. Exchange seeks proposals from them to appoint intermediaries, say sources

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) has reached out to investment banks and legal firms for advisory roles for its long-awaited initial public offering, according to people familiar with the development.

Sources said the exchange has circulated requests for proposals (RFPs) to multiple investment banks and law firms as part of the process to appoint intermediaries for the share sale.

Firms have been asked to submit details on their credentials, track record and deal teams by the end of this month. Following this, shortlisted firms will make presentations and are expected to be finalised by mid-March, said two persons aware.

The move comes after NSE appointed Rothschild & Co as an independent adviser to help oversee the listing process earlier this month. The adviser is expected to evaluate proposals and help select lead bankers, legal counsel and other intermediaries.

MANDATE PITCH. Firms have been asked for details on credentials, track record and deal teams by the month-end REUTERS

IPO PREPARATIONS

The exchange has been preparing internally for the listing as soon as it receives the market regulator's no-objection certificate. Last month, the NSE set up a committee to oversee IPO-related activities. The panel is chaired by non-independent director Tablesh Pandey and includes Managing Director and CEO Ashishkumar Chauhan.

Separately, the bourse recently appointed Walker Chandiok & Co LLP as its statutory auditor for a five-year term, replacing Price Waterhouse & Co.

OFFER SIZE

Market estimates earlier suggested the IPO could raise around ₹22,700 crore, with roughly 4-4.5 per cent of the company's equity potentially being offered to the public.

NSE's listing plans had been stalled for several years due to regulatory and legal hurdles linked to past controversies. However, the process gained momentum after the Securities and Exchange Board of India granted a no-objection certificate for the IPO in January.

In the unlisted market, NSE shares have been trading around ₹2,035 apiece. The price has slipped about 1.9 per cent over the past month but remains higher by over 7 per cent compared with a year ago.

As of December 31, public shareholders collectively held about 64.45 per cent of the exchange, while the non-promoter, non-public category, largely trading members and their associates, accounted for 35.55 per cent.

When contacted, NSE said, "Pursuant to the NOC issued by SEBI, the board approved an initial public offering of the Company through an offer for sale on 6 February 2026. No further comments at this stage."

NSE chief moots qualifying norm for F&O traders

Our Bureau
Mumbai

India's derivatives market may need entry thresholds similar to those in global markets as participation widens and vulnerable investors slip into excessive speculation, said National Stock Exchange CEO Ashishkumar Chauhan on Thursday.

Speaking at the FIA conference, the NSE chief said derivatives will become increasingly important as tools for risk management, even as the regulators may need to step in to protect smaller investors.

RISK MARKETS

"Because of technology bringing in many other changes, including geopolitical shifts and changes in financial markets very rapidly, over the next 20, 30 or even 50 years, the need for markets which allow management and transfer of risk, derivatives markets, will be needed much more," he said.

But growth cannot come at the cost of widespread speculative losses among those with limited financial capacity.

"A developing country like India cannot allow over-speculation by the lower strata of the economy. Hence, more and more regulations will come from the governments, regulators and exchanges to curb over-speculation till the perception continues," Chauhan said.

He suggested that India could consider a minimum qualifying framework for derivatives participation, similar to norms in countries such as Singapore and the United States.

"Most countries have already adopted this regime, and it is high time India adopts it so that the protection required for the lower strata is adequately provided and government objectives are fulfilled," he added.

MFs told to value gold and silver ETF with spot Comex prices from April

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Capital market regulator has directed mutual funds to value their physical gold and silver using the polled prices, which are used for settling derivatives contracts of recognised stock exchanges.

AMFI, in consultation with SEBI, will prescribe a uniform policy and the new valuation norms will come into effect from April 1.

As per the existing regulatory framework, physical gold and silver which are held by gold and silver exchange traded funds (ETFs) are valued at AM fixing prices of the

London Bullion Market Association.

ADJUSTING PRICES

The final valuations are arrived at after adjusting the LBMA prices with necessary metric and currency conversions, addition of transportation costs, customs duty, applicable taxes and levies and factoring in notional premium or discount to arrive at domestic valuations.

After discussions in the Mutual Fund Advisory Committee (MFAC), public consultation and discussion with all stakeholders, it was deliberated that polled spot prices published by recognised stock exchanges may be used for the valuation of gold and silver held by mutual fund schemes.

As stock exchanges are subject to transparency and compliance requirements under the regulatory framework, using the spot price published by such regulated entities shall lead to a valuation reflective of domestic market conditions and also ensure uniformity in the valuation practices, said SEBI.

SEBI introduces lifecycle funds, discontinues retirement, children funds under MF framework

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has opened a new scheme category 'Life Cycle' funds with a clear limit on investments in equity and debt.

The equity investment of the life cycle funds will be higher the debt when the investor is young.

GLIDE PATH

Life Cyle scheme will follow a glide path strategy based investing across various asset classes Equity, Debt, InvITs, ETCDs, Gold and Silver ETF.

SEBI has discontinued solutions-oriented scheme category, which includes children's and retirement funds with immediate effect. Existing schemes in this category will stop all subscriptions.

> **The regulator also streamlined the** launch of thematic funds and ensured there are no major overlaps

Existing schemes will be merged with any other scheme having similar asset allocation and risk profile with prior approval from SEBI. Sunil Subramaniam, CEO of independent think-tank Sense and Simplicity, said life cycle funds has a prescribed equity and debt investment limit varying according to the investors age.

The regulator has also streamlined the launch of thematic funds and ensured that there are no major overlaps. The sector-based debt thematic fund will also benefit informed investors looking business-specific debt exposure, he added.

SEBI has also introduced sectoral-based debt fund with 80 per cent exposure to specific sectors. MFs have been allowed to offer both Value and Contra funds subject to the condition that scheme portfolio overlap between the two schemes will not be over 50 per cent.

Aditya Agarwal, Co-founder of Wealthy.in, a wealth management platform for MF distributors, said value and contra funds exist across different AMCs and some historical comparisons showed significant portfolio overlap in some cases — as high as 70–80 per cent — despite being distinct styles.

The capping portfolio overlap between the two at 50 per cent, will ensure clear differentiation in strategy and more meaningful product choices for investors, he added.

'Shift from physical to financial assets signals a maturing wealth landscape'

V Sajeev Kumar
Kochi

India's wealth accumulation pattern has undergone a decisive transformation over the past five years, with investors increasingly moving away from traditional physical assets, such as real estate and gold, towards financial instruments, particularly equities, according to Arpita Vinay, Senior Managing Director and CEO of Spark Capital PWM.

Speaking to *businessline* on the sidelines of the inauguration of the company's office in Kochi, she said the growing participation of retail investors in equity markets, reflected in sustained mutual fund inflows, underscores the increasing maturity of India's financial ecosystem.

"Earlier, wealth creation was dominated by real estate, followed by gold. Today, equities are emerging as a preferred asset class," she said.

Arpita Vinay, Senior MD and CEO of Spark Capital PWM

INVESTMENT HORIZON

"Unlike real estate and gold, equities offer transparency and liquidity; however, to fully benefit from the long-term compounding that equities offer, the investment horizon needs to be at least 3-5 years," she added.

She pointed out that India's organised wealth management industry remains largely concentrated among affluent individuals, high-net-worth individuals (HNIs) and ultra-HNIs. The size of the organised segment is estimated around ₹25 lakh crore, driven in part by inter-generational wealth transfer. Spark Capital PWM, which currently manages assets worth approximately ₹40,000 crore, has set an ambitious target to scale up its assets under management (AUM) to ₹1 lakh crore over the next three years.

"Our integrated proposition, combining investment banking and wealth management, enables us to generate revenues and deepen client engagement," she said.

Referring to Kerala, Vinay said the State stands out as one of India's most globally connected wealth markets.

"NRIs represent a major growth opportunity for us, which led to the establishment of our international office in Dubai," she said.

Standard Chartered Securities bets on consumption to boost economy

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Standard Chartered Securities believes consumption as a theme will be the key driver to boost the economy in the coming days with the government's focus on putting more money in the hands of consumers.

The RBI has already cut repo rates by 100 basis points, the GST overhaul will reduce the burden on consumers and the Finance Ministry has already provided tax relief. In addition, the Centre has announced the Eighth Pay Commission, which will benefit 30-40 million State and Central government employees. These measures will leave about ₹6 lakh crore in the hands of consumers and provide a significant boost to the economy, he added.

FMCG, QSR SECTORS

Gaurav J Dua, ED & CIO, Standard Chartered Securities, said the rub-off effect of

Gaurav J Dua, ED & CIO, Standard Chartered Securities

monetary and fiscal policy measures are already playing out with the rising volume growth in the FMCG and QSR sectors. The demand for premium products across sectors is visible, which is expected to strengthen further as the per capita income rises to $4,000 by 2030, he said.

Despite the 25-30 per cent decline in small-cap indices, there are enough opportunities as some stocks have started to look good now.

"We normally limit our investment horizon to Nifty-500 stocks, because that is the kind of clientele that we have, who want to have a balanced approach and they're happy with 2-5 per cent alpha over Nifty."

"We have the top 100-150 stocks forming about 60 per cent of the portfolio, with the rest in mid- and small-caps. I think that gives you the right balanced approach," he said.

IT WILL EVOLVE

On the recent crash in the IT sector, Dua said the IT industry had transformed itself multiple times, from enterprise software package implementation to quality assurance to infrastructure management, cloud computing and digital transformation. Standard Chartered Securities has been advising its clients to hold back IT stocks and not exit in panic. He noted that the oversold position currently was worse than even during the global financial crisis. He believes there will be exit opportunities down the line and there will also be stocks that will gain from the transition, he added.

BROKER'S CALL.

SBI Securities

BAJAJ CONSUMER CARE (BUY)
Target: ₹445
CMP: ₹402.75

Bajaj Consumer Care Ltd (BCCL), part of the Shishir Bajaj group, has a dominant market position with its brand Bajaj Almond Drops Hair Oil (ADHO) commanding over 63 per cent market share in the light hair oil (LHO) category.

Its products are now available in over 4.3 million outlets across India. Project Arohan is BCCL's strategic Route-to-Market transformation initiative, designed to modernise its distribution network and expand direct retail reach. BCCL targets to increase direct outlet reach by 10 per cent annually for the next four-five years. It has now diversified its portfolio to a broader hair and coconut oil space with the launch of Bajaj 100% Pure Coconut Oil in FY22, which has now captured about 2 per cent market share in India. Further, in February 2025, BCCL acquired Vishal Personal Care (owner of Banjara's brand), strengthening its position in the South Indian skincare & hair oil market. BCCL reported robust Q3FY26 numbers with Revenue/EBITDA/PAT growing 30.6 per cent/113.9 per cent/83.2 per cent, respectively. EBITDA margin expanded about 710 basis points, on the back of strategic pricing and mix improvements. At the current value, the stock trades at FY26E/27E Bloomberg consensus PE of 29.4x/25.5x, respectively, which looks reasonable given its dominant market position in the LHO category, strategic product portfolio diversification and aggressive direct reach expansion through its Project Arohan.

Motilal Oswal Research

POLYCAB (BUY)
Target: ₹9,600
CMP: ₹8,504

We met the management of Polycab to discuss business trends in the Cables & Wires (C&W), FMEG and EPC segments, raw material price trends, key strategic initiatives and channel inventory.

Here are the key highlights of the discussion: Channel inventory, which had risen to 40-45 days in Q3FY26 (vs normal 21-24 days), normalised within the first 20 days of January 2026 amid strong demand recovery. The company has now passed on the entire cost increase (vs about 70 per cent in Q3), driving margin recovery in Q4-FY26. It has gained meaningful market share in 9MFY26, growing well ahead of industry and it has reiterated its 1.5x industry growth target till FY30 under Project Spring. Real estate demand remains strong, while affordable housing and the government's City Economic Region push should further support wire demand. Unorganised players account for about 40 per cent of wires, and Polycab sees limited impact from new entrants. The company holds about 30 per cent share in organised wires, aided by a strong network of dealers and distributors, structured loyalty programmes, and 34 warehouses enabling 24-hour replenishment. Exports form about 6 per cent of revenue. We remain structurally positive on Polycab, supported by its leadership in the C&W segment, a favourable industry outlook, a strong balance sheet and healthy return ratios, providing visibility for steady growth and capital efficiency. We reiterate our Buy rating with a TP of ₹9,600.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

Samvardhana Motherson International: BUY

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

The stock of Samvardhana Motherson International has been in an uptrend since April last year.

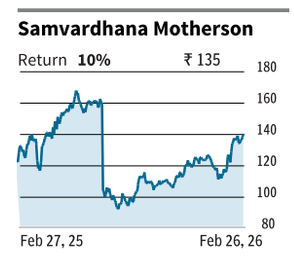
While the recent leg of the uptrend began a month ago, the scrip was moving in a sideway direction in the recent sessions.

But the chart shows that the stock has rebounded well from a support at ₹129 early this week, where a rising trendline support also lies.

The price action shows good positive momentum and in the near-term, the price is likely to rise to ₹150.

Therefore, participants can go long now at ₹135 and add longs if the price dips to ₹130. Place stop-loss at ₹125. When the price hits ₹142, trail the stop-loss to ₹135.

Tighten the stop-loss to ₹140 when the stock touches ₹146. Book profits at ₹150.



Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading.

Day trading guide

25637 » Nifty 50 Futures

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
25600	25500	25730	25800	Consider buying on a rally above 25730; stop-loss at 25600.

₹898 » HDFC Bank

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
880	870	903	915	Breaches a key support; go short with a stop-loss at 915.

₹1289 » Infosys

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1285	1265	1320	1350	Go short if the stock slips below 1285; stop-loss at 1300.

₹318 » ITC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
313	310	321	325	Chart shows a bearish bias; go short with stop-loss at 325.

₹280 » ONGC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
276	272	285	290	Stock likely to rally; consider buying with stop-loss at 276.

₹1405 » Reliance Ind.

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1385	1365	1420	1435	Stock shows a bearish bias; sell with a stop-loss at 1435.

₹1209 » SBI

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1188	1150	1232	1240	Buy the stock when price rises above 1220; stop-loss at 1180.

₹2647 » TCS

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2565	2520	2670	2740	Go short if the stock slips below 2620; stop-loss at 2680.

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers ▲ 14.05 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
Reliance Ind	1406.80	12.29	19.47	8.17
Bharti Airtel	1929.60	9.90	29.70	4.63
State Bank	1209.50	8.56	12.90	4.32
Bharat Elec	449.05	7.66	55.05	1.38
ICICI Bank	1404.90	6.89	17.74	8.63
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1104.60	5.75	22.72	1.33
Eicher Motors	8190.00	5.50	41.93	0.97
Sun Pharma	1785.70	4.99	39.12	1.63
Tata Motors PV	391.55	4.45	53.25	0.70
Maruti Suzuki	15213.00	4.12	32.03	1.72
TCS	2647.70	4.12	19.97	2.33
Max Healthcare	1109.90	3.56	76.08	0.71
Adani Ports	1550.60	3.54	28.59	0.98
ONGC	280.10	2.26	7.84	0.94
Dr Reddys Lab	1319.30	1.71	19.94	0.69
Hind Unilever	2383.30	1.64	55.69	1.82
Tata Steel	215.52	1.60	29.50	1.53
Titan	4342.60	1.59	80.89	1.54
Cipla	1358.10	1.48	24.20	0.66
Hindalco	941.30	1.24	13.16	1.17
JSW Steel	1280.60	1.15	40.33	1.04
SBI Life	2082.80	0.91	85.14	0.80
Bajaj Auto	10110.00	0.32	31.78	0.96
Tech Mahindra	1361.80	0.00	29.06	0.74
Apollo Hosp	7775.00	-0.18	59.92	0.69
HDFC Life	734.00	-0.29	83.65	0.68
Wipro	201.08	-0.53	15.82	0.49
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	256.15	-0.58	101.41	0.72
Kotak Bank	424.55	-0.65	22.46	2.69
IntGlobeAvi	4933.50	-0.69	59.40	0.96
Infosys	1289.10	-0.77	18.67	3.89
NestleIndia	1318.00	-0.85	77.92	0.81
Adani Enter	2216.40	-0.87	18.10	0.50
Bajaj Finserv	2041.30	-1.00	16.99	1.00
HCL Tech	1373.50	-1.09	22.63	1.25
Grasim Ind	2863.50	-1.25	20.57	0.94
M&M	3484.60	-1.31	25.63	2.68
TataConsumerProduct	1159.50	-1.83	77.97	0.65
Asian Paints	2394.90	-2.13	58.75	0.93
Coal India	433.50	-2.54	8.98	0.85
UltraTech Cement	12937.00	-2.70	49.75	1.32
ITC	318.30	-3.07	19.26	2.64
L&T	4286.50	-3.09	31.07	4.33
NTPC	381.90	-3.12	14.92	1.56
Trent Ltd.	3856.00	-3.21	84.62	0.74
PowerGrid Corp	303.25	-3.97	18.17	1.18
Axis Bank	1395.50	-4.72	16.40	3.44
Bajaj Finance	1012.95	-4.72	34.40	2.31
Eternal Ltd.	246.50	-5.83	1029.79	1.52
HDFC Bank	898.60	-30.20	17.85	11.83

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers ▲ 229.25 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
Vedanta	737.45	49.12	17.40	5.31
Bank Of Baroda	324.45	47.87	8.54	2.56
Indian Oilcorp	186.47	38.56	7.14	2.96
Divis Lab	6474.00	29.93	69.33	3.49
Bpcl	386.00	28.79	6.80	3.18
Samvardmothersoninternatl	135.31	27.58	39.24	2.55
Cg Power & Ind Sol	726.75	27.50	103.16	2.12
Solar Industries	13755.00	21.63	81.53	1.42
Varun Beverages	460.45	18.89	50.86	2.68
Pidilitind	1516.90	17.98	66.71	2.00
Tvs Motor Cmp	3954.20	15.64	61.52	3.94
Zyduslifesciences	938.50	14.15	18.79	1.00
Jsw Energy	498.65	13.85	33.48	1.14
Hindustaneronautics	4008.90	13.61	30.14	3.23
Adani Energy Solutions	1023.95	11.40	51.60	1.51
Indian Hotels Co.	680.95	11.20	44.78	2.54
Adani Power	141.34	9.47	24.12	2.37
Info Edge I	1051.00	9.09	40.44	1.73
Icici Lombard Gic	1946.50	5.23	34.61	2.00
Bosch	36740.00	4.42	39.31	1.35
Mazagoan Dock	2251.70	3.17	37.74	0.73
Godrej Consumer	1239.20	2.17	69.61	2.12
Ambuja Cements	512.15	1.92	25.72	1.33
Adanigreenenergy	965.95	1.66	85.73	1.26
Rural Elec	354.10	0.37	5.41	1.88
Gail (India)	169.96	-0.32	12.99	1.95
Canara Bank	158.88	-0.51	7.83	2.28
Bajaj Housing Finance	87.57	-0.59	29.45	0.35
Punjab Natl Bank	130.48	-0.62	8.39	1.91
Dlf	610.80	-0.77	34.14	1.66
Lic	870.85	-2.66	10.78	0.82
Havells	1413.70	-2.95	59.80	1.51
Siemens	3336.90	-3.69	74.95	1.25
Tata Power	380.40	-4.28	24.27	2.71
Shree Cement	26745.00	-4.81	53.73	1.52
Hyundai Motor India	2194.20	-5.26	30.79	1.33
Abb India	6133.00	-5.43	77.07	1.37
Torrent Pharma	4399.80	-5.99	65.54	1.95
Jindal Steel	1261.00	-6.17	63.80	2.00
Indian Railway Finance Corp	103.23	-7.13	19.25	0.78
Britannia Ind	6137.00	-7.43	61.17	3.07
Cholamandalamin&Fin	1748.10	-8.12	30.43	3.14
Macrotech Developers	1011.50	-9.28	30.20	1.21
Avenuesuper	3865.60	-9.98	87.82	2.42
Hindus Zinc	609.80	-12.03	21.83	1.12
Power Finance	420.60	-13.11	4.16	2.60
Ltimindtree	4504.00	-15.30	28.27	1.77
Siemens Energy India	2920.30	-20.56	88.04	1.10
United Spirits	1388.80	-21.00	58.73	1.74
Bajaj Holdings	10951.00	-27.93	13.60	2.01

Pts: Impact on index movement

Banks' G-Sec portfolio rises at slower clip amid credit growth

POOR PACE. Loan demand moderates banks' appetite for additional G-Sec holdings

K Ram Kumar
Mumbai

Banks' investment in Central government securities (G-Secs) and State government securities (SGS) grew at a slower clip of 3 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) as on January 31, 2026, amid credit growth picking up momentum.

The aforementioned development also comes in the backdrop of deposit growth lagging credit growth and the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) conducting a series of open market operation (OMO) purchase auction of G-Secs to provide liquidity in the banking system.

TIMELY MOVE. The RBI has been conducting OMO purchase auction of G-Secs to provide liquidity in the banking system

PICKS UP PACE

Banks' investment in G-Secs and SGS grew at a higher clip of 11 per cent y-o-y as on January 24, 2025. The differential between credit growth and deposit growth widened to 198 basis points as on January 31, 2026, from 109 basis points as on January 24, 2025.

DEPOSIT GROWTH

As on January 31, 2026, deposit growth at 12.42 per cent y-o-y (10.20 per cent as on January 24, 2025) was lower than credit growth of 14.40 per cent (11.29 per cent). The OMO purchase auction of G-Secs conducted by the central bank is also resulting in the overall portfolio of these securities gradually coming down.

Considering that banks have to park 18 per cent of the deposit they mobilise in statutory liquidity ratio (SLR) securities (G-Secs and SGS), they should have invested ₹5,05,251 crore in these securities during the January 24, 2025, to January 31, 2026, period. However, they invested only ₹1,96,804 crore, per RBI data. Venkatakrishnan Srinivasan, Founder & Managing Partner, Rockfort Fincap LLP, observed that strong credit growth had reduced incremental demand for government securities.

"As banks channelise funds into loans amid healthy credit demand, their appetite for additional G-Sec holdings moderates. Loans typically offer higher returns than sovereign bonds, and expanding credit absorbs liquidity that might otherwise have flowed into G-Secs," he said. V Rama Chandra Reddy, Head–Treasury, Karur Vysya Bank, attributed the slower pace of growth in banks' investment portfolio to the sale of excess SLR securities (G-Secs) at OMO purchase auctions. This way, the RBI is helping banks bridge the gap between credit and deposit growth.

Stage set for *businessline* Agri & Commodity Summit today

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

The Hindu businessline is back with the fifth edition of the *businessline* Agri & Commodity Summit 2026, to be held on February 27 at The Leela Palace in New Delhi. It will commemorate the 'Year of the Woman Farmer'.

WOMAN FARMER

The United Nations has declared 2026 as the 'International Year of the Woman Farmer (IYWF 2026)'.

Led by the Food and Agriculture Organisation (FAO), this initiative highlights the vital contributions of women in agriculture, aiming to close gender gaps, enhance access to resources and boost recognition for their role in food security.

Keeping this in mind, the summit has been themed 'Women: The Pillar of Rural Economy'.

EVENT SPONSORS

The presenting sponsor is Nabard, while associate sponsors are Yara India, Indofil Industries Ltd, Bayer, HURL and Markfed Punjab. The banking partner is State Bank of India and media partner is Agri Network Consultancy.

At a time when India is recognising the central role women play in sustaining agriculture, strengthening rural incomes and driving commodity markets, *businessline* is the first national platform to formally celebrate and shape this narrative.

The summit will be inaugurated by Devesh Chaturvedi, Secretary, Department of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare.

NABARD
Presents
the hindu businessline.
AGRI & COMMODITY SUMMIT 2026
Associate Partners
YARA | indofil | BAYER | HURL | Markfed Punjab
Banking Partner: SBI
Media Partner: ANC

A special address will be delivered by Shaji KV, Chairman, Nabard.

As India enters the 'Year of the Woman Farmer', the summit will move the conversation from participation to power, from labour to leadership and from inclusion to investment. The aim of the summit is to:

- Spotlight empowered women across the agricultural value chain
- Address funding and credit access challenges
- Present inspiring stories from the field
- Explore women's participation in bullion, commodities and wealth creation

VARIOUS SESSIONS

A session, titled 'Silent Architects of the Rural Economy', will see panelists Sarbani Bose, CoE Lead, Gender Equality, PRADAN; Chhavi Rajawat, former sarpanch, Soda village, Rajasthan; Sanjiv Kanwar, Managing Director, Yara South Asia and Country Head, Yara India; and Kalyani Singh, entrepreneur, Better Life Farming Alliance, holding a discussion with Shishir Sinha, Associate Editor, *The Hindu businessline*, on the the real story behind the journey.

As India enters the 'Year of the Woman Farmer', the summit will move the conversation from participation to power, from labour to leadership and from inclusion to investment

Another session, 'Seeds of Funding', will have panellists such as Anupam Gupta, CBO, Kissandhan; Ravi Kumar, Lead-Smallholder Farming, South-East Asia, Bayer AG; and Ajay Kumar Jha, Deputy General Manager (Product Development and Marketing), State Bank of India, conversing with Subramani Ra Mancombu, Consulting Editor, *The Hindu businessline*.

'Precious Metals: Beyond Aam Aadmi's Reach' will see *businessline*'s Lokeshwarri SK, Data Editor, in conversation with Kavita Chacko, Research Head, India, World Gold Council; Jateen N Trivedi, V-P, Commodity and Currency Research, LKP Securities; and Tarun Kanwar, Director, Navrattan Jewellers, Delhi.

Besides these, there will a session, titled 'From Field Work to Entrepreneurship', in which Lakhpati Didis' Aruna Debbarma from Tripura and Vaishali Ghuge from Aurangabad will share their stories with Richa Mishra, Resident Editor, Hyderabad, *The Hindu businessline*. Ghuge works for the Swayam Shikshan Prayog organisation.

The grand finale will be a fireside chat featuring Brahmani Nara, Executive Director, Heritage Foods, in conversation with Raghuvir Srinivasan, Editor, *The Hindu businessline*.

Scan the QR code for the live stream or visit https://thbl.news/AGS2026LS

Bitcoin may rebound towards $70,000 as ETF inflows hit highest since January

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

The crypto market recovered over the past 24 hours, driven by structural demand and short-term positioning. Bitcoin rebounded from the $62,000 demand zone towards $68,000-$70,000, supported by $257 million in net inflows into spot Bitcoin ETFs, the largest since January.

Riya Sehgal, Research Analyst, Delta Exchange, highlighted that over $400 million in short liquidation added upside momentum.

"Improving global risk appetite, stabilising bond yields and expectations of more accommodative financial conditions support liquidity-sensitive assets, including cryptos. Bitcoin faces resistance between $69,000 and $72,900; a breakout could target $74,000, while rejection may lead to near-term consolidation or a pullback toward the $66,000 support," she said.

Meanwhile, Vikram Subburaj, CEO of Giottus, observed that Bitcoin rose roughly 3.5 per cent over 24 hours.

Intraday trade briefly approached the $70,000 handle, a price point that remains the immediate overhead resistance.

"Technically, $70,000 is the first psychological barrier. A sustained break could reopen the path towards the low $70,000s. This is a supply zone tested earlier this month. On the downside, $65,000 remains the near-term pivot. A failure would expose $63,000, with deeper structural support costing around $60,000. This level has repeatedly attracted demand in February," he said.

IOB officers defer March 2 strike after conciliation meet

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

The proposed all-India strike by the Indian Overseas Bank Officers' Association (IOBOA), scheduled for March 2, has been called off following a long conciliation meet before the Central Labour Commissioner on Wednesday.

It has been decided that the association and the bank's management should solve it by way of a bipartite meet on or before March 10.

The IOBOA had earlier issued a strike notice, calling for the implementation of a series of demands to improve the working culture at the public sector bank. This was then taken up for conciliation, and a meeting was held between members of the management, IOBOA and the labour authorities on February 25.

Bipartite talks will be taken up on or before March 10

'NOT POLICY MATTERS'

According to the minutes of the meeting viewed by *businessline*, the association and the bank management presented their submissions.

The Department of Financial Services and the Indian Banks' Association stated that the issues raised were not policy matters in nature, and thus should be resolved through bilateral discussions.

The conciliation officer also directed the bank's management to convene a meeting with the association on or before March 10. The minutes of such a meeting are also to be forwarded to the Chief Labour Commissioner (Central) for review, they added.

MUTUAL AGREEMENT

At the meeting, the officers' association maintained that several of its demands directly impact service conditions, working environment and work-life balance, and called for a standard operating procedure to be formulated to address aspects such as end-of-day blocking, contacting officers on holidays and convening review meetings.

Both parties mutually agreed to the following points, including that the IOBOA office will function normally from February 26, adhering to mutually agreed norms; no in-absentia transfers should be issued until the bipartite meeting is held; and that officers will submit replies to explanations sought by the management within the stipulated time.

RBI nod for SBI MF's stake buy in Bandhan Bank

Our Bureau
Kolkata

The Reserve Bank of India has accorded its approval to SBI Mutual Fund to acquire up to 9.99 per cent in private sector lender Bandhan Bank. The approval has been given pursuant to the information furnished by the fund house to the RBI, Bandhan Bank said in a stock exchange filing on Thursday.

"Reserve Bank of India vide its letter dated February 25, 2026, accorded its approval to SBI Mutual Fund to acquire aggregate holding of up to 9.99 per cent of the paid-up share capital or voting rights in Bandhan Bank," it said.

The approval is subject to compliance with the relevant provisions of different acts. "The RBI has also conveyed that if the applicant fails to acquire major shareholding within a period of one year from the date of its letter, this approval shall stand cancelled," stated the filing.

Ageas Federal Life plans to grow agency strength three-fold to reduce dependence on banca channel

Mithun Dasgupta
Kolkata

Ageas Federal Life Insurance plans to bring down the bancassurance contribution to its premium income from around 75 per cent at present to around 60 per cent in the next three years, when the insurer aims to grow the agency strength by over three-fold.

The life insurance company is a joint venture of Belgium's largest insurer Ageas and private sector lender Federal Bank.

"We had one channel and bank partner specific bancassurance. Now, we are trying to create other channels. For instance, we have a huge business plan in terms of growing our agency, growing our direct sales, growing our digital and also coming up with one or two other channels," said Ageas Federal Life Insurance MD & CEO Jude Gomes.

BANCA CHANNEL

At present, 75 per cent of its business in terms of annualised premium equivalent (APE) comes from the bancassurance channel, down from over 90 per cent 15 months ago.

"We want to really de-risk our investment and our production. While the Federal Bank [contribution to premium income] will grow, others will grow faster so that we can take the foundation pillars to the next level. If you look at the industry, about 60 per cent is bancassurance. So, we will be hovering somewhere around 60 per cent in the next three years," Gomes told *businessline*. The insurance company has 7,000 agents and plans to grow the agency strength by more than three-fold in the next three years. The insurer's goal is to be in the top 10 in the life insurance industry in the next three years and triple its business during the same time.

यूको बैंक UCO BANK
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)
Head Office-I Resources Department
2nd Floor, 10 BTM Sarini, Kolkata-700001
REQUEST FOR PROCESS
RefNo: UCO/RESOURCES/RFP/05/2025-26 & UCO/RESOURCES/RFP/06/2025-26
UCO Bank invites following tenders through GEM Portal:
Request for Proposal (RFP) for Selection of Vendor for Group Personal Accident Insurance& other group based Insurance covers (Group Cyber Insurance / Group Critical Illness/ Group Cancer Benefit / Hospital Cash Scheme) and Group Term Life Insurance (GTLI) for Account Holders of Select Deposit Schemes of UCO Bank For any details, please refer to https://www.uco.bank.in & https://gem.gov.in
Date: 27.02.2026 Deputy General Manager (Resources Department)
सम्मान आपके विश्वास का | Honours Your Trust

Government of Kerala
Published Tenders from 23-02-2026 to 25-02-2026
Hydrographic Survey Wing
Tender ID: 2026_HSW_840281_1 * Chief Hydrographer * Purchase of Dighi (GRP Boats) for Hydrographic Survey Wing * Closing Date: 05-Mar-2026 * PAC: Rs2000000
Visit https://etenders.kerala.gov.in for more details.
Ro.No:23-25/Feb/2026/PRD/(N)15

AMARA RAJA | ENERGY & MOBILITY
Amara Raja Energy & Mobility Limited
(Formerly known as Amara Raja Batteries Limited)
CIN: L31402AP1985PLC005305
Registered office: Renigunta-Cuddapah Road, Karakambadi, Tirupati, Andhra Pradesh, India-517520
Tel: 91 (877) 226 5000 Fax: 91 (877) 228 5600 | CIN: L31402AP1985PLC005305
E-mail id: investorservices@amararaja.com | Website: www.amararajaeandm.com

NOTICE OF POSTAL BALLOT, INFORMATION ON REMOTE E-VOTING AND OTHER INFORMATION

NOTICE is hereby given that pursuant to Section 108, 110 and other applicable provisions, if any, of the Companies Act, 2013 ("the Act"), read with Rule 20 and Rule 22 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 ("the Rules"), read with Circulars i.e. (General Circular No. 14/2020 dated April 8, 2020, General Circular No. 17/2020 dated April 13, 2020 and General Circular No. 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025, issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs and SEBI Circulars issued in this regard), Regulation 44 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ("Listing Regulations"), Secretarial Standard on General Meetings ("SS-2") issued by the Institute of Company Secretaries of India and other applicable laws, rules and regulations (including any statutory modification(s) or re-enactment(s) thereof for the time being in force), the special business for re-appointment of Mr. Annush Ramasamy (DIN: 01810872) as an Independent Director of the Company for the second consecutive term of five years w.e.f June 12, 2026 till June 11, 2031, is proposed for the approval of the Members of Amara Raja Energy & Mobility Limited ("the Company") by means of Postal Ballot through remote e-voting as set out in the Postal Ballot Notice ("Notice") dated February 11, 2026.

The Notice indicating, inter-alia, the process and manner of remote e-voting, has been sent to the members on Thursday, February 26, 2026, in electronic mode only, to those shareholders whose e-mail addresses are registered with the RTA or Company or made available to the Depositories as on Friday, February 20, 2026 i.e., Cut-off date. A person who is not a shareholder as on the cut-off date shall treat this notice for information. Further, a letter providing web-link and QR code for accessing the Notice, including the exact path, is being sent to those members who have not registered their email addresses with the Company.

The Notice along with explanatory statement thereto are available on Company's website https://amararajaeandm.com/Investors/annual-general-meetings and also on the websites of the stock exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com respectively.

The Company seeks consent of the members by way of Special Resolution on the matter mentioned in the Notice through remote e-voting only. The Company has engaged the services of National Securities Depositories Limited (NSDL) for the purpose of providing remote e-voting facility to all its members. The detailed instructions on remote e-voting are provided as a part of the Notice which the members are requested to read carefully before casting their vote.

Particulars	Event Dates/Particulars
Cut-Off Date for eligibility to vote	**Friday, February 20, 2026** Members holding shares either in physical form or in dematerialized form as on Cut-off date may cast their vote by remote e-voting. The voting rights of the Members shall be in proportion to their share of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company as on the Cut-Off date.
Remote e-voting will commence on	**Friday, February 27, 2026** (9:00 A.M. IST)
Remote e-voting will end on	**Saturday, March 28, 2026** (5:00 P.M. IST) The remote e-voting shall be disabled by NSDL thereafter. Once the vote on a resolution is cast by member, he / she / it shall not be allowed to change their vote subsequently.

ALL MEMBERS ARE FURTHER INFORMED THAT,

A. The instructions for remote e-voting and manner in which the user ID and passwords can be obtained by members whose email address are not registered with Company/Depository to enable them to cast their vote and register their email address, are provided in the notes to the Notice.

B. The Company has appointed Mr. R Sridharan (Membership No. FCS 4775 and CP No. 3239) from M/s R. Sridharan & Associates, Company Secretaries as a Scrutinizer or failing him Ms. Srinidhi Sridharan, (Membership No. FCS 12510 and CP No. 17990) from M/s Srinidhi Sridharan & Associates, Company Secretaries, as the Scrutinizer to scrutinize the e-voting process in a fair and transparent manner and shall submit a report to the Company after completion of Scrutiny.

C. The results of the Postal Ballot will be declared within two working days from the conclusion of the remote e-voting i.e., Wednesday, April 1, 2026 and the Company would submit the same to the Stock Exchanges where the shares of the Company are listed. The aforesaid result along with the Scrutinizer's report would also be displayed on the Company's website www.amararajaeandm.com and on the website of NSDL www.evoting.nsdl.com immediately after the results are declared.

D. Members who have not registered/ updated their email address and hence have not received the aforesaid notice are requested to register/ update their email address by sending a request to the Registrar and Share Transfer Agents of the Company i.e. Cameo Corporate Services Limited or to the Company at https://wisdom.cameoindia.com/ or investor@cameoindia.com or to the Company at investorservices@amararaja.com respectively providing the following details to obtain user-id and password for remote e-voting:

Mode of Holding:	Details to be provided:
Physical	Folio No., Name of shareholder, scanned copy of the share certificate (front and back), PAN (self-attested scanned copy of PAN card), AADHAR (self-attested scanned copy of Aadhar Card)
Demat	DP ID and Client ID (16-digit DPID + CLID or 16-digit beneficiary ID), Name of shareholder, client master or copy of Consolidated Account statement, PAN (self-attested scanned copy of PAN card), AADHAR (self-attested scanned copy of Aadhar Card)

Any Queries/Grievances connected with facility for E-voting:

Company	NSDL	Registrar and Share Transfer Agent
Write a mail at investorservices@amararaja.com	Refer to the FAQs for Shareholders and e-voting user manual for Shareholders available at the, download section of https://www.evoting.nsdl.com Contact NSDL, 4th Floor, 'A' Wing, Trade World, Kamala Mills Compound, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel, Mumbai 400 013. Email: evoting@nsdl.co.in or at Toll free no: 1800 1020 990	Cameo Corporate Services Limited, Unit: Amara Raja Energy & Mobility Limited Subramanian Building, No.1, Club House Road, Chennai – 600002, Tamil Nadu, India Tel: 91 44 28460390, Portal: wisdom.cameoindia.com; Email ID: investor@cameoindia.com Website: www.cameoindia.com

For Amara Raja Energy & Mobility Limited
(Formerly known as Amara Raja Batteries Limited)
Sd/-
Vikas Sabharwal
Company Secretary & Vice President - Legal

Place: Hyderabad
Date: February 26, 2026

CHENNAI
businessline.
FRIDAY - FEBRUARY 27 - 2026

QUICKLY.

Authorised Aadhaar centres on Google Maps soon

New Delhi: The Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI) and tech giant Google have teamed up to enable the display of authorised Aadhaar centres on Google Maps, a move that aims to enhance ease of access and convenience for residents across the country. PTI

JSW Motors, Tata IIS to build tech talent pipeline

New Delhi: JSW Motors said it has partnered with the Tata Indian Institute of Skills to establish a structured technical talent pipeline ahead of the commissioning of its manufacturing plant at Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar in Maharashtra. The partnership delivers a JSW Motors-specific curriculum, co-developed with Tata IIS. PTI

Amit Malhotra is JioStar's Head of International Biz

Mumbai: Reliance's JioStar appointed Amit Malhotra as the company's Head of International Business, as per an internal memo seen by *businessline*. He will be reporting to Kevin Vaz, CEO–Entertainment, JioStar, and Kiran Mani, CEO–Digital, JioStar. OUR BUREAU

Gift City goes global: Cyprus' EllinasFin to be first overseas equity to list on NSE IX

DUAL LISTING. Positioned as a test case for such cross-border capital flows through IFSC

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

In a milestone for Gift City's evolving offshore capital markets, Cyprus-based financial services company Ellinas Finance will soon list its equity shares on NSE International Exchange (NSE IX), marking what exchange officials describe as the first cross-border equity listing between India and Cyprus.

"This is the first cross-listing in Gift City," said V Balasubramaniam, MD and CEO of NSE IX. He told *businessline* that the Cyprus-listed company will debut on NSE IX next week. "We are going through the listing documents. We are expecting to complete the listing in the next one week," he added.

Echoing the significance, Viraj Kulkarni, Honorary Consul of the Republic of Cyprus in Mumbai, while speaking at the Global Securities Markets Conclave 2.0 in Gift City, on Thursday, said, "This in effect is the culmination of the MoU signed and announced last June in Nicosia by the leaders of both the countries."

BILATERAL AGREEMENT. The development follows the MoU signed in June 2025 between NSE IX and the Cyprus Stock Exchange during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit

Already listed on the Cyprus Stock Exchange (CSE), Ellinas Finance will now have its equity shares admitted for listing on the NSE IX at Gift City, creating a dual listing structure that allows the company's shares to be listed on two separate exchanges in different jurisdictions. The Ellinas Finance listing is being positioned as a test case for such cross-border capital flows through India's International Financial Services Centre (IFSC).

The development follows the MoU signed between NSE IX and the CSE during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Cyprus. The agreement laid the groundwork for cooperation on cross and dual listings, joint product development, research collaboration, fintech engagement and investor access to a wider pool of financial instruments.

According to the CSE, Ellinas Finance is currently headed by Chairman Demetris Petrides. The main activities of the company, founded in 1992, are providing short- and medium-term lending to individuals and companies through specially-tailored personal and business loans, financing of investor accounts, factoring services, private equity, among others.

"Cyprus currently holds the presidency of the Council of the European Union. Last year, it was the second-fastest growing country by GDP in Europe. Cyprus ranks among the top 10 countries from which FDI comes to India — a total of $15.3 billion and in the last six months $1.5 billion has been committed," Kulkarni added.

OTHER PACTS

On Thursday, Taiwan Stock Exchange signed bilateral MoUs with NSE IX and India INX stock exchanges in Gift City. "The MoU with Taiwan Stock Exchange is more exploratory in nature. Taiwan has a number of larger semiconductor firms whose subsidiaries have operations in India. We are exploring to see if some of them can get listed here," Balasubramaniam said.

A similar MoU was signed between Afrinex, Mauritius and NSE IX. Afrinex is a Pan-African financial exchange headquartered in Mauritius, established to operate as a multi-currency, multi-asset securities exchange serving investors and issuers across Africa and beyond.

Anil Ambani appears at ED for money laundering probe

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Anil Ambani

A day after his 'Abode' in Mumbai's Pali Hill was attached, industrialist Anil Ambani finally appeared at the Enforcement Directorate's (ED's) headquarters in Delhi on Thursday to join a money laundering investigation against him and Reliance Anil Ambani Group in a bank fraud case.

Ambani's statement under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act was recorded after he turned up before the Special Task Force, constituted on the directions of the Supreme Court, this morning. He had failed to appear before the investigators to record his statement earlier in the month, but was given a fresh date. Previously, he had also sought the option of virtual appearance, but was denied the same by the investigating agency.

The ED had earlier said Reliance Communications (RCom) and its group companies had sought loans from domestic and foreign lenders, but ₹40,185 crore remained outstanding, which is suspected to have been diverted for other purposes. It has provisionally attached Abode, valued at ₹3,716.83 crore, as part of an ongoing money laundering investigation tied to alleged bank fraud involving RCom. The attachment was carried out under the provisions of the PMLA. A portion of the same property, worth ₹473.17 crore, was previously attached.

With this latest move, the total value of assets attached in cases linked to the Reliance Anil Ambani Group has crossed ₹15,700 crore.

ED PROBE

The ED probe originates from an FIR filed by the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) against RCom, Anil Ambani and others under Sections 120-B, 406 and 420 of the erstwhile Indian Penal Code, along with provisions of the Prevention of Corruption Act.

Investigators allege that RCom and its affiliate firms secured loans from domestic and overseas lenders between 2010 and 2012, leaving outstanding dues of ₹40,185 crore. According to the agency, five banks have classified the group's accounts as fraudulent. Earlier, the State Bank of India designated RCom and Ambani as "fraudulent" under RBI guidelines and is in the process of filing a complaint with the CBI.

The ED has questioned Ambani regarding the loan transactions, including in connection with an alleged ₹17,000-crore loan fraud case. It is separately probing an alleged loan diversion of over ₹14,000 crore involving RCom. Agencies claimed that funds borrowed by one group entity were diverted to repay loans of other companies, routed to related parties, or parked in mutual funds and fixed deposits in violation of lending terms.

The ED estimates that over ₹13,600 crore was used for loan "evergreening," ₹12,600 crore channelled to connected entities and around ₹1,800 crore invested in financial instruments that were later liquidated and redirected within the group.

Investigators have also flagged suspected misuse of bill discounting facilities and remittances abroad.

'Luxembourg facilitates European, global investments into India'

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

Positioning itself as a gateway for European and global capital into India, Luxembourg on Thursday outlined a five-point roadmap to deepen financial cooperation. "This is a historic opportunity to work with India and we should seize this opportunity. India's market and growth story is remarkable," Gilles Roth, Minister of Finance, Luxembourg, said at the Global Securities Markets Conclave 2.0 in Gift City.

The EU-India trade deal would be a "strategic step forward," increasing predictability for businesses, deepening investment links and creating more structured economic cooperation.

"Fewer frictions and more confidence and more incentives to build long-term partnerships," he said. With India's capital markets expanding rapidly and its funding needs rising, Luxembourg positioned itself as a platform to channel European and global capital into India.

"Luxembourg is a cross-border financial centre by design. We specialise in building bridges between countries, investor bases and real economy needs... We host around €8 trillion in assets under management,

Gilles Roth, Minister of Finance, Luxembourg

distribute funds in over 80 countries, represent about 60 per cent of global cross-border fund distribution, and have more than 115 banks from over 20 countries operating within its jurisdiction," Roth said. "In Luxembourg, we see two clear options for cooperation — supporting Indian institutions seeking European and global investors through Luxembourg structures and platforms, and for facilitating European and global investments into India. Here we have enormous potential," he added.

5-POINT PLAN

Roth outlined a five-point framework to deepen financial integration between the two countries. The first pillar focused on investment fund and asset management connectivity.

The second area centred on reducing friction for high-quality issuers and investors, including facilitating sustainable listings and improving market access mechanisms. Third, Luxembourg saw a scope to channel European institutional capital into India's large investment requirements. The emphasis, Roth said, would be on making projects "investable, transparent and scalable."

The fourth pillar targeted collaboration in digitalisation of financial markets, including tokenisation and the use of AI in capital market infrastructure, while the fifth called for a more structured and operational policy dialogue, aimed at strengthening regulatory cooperation and making existing frameworks more effective for cross-border market participants.

Optimum Solutions, ABeam Consulting set up GCC

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Singapore-based Optimum Solutions and Japan-based ABeam Consulting have jointly established a Global Capability Centre (GCC) here on Thursday, with a focus on serving clients in Japan.

The GCC, which will have an initial workforce of 150-165 in 2025-26, will double its headcount annually over the next three- four years to reach 2,000 employees by 2030.

"The GCC brings together engineering capability from Singapore and consulting expertise from Japan to support global digital transformation programmes," Balwant Jain, CEO, Optimum Solutions, told *businessline*.

"The core premise of this partnership was that we would provide software development capabilities, while they (the Japanese

Balwant Jain, CEO, Optimum Solutions

partner) would bring consulting expertise and relationships with Japanese customers," he said.

STRONG OPPORTUNITY

"We see a strong opportunity for a GCC specifically focused on the Japanese market. Most GCCs currently are focused on Europe and the US," he said.

The Hyderabad GCC will support work across AI, data engineering, cloud services, enterprise platforms, application engineering, digital solutions and business operations.

Russian crude flows to India rise slightly in Feb as RIL resumes imports: Vortexa

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

Russian crude oil imports to India have increased, *albeit* slightly, in the current month (till February 24), as Reliance Industries (RIL) resumed supplies from Moscow, a report by energy intelligence firm Vortexa said.

Citing data, Vortexa said that five Aframax/ Long Range2 (LR2) and one Suezmax vessels discharged Russian crude oil into RIL terminals in February 2026 month-to-date.

The firm also anticipated that Indian imports of Russian crude may have already hit a "low point" in January 2026 at close to 1 million barrels per day (mb/d).

Vortexa data on India's crude oil imports by destination terminal show that the overall Russian shipments have been rising in February after the decline witnessed last month.

Similarly, shipments to RIL terminal have also been growing after the country's largest private sector refiner stopped procuring barrels from Moscow in January.

However, HPCL Mittal Energy (HMEL) is yet to receive cargoes from Russia.

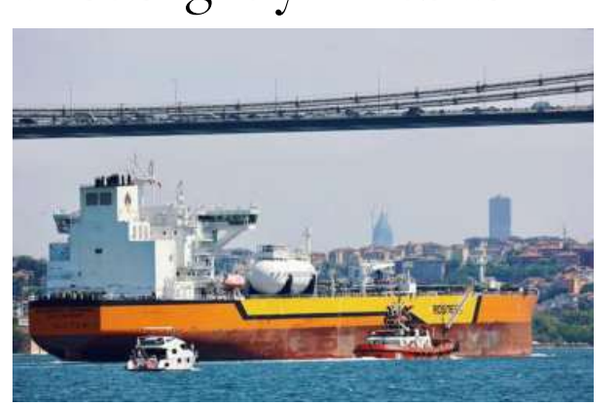
Besides, arrivals at Nayara Energy's Vadinar refinery and State-run refiners' terminal have declined in February on a monthly basis.

ASIAN BUYING

The report pointed out that global seaborne crude imports continue to grow thus far in 2026, with demand coming from non-OECD buyers, mainly India and China.

"Asian buying reflects supply security concerns and reshuffling of some flows away from sanctioned barrels. China is soaking up sanctioned barrels at unprecedented pace," it added.

Atlantic Basin crude stays intra-basin, as high freight rates for very large crude carriers (VLCCs) forces key buyers in the Pacific Basin to look for short-haul barrels instead, which are on strong offer



RISING DEMAND. Global seaborne crude imports continue to grow thus far in 2026, with demand coming from non-OECD buyers, mainly India and China REUTERS

from Middle East Gulf (MEG). Long-haul flows such as USGC (US Gulf Coast) to Asia, West Africa to Asia and South America East Coast to Asia all posted declines, Vortexa said.

India crude import reshuffling is not supporting freight rates, as replacement supplies come primarily from short-haul flows from MEG.

Current indications—including continued discharges of sanctioned crude in China and India, and declining flows from the Atlantic Basin to the East—suggests a potential easing of VLCC freight rates in the coming weeks to a level that is more aligned with fundamentals, it added.

Overall, global seaborne crude exports exceeded seasonal highs in the first two months of 2026, supported by robust OPEC+ exports, while non-OPEC+ exports rose moderately.

Saudi Arabia is leading the export growth amongst OPEC+ members, as the country has revised its official selling prices for Asian customers to a five-year low, Vortexa said.

US-IRAN TENSION

The US-Iran tensions in the MEG added a risk premium to oil prices, as oil flows via the Straits of Hormuz represent one third of global seaborne crude/condensate flows.

Countries such as Saudi Arabia, the UAE and Iran have been pushing out more oil from the MEG over the last four weeks, probably out of war concerns, it added.

The firm pointed out that while sanctioned crude oil exports rose by around 1 mb/d year on year with Indian imports of Russian crude declining by about 440,000 b/d on an annual basis.

INDIA-US TRADE TALKS

In a separate commentary on Tuesday, Anna Zhminko, Associate Market Analyst at Vortexa, said, "The share of Russian oil in India's total crude imports has been on a downward revision since last December, falling to 20 per cent this February (around 1.1 mb/d, days 1-24), compared to 36 per cent in November 2025."

Amid India-US trade negotiations, only the EU-sanctioned Nayara refinery continues a robust import programme of Russian crude, she added.

Zhminko pointed out that it was not yet clear whether India will continue to scale back on imports of Russian crude oil further or reverse the trajectory due to a recent US Supreme Court decision to reset tariffs.

However, displaced volumes would most likely be diverted to China's private refining sector. In turn, predominant reliance on China's private refiners subjects Russian crude to steeper discounts and prolonged clearance, pressuring vessel availability, she explained.

Creditors can pursue simultaneous insolvency proceedings against both debtors, guarantors: SC

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Thursday said that simultaneous Corporate Insolvency Resolution Process (CIRP) proceedings are maintainable against both a principal debtor and its corporate guarantor for the same debt.

A Bench, comprising Justices Dipankar Datta and Augustine George Masih, held that there is no statutory bar under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC) preventing a financial creditor from initiating parallel actions to recover its dues.

"The judge is not to innovate at pleasure. He is not a knight errant roaming at will in pursuit of his own ideal of beauty or of goodness," Justice Datta wrote in the opening of the 47-page judgment.

"Thus, whilst approving that the IBC is not a recovery proceeding, we negate the contention that CIRP can be prohibited against a guarantor or co-borrower only on that ground. It seems prudent that the rationale of a creditor obtaining a guarantee for its debt must be realised to its fullest. A financial creditor, vested with rights under the Code, must be able to exercise it. Equally so, the adjudicating authority has the obligation to examine the application independently, on its own merits," he said.

LIABILITY OF A SURETY

The verdict reaffirmed the fundamental principle of the Indian Contract Act, which

says the liability of a surety (guarantor) is "co-extensive" with that of the principal debtor.

It said that the very purpose of a guarantee would be defeated if a creditor were forced to wait for one insolvency process to conclude before starting another.

"The interpretation ... would mean that the guarantor would be exempt, in the interregnum, from paying the debt, which the IBC does not provide for," the verdict said.

The Bench said the IBC is a "well-thought" policy framework and that "wearing the legislative hat" would be an act of "judicial exploration".

BATCH OF APPEALS

The ruling arose from a batch of appeals involving major financial institutions, including ICICI Bank and the State Bank of India (SBI), against various infrastructure and real estate firms.

It allowed the appeals by ICICI Bank and SBI, where insolvency against guarantors had been previously blocked.

It rejected the appeals by corporate directors who sought to stop parallel proceedings against their companies.

Jindal Poly's appeal against class action suit dismissed

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

In what can be seen as India's first-ever class action suit, the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) on Thursday dismissed an appeal by Jindal Poly (JPFL) and upheld the admission of the shareholder class action before the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT).

"NCLT in the impugned order has satisfied itself regarding fulfilment of all requisite pre-conditions under Section 245 read with relevant Rules. Thus, we are not inclined to interfere in the impugned order and hence the appeal is dismissed," a coram of Justice Yogesh Khanna (Member-Judicial) and Ajai Das Mehrotra (Member-Technical) said.

Acknowledging the dismissal, a spokesperson of JPFL said: "This decision does not impose any findings on the allegations made in the petition. The company is reviewing the order and shall decide on the next steps accordingly."

NCLT FINDINGS

The Appellate Tribunal upheld the NCLT's findings regarding the six mandatory pre-conditions for a class action suit. Specifically, the applicants far exceeded the 2 per cent shareholding threshold by cumulatively holding 4.99 per cent of the share capital. Further, the NCLT was satisfied that the applicants had established a valid "opinion" that the company's affairs were being managed in a manner prejudicial to the interests of its members, depositors or the company itself.

Regarding the "good faith" requirement, the NCLT noted the petitioners'

The Appellate Tribunal upheld the admission of the shareholder class action before the National Company Law Tribunal

attempts to engage with the company through multiple emails, all of which went unaddressed. This lack of transparency culminated in the company's outright refusal to provide any documents or information. Consequently, the petitioners engaged FTI Consulting, a globally-recognised audit firm, whose forensic evaluation revealed a gross undervaluation of transactions, resulting in losses exceeding ₹2,500 crore.

The NCLAT found that, *prima facie*, the allegations suggest illegal and systematically fraudulent acts perpetrated by JPFL, its promoters and its directors. It noted that these impugned transactions had resulted in substantial financial losses for the entire class of minority public shareholders. "The investigation conducted by SEBI and by the Directorate of Enforcement (ED) *prima facie* establish the 'management and conduct of the affairs of the company (Appellant / JPFL herein) are being conducted in a manner prejudicial to the interest of the company itself as well as its members'," it said.

QUICKLY.

Brecht Vanneste named new MD of MSD in India

Mumbai: Drugmaker MSD has announced the appointment of Brecht Vanneste as Managing Director of MSD (India), from March 1, 2026. He will replace Rehan A Khan, who was appointed in 2020 as head of MSD, also referred to as Merck & Co Inc in the United States and Canada. Brecht is a biopharmaceutical industry veteran who has been at MSD for more than 27 years, and has held several international leadership roles, the company said. OUR BUREAU

Eugia gets USFDA nod for Everolimus tablets

Hyderabad: Eugia Pharma Specialities, an arm of Aurobindo Pharma, has received final approval from the US Food & Drug Administration (USFDA) to manufacture and market Everolimus tablets. The approved drug is a bioequivalent and therapeutically equivalent to the reference listed drug, Zortress tablets of Novartis Pharmaceuticals Corp. OUR BUREAU

New 48-hour free cancellation window introduced for air tickets

EASE OF BOOKING. DGCA rules mandate 'look-in option', strict refund timelines to help passengers

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

In a major relief to air travellers, India's aviation safety regulator has mandated a 'look-in option' that allows passengers to cancel or amend flight tickets without additional charges for a period of 48 hours after the initial booking.

The new civil aviation requirement (CAR) comes after the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) received a high volume of complaints regarding delayed refunds and restrictive airline policies.

businessline was the first publication to report about this in November 2025.

Accordingly, under the new 'look-in' provision, passengers can cancel or change their tickets within 48 hours of booking at no additional charge, except for any prevailing fare difference for the revised flight.

This facility is only available for domestic flights booked at least seven days in advance and international flights booked 15 days prior to departure through airline websites.

ADDRESSING CONCERNS. The new rules come after the DGCA received complaints regarding delayed refunds and restrictive airline policies

BOOKING FLEXIBILITY

Beyond the initial booking flexibility, the CAR prescribes rigorous timelines for the return of funds.

In case of credit card payments, airlines must complete the refund within seven days of cancellation.

Besides, for cash transactions, the refund shall be made immediately by the airline office where the ticket was purchased, the new CAR said.

Furthermore, for tickets bought through travel agents or portals, the CAR states that onus of refund rests with the airlines, which must ensure the process is completed within 14 working days.

On the issue of 'credit shells', the regulator stated that holding a refund amount in such a facility shall be the prerogative of the passenger and not a default practice of the airline.

Consequently, airlines are no longer permitted to automatically retain funds for future travel unless the passenger specifically opts for this arrangement.

STATUTORY TAXES

The CAR further mandates airlines to refund all statutory taxes, user development fees (UDF), airport development fees (ADF), and passenger service fees (PSF) to passengers even in cases of non-utilisation or non-refundable 'no show' tickets.

Moreover, the regulator has stipulated that cancellation charges must be indicated prominently at the time of booking. Additionally, the CAR stated that under no circumstances shall an airline or its agent levy a cancellation charge exceeding the basic fare plus fuel surcharge.

Meanwhile, airlines have been barred from levying any additional charge to process a refund or for correcting the name of a passenger if the error is pointed out within 24 hours of booking on the airline's website.

Additionally, in the event of medical emergencies involving hospitalisation of the passenger or a family member on the same passenger name record (PNR), airlines may provide either a refund or a credit shell. In addition, for other medical situations, CAR said that refunds will be issued following an opinion from a DGCA-empanelled aerospace medicine specialist regarding the passenger's fitness to travel.

AAI raises FY27 capital expenditure to ₹4,563 cr

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

State-owned Airports Authority of India (AAI) has increased its capital expenditure (capex) for the financial year 2026-27 on a year-on-year basis to ₹4,563 crore, sources told *businessline*.

The state-run airport operator and developer had invested ₹4,526 crore in FY 2025-26.

The earmarked amount assumes significance since the annual capex is utilised to refurbish old terminal buildings, restore and operationalise unserved and underserved airports, and enhance airside as well as city-side infrastructure capacity.

A case in point is the government's assertion that the country opens one new airport every 50 days.

Till now, AAI has operationalised 93 unserved and underserved airports — including heliports and water aerodromes — under the regional connectivity framework, significantly expanding India's aviation footprint.

During the same period, it has also developed and refurbished multiple terminal buildings across its network to ease congestion and enhance passenger amenities.

According to industry insiders, expansion of both airside and city-side capacity remains a key ingredient in sustaining the sector's growth.

Exponential passenger growth in recent years has led to congestion at several older terminal buildings.

The expected induction of over 1,700 aircraft over the next five years and beyond is also likely to strain parking bay capacity at many airports.

GROWTH MOMENTUM

"It is essential that aviation infrastructure is created and resurrected for the continued growth momentum of the sector," sources said.

The capex outlay will also play a major role in fulfilling provisions under the modified UDAN framework that is currently under active consideration.

Notably, over the past few years, AAI has consistently maintained capex around ₹4,500 crore annually for the last few years.

In FY 2023-24, capex stood at ₹5,000 crore, surpassing the target of ₹4,000 crore.

Recently, the authority completed a capital expenditure of ₹25,000 crore for the period between 2019-20 and 2024-25.

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GSK seeks more awareness on preventing shingles in adults

PT Jyothi Datta
Mumbai

Despite the "day-disrupting" pain caused by shingles, an infection caused by the same virus as chicken pox, prevention is not part of the discussion among adults with chronic diseases, says British biopharmaceutical company GSK, citing findings from a global survey commissioned by them.

"India is living longer but not necessarily healthier," said Shalini Menon, Executive Vice-President (Medical Affairs), GSK India, pointing out that as people age, they are likely to get affected by diabetes, hypertension, heart disease, kidney diseases and lung disease, further weakening the immune system and the body's ability to fight infections. And yet the survey revealed limited awareness about the link between chronic conditions and immune health among ageing adults, she said.

About 43 per cent of Indians who participated in the survey (who have had shingles) reported severe, "day-disrupting pain", with over one in three saying that it stopped them from working or attending social events, the survey found.

"Patients with chronic kidney disease and cardiovascular disease (CVD) experienced the greatest disruption, while diabetes and CVD patients reported the highest emotional toll," it added. Shingles is caused by the reactivation of the varicella-zoster virus, the same virus that causes chickenpox. GSK's shingles vaccine was launched in India in early 2023 for adults over 50 years.

Shalini Menon, Executive V-P (Medical Affairs), GSK India

While India is relatively new to adult vaccines, GSK's shingles vaccine has been approved in 18-year-olds and above in China, and its prefilled syringe version has recently been approved in the United States.

SYRINGE SYSTEM

Responding to a *businessline* query, Menon said the prefilled syringe system is on the company's radar, but it was too early to confirm any plans for India.

The multinational company is gathering data on the performance of the vaccine in those who have taken it locally, before it could be taken further into the public health services delivery system, she said.

Like childhood immunisation, the aim is to make preventive adult vaccines part of life course, to bring down healthcare costs, she said.

The two-dose vaccine is presently available in the private market at about ₹11,000 per dose.

JAPAN'S EXPERIENCE

Outlining the importance of preventive healthcare conversations as the population ages, the company cited the example of Japan.

In 2020, Japan's adults aged 65 and above accounted for nearly 29 per cent of its population, a demographic shift that coincided with a more than 50 per cent rise in shingles cases across that population, GSK said.

"The growing public health impact led Japan to incorporate shingles vaccination in its immunisation protocols in certain provinces, targeting elderly individuals aged 65 and older," the company said, adding that India is on a similar demographic trajectory.

"The country's population aged over 60, currently estimated at 153 million, is expected to more than double to 347 million by 2050.21 This ageing shift is already being reflected in the country's health profile. More than 75 million older adults are living with at least one chronic condition, while 27 percent are managing multiple long-term illnesses, including diabetes and cardiovascular diseases," the company said.

Thailand targets 2.55 m Indian visitors in 2026

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

Thailand is eyeing 2.55 million tourists from India with increased air connectivity and focus on lifestyle and wellness travel, the country's tourism authority said on Thursday.

Last year, 2.48 million Indians visited Thailand, a growth of 16.8 per cent over 2024. In the first two months of 2026, nearly four lakh Indians have visited Thailand — the most after China, Malaysia and Russia.

"India remains one of Thailand's top source market. Key segments include families, health and wellness travellers, weddings, golfers, female travellers, seniors, and emerging niche segments focused on rejuvenation, restoration and adventure," Tourism Authority of Thailand said in a statement.

TOURISM PUSH

Beyond established destinations like Bangkok and Phuket, the tourism authority is also promoting lesser-known destinations to encourage repeat visitations and deeper encouragement.

While 10 airlines operate flights between India and Thailand, capacity between the two countries has increased by 15 per cent over last year. More flights are expected as Thai Airways will increase frequencies to existing destinations and open new routes from Bangkok to Amritsar, Jaipur and Kochi.

Samsung planning to introduce AI in entry-level smartphones

Press Trust of India
San Francisco

Samsung will democratise artificial intelligence (AI) technology for its smartphones as it aims to bring this feature to entry-level devices, said a company official.

The firm, which launched its third-generation Galaxy AI series phone S26 here, believes that AI-powered phone is going to dominate the smartphone segment, said Samsung India, MX Business, Senior Vice-President, Raju Pullan. Samsung recently launched the Galaxy A07 5G smartphone in the Indian market, with starting price of ₹15,000 in the affordable segment, which has AI-powered features to support users' everyday tasks.

"We are now taking the AI features right up to the entry price point, and that's how we will expand the overall category," Pullan said on the sidelines of the S26 launch.

pricol

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NOTICE TO SHARE HOLDERS

Special Window for Transfer and Dematerialisation of Physical Securities

Pursuant to SEBI Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MIRSD-POD/I/3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026, shareholders are hereby informed that a Special Window has been opened for a period of one year, from February 5, 2026 to February 4, 2027, for the transfer and dematerialisation of physical securities which were sold / purchased prior to April 01, 2019. This facility is applicable to fresh lodgement and also for such transfer requests which were submitted earlier and were rejected, returned, or not attended due to deficiencies in documents, process or otherwise. The shares lodged for transfer will be processed only in demat mode and shall be subject to lock-in for a period of one year from the date of registration of transfer. Shareholders may avail this opportunity by submitting the requisite documents to the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent: Integrated Registry Management Services Private Limited, 2nd Floor, "Kences Towers", No.1, Ramakrishna Street, North Usman Road, T.Nagar, Chennai – 600017. Phone: 044 - 28140801-03. Email: einward@integratedindia.in

For Pricol Limited
T.G.Thamizhanban
Company Secretary

Coimbatore
26th February 2026

The next wave of Indian-origin leaders in Big Tech

OpenAI's Arvind KC is latest in a growing crop of executives in senior roles at AI majors

Rohan Das
Chennai

When OpenAI announced the appointment of Arvind KC as its new Chief People Officer, it signalled the growing bench strength of Indian-origin executives in senior roles in global big tech circles, especially in the AI function. From OpenAI to Anthropic to Apple and Meta, there is a big crop of Indian-origin professionals in the influential C-suite.

OpenAI alone has made a few marquee appointments of Indian-origin executives at senior management positions including Vijaye Raji (CTO-Applications), Srinivas Narayanan (CTO-B2B Applications) and Uday Ruddarraju (Head of Compute Infrastructure).

As for its arch rival Anthropic, Rahul Patil was appointed as the company's CTO in October 2025 to oversee infrastructure, compute and engineering as it scales its Claude AI models. This crop mirrors the growth of Indian talent of yesteryears such as Sundar Pichai, Satya Nadella and others, who went on to lead world's top tech giants like Microsoft, Alphabet and Adobe.

DESI CLOUT

Beyond just pure play AI companies, tech majors have also roped in *desi* executives to head AI divisions. Apple recently announced Amar Subramanya as Vice President of AI. In his role, the Bangalore University graduate is leading Apple Foundation Models, ML research and AI Safety and Evaluation.

Meta's top team includes Aparna Ramani, who has been the VP of Engineering at the company since 2016 and is now leading its AI Infrastructure teams.

Likewise, Ashok Elluswamy is the VP of AI Software at Tesla and Deepu Talla leads the Robotics & Edge AI division of Meta as its Vice-President and General Manager.

Arvind KC, Chief People Officer, OpenAI

Most recently, in a major move, Microsoft's Nadella announced that Indian-origin Asha Sharma will become Executive VP and CEO of Microsoft Gaming.

Previously at online gaming major Roblox, OpenAI's new people head Arvind earlier held leadership roles at Google, Palantir and Facebook (now Meta), among others.

A graduate in chemical engineering from the University Institute of Chemical Technology in Mumbai, Arvind completed his MBA in operations management from Santa Clara University.

TECH EXPERTISE

Kamal Karnath, Co-founder of Xpheno, a specialist staffing firm, believes these appointments are driven by a pattern of deep technical expertise, especially in the AI domain.

"These executives typically bring a strong pedigree in terms of qualifications, experience and hands-on product work across tech stacks. Their prior leadership exposure, combined with proximity to global enterprise ecosystems, makes them a clear fit for senior roles. A higher education mandate from the US also strengthens their credibility for such positions," he added.

Invesco Mutual Fund

Invesco Asset Management (India) Pvt. Ltd.
(CIN: U67190MH2005PTC153471), 2101-A, 21st Floor, A Wing, Marathon Futurex, N. M. Joshi Marg, Lower Parel, Mumbai - 400 013

Telephone: +91 22 6731 0000, Email: mfservices@invescoindia.com; www.invescomutualfund.com

NOTICE

NOTICE is hereby given that Invesco Trustee Pvt. Ltd., (**the Trustee to Invesco Mutual Fund**) has approved the declaration of Income Distribution cum Capital Withdrawal ('**IDCW**') in the following scheme, the particulars of which are as under:

Name of the Scheme	Plan(s) / Option(s)	Amount of IDCW* (Rs. per unit)	NAV as on February 25, 2026 (Rs. per unit)	Record Date#
Invesco India Large Cap Fund, Large Cap Fund - An open ended equity scheme predominantly investing in large cap stocks	Regular Plan - IDCW Option	3.00	28.92	March 4, 2026
	Direct Plan - IDCW Option		37.30	

*Distribution of the above IDCW is subject to the availability of distributable surplus and may be lower to the extent of distributable surplus available on the record date. IDCW payable to the unit holder(s) will be lower to the extent of tax deducted at source, at applicable rates..

#or immediately following Business Day if that day is not a Business Day.

Face Value per unit is Rs. 10/-.

Pursuant to payment of IDCW, the NAV of the IDCW Options of the scheme would fall to the extent of payout and statutory levy, if any.

Unit holders of the aforesaid scheme, whose names appear in the records of the Registrar, KFin Technologies Limited, as at the close of business hours on **Wednesday, March 4, 2026** or immediately following Business Day if that day is not a Business Day (including valid purchase/switch-in application received till 3.00 p.m. on the record date, subject to the entire amount of subscription/ purchase as per the application / switch-in request is available for utilization by the scheme before the cut-off time on the record date) will be entitled to receive the IDCW.

Unit holders holding units in dematerialized (electronic) form whose names appear in the statement of beneficial owners maintained by the Depositories under the aforesaid scheme as at the close of business hours on **Wednesday, March 4, 2026** will be entitled to receive the IDCW.

With regard to Unit holders under IDCW options of the aforesaid scheme, who have opted for IDCW Reinvestment facility, the IDCW due will be reinvested by allotting units for the IDCW amount (net of applicable taxes and stamp duty) (on the next Business Day after the Record Date) at a price based on the prevailing ex-IDCW NAV per unit on the record date.

For **Invesco Asset Management (India) Pvt. Ltd.**
(Investment Manager for Invesco Mutual Fund)

Sd/-
Saurabh Nanavati
Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer

Date: February 26, 2026

Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

CHENNAI
businessline.
FRIDAY - FEBRUARY 27 - 2026

QUICKLY.

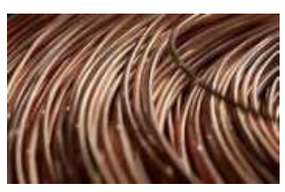
Gold steady as markets eye US-Iran talks outcome

Gold prices held steady on Thursday as investors stayed on the sidelines ahead of the third round of indirect US-Iran nuclear talks in Geneva. Spot gold was down 0.1 per cent at $5,165.77 per ounce at 1419 GMT. US gold futures for April delivery were down 0.8 per cent at $5,182.10. Silver fell 2.8 per cent to $86.94 per ounce. REUTERS

Crude oil slips on high US inventories

London: Crude oil prices fell after the biggest jump in US crude inventories in three years, with signs of weakness in the physical oil market also weighing on prices, while traders assessed US-Iran talks. Brent crude futures were down 95 cents at $69.90 a barrel by 1351 GMT. WTI futures lost $1.06 to $64.36. REUTERS

Copper momentum slows on inventory overhang



London: Copper eased after touching a two-week high in the previous session as rising inventories and a firmer dollar tempered optimism about a revival in demand from China, the world's top consumer of the metal. Benchmark three-month copper on the LME was down 0.1 per cent to $13,304 a tonne as of 1036 GMT. REUTERS

Slack demand, competition weigh on onion exports

ERODING SHARE. Bangladesh and Saudi Arabia cut imports from India, while Pakistan gains on price edge; currency advantage boosts rival suppliers

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

India's onion exports have come under further pressure this financial year, reflecting a sustained decline driven by changing global market dynamics.

Shipments have slowed primarily due to reduced offtake from key buyers such as Bangladesh and Saudi Arabia, as these countries increasingly rely on their own domestic production, exporters said.

POLICY IMPACT

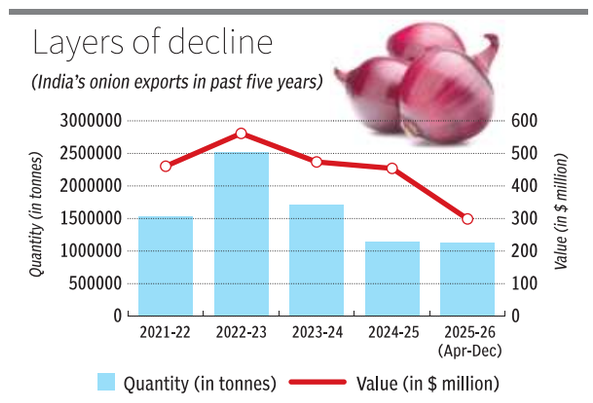
This structural shift in demand has curtailed the shipment volumes, even as competitive pressures are weighing on exports.

The weaker currency of Pakistan, a major competing origin, has enhanced its price competitiveness in international markets, making it more difficult for Indian exporters to defend market share, particularly in price-sensitive destinations.

"Demand is there, but we have lost some markets. Bangladesh, one of the biggest buyer, is not buying from us. Lot of countries have developed their own crop; now even Saudi, a good buyer, is not buying," said Ajit Shah, President, Horticulture Exporters Association.

"Also, India had imposed a ban 2-3 years ago. So all our traditional buyers shifted to other suppliers like Pakistan, Sudan and Yemen," he said.

Earlier, these countries used to export in small quantities, about 2-3 months a year. Now they are exporting for 6-7 or even nine months a year, Shah said, adding that as a result, "buyers had started comparing our price with these other suppliers".



Source: DGCIS, Apeda

"Our quality is always good as compared to the other suppliers, but now every market is price sensitive. So our quantity, our share of demand has decreased and that's why the export is not going so much. But it's not so less also," Shah said.

According to DGCIS data, India's onion exports during April-December of the current financial year registered a 22 per cent decline in value terms at $298.69 over the corresponding last year's $380.08 million on lower prices.

VOLUMES UP

However, the shipment volumes during this period were up 37 per cent at 11.33 lakh tonnes compared to 8.26 lakh tonnes in the corresponding last year.

In fact, onion shipments have been on a downward trend in recent years when a ban was imposed in December 2023 until March 2024 to ease domestic supplies. All restrictions were removed by March 2025 when supplies improved.

Further, Shah said, Bangladesh, when it doesn't have its own crop, is buying the maximum quantity from from Pakistan, whereas Saudi Arabia is buying from Yemen and Sudan.

"Our prices are similar or up by say $10-50 per tonne, when compared with onions from Sudan or Yemen. However, we are expensive in comparison with Pakistan as there is a vast difference in their dollar rate and our rate. Our dollar-rupee rate is 90.5, while their dollar to Pakistan rupee rate is 280 and that's the main reason they are cheaper than us in the international market," Shah said, adding that weaker currency is giving them an edge.

However, Indian onion exports are taking place to countries such as Sri Lanka and West Asian countries, Shah said, adding that the rabi arrivals will be starting soon.

RABI ARRIVALS

Trade sources said the prices had eased in recent weeks with improving arrivals.

Per the Agmarknet data, the modal prices are hovering in the range of ₹775-1,500 per quintal in Maharashtra, the major producing State.

The all-India average wholesale mandi prices have eased from ₹1,410.44 per quintal a week ago on February 17 to ₹1,085.64 on February 24.

Shah said the rabi onion crop is expected to be bigger than last year.

Storage in key reservoirs drops below 60% of capacity

Our Bureau
Chennai

Storage in India's 166 major reservoirs dropped below 60 per cent of capacity this week, with the level in at least 28 per cent of dams dipping below 50 per cent.

The level has dropped as winter rain from January 1 to February 25 is 58 per cent deficient, with the precipitation in the Eastern and North-Eastern region 90 per cent deficient, and in the Central region 77 per cent.

According to the Central Water Commission (CWC), storage dropped to 59 per cent or 108.338 billion cubic metres (BCM) of the 183.565 BCM capacity.

The CWC weekly bulletin on the storage in the major reservoirs said the level was 12 percentage points higher than last year and over 25 percentage points more than normal (last 10 years).

Only 3 reservoirs are brimming compared with 4 last week.

SOUTH BELOW 40%

The Western region had the highest storage of 69.7 per cent or 26.557 BCM of the 38.094 BCM capacity in its 53 reservoirs.

Storage in the 47 reservoirs of the Southern region slipped below 50 per cent of the 55.288 BCM at 27.606 BCM. It is lower than last year.

The level in Karnataka and Telangana was below 50 per cent, while in Tamil Nadu and Kerala, it was below 60 per cent. In Andhra Pradesh, the dams were filled to 62 per cent capacity.

The level in the 28 reservoirs of the Central region was 63 per cent or 30.803 BCM of the 48.588 BCM capacity.

MORE FALL LIKELY

Storage in the 27 reservoirs of the Eastern region was 57 per cent of the 21.759 BCM capacity at 12.464 BCM.

The 11 reservoirs of the Northern region were filled to 55 per cent or 10.908 BCM of the 19.836 BCM capacity.

Per data from the India Meteorological Department, 78 per cent of the 727 districts in the country received deficient or no rainfall since the beginning of the year.

A low-pressure system over the Bay of Bengal may bring some relief to the southern peninsula. But, the level will likely decline further in the coming weeks.

CACP charts roadmap for jute sector revival

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP) has recommended expanding acreage, improving productivity, strengthening procurement and diversifying exports to address structural challenges in the jute sector.

Output has declined sharply over the past two-and-a-half decades, largely due to the shrinking area under cultivation.

In its non-policy observations for 2026-27, the CACP noted that despite the development of high-yielding varieties (HYVs), the varietal replacement rate remains low, with older varieties such as JRO-204 and JRO-524 still dominating.

It called for a national action plan, with Centre-State coordination, to scale up the multiplication of quality seeds and ensure timely availability at affordable prices.

The panel also reiterated its earlier recommendation to set up an expert committee to resolve the long-pending discrepancy in production estimates between the Agriculture Ministry and the Jute Advisory Board.

QUALITY INCENTIVES

The CACP recommended higher MSP premium for superior grades (TD-1 and TD-2) and steeper discounts for lower grades (TD-4 and TD-5) to encourage production of better quality fibre.

Currently, most output is low grade, suited mainly for sacking under the Jute Packaging Materials Act.

The relative premium for higher grades has stagnated, weakening quality incentives, it noted. The panel also suggested gradually reducing mandatory jute packaging use to free raw material for diversified products.

Key suggestions include expanding area, promoting high-yielding seeds, higher MSP for superior fibre and boosting mechanisation

Given that labour accounts for over three-fourths of production costs, the CACP stressed the need to promote mechanisation, including line sowing with seed drills and improved weeding tools.

EXPORT RISKS RISING

India is a net importer of raw jute but a net exporter of jute products.

However, exports are highly concentrated, with the top five markets accounting for 50–70 per cent of shipments, leaving the sector vulnerable to external shocks. With the US — a key destination — raising tariffs, the CACP has urged diversification of export markets and product segments to reduce risk.

ROPING IN FPOS

Observing that the presence of the Jute Corporation of India (JCI) is still limited, particularly in remote and inaccessible areas, due to a shortage of manpower, procurement centres and storage infrastructure, the farm costs panel suggested that the JCI should expand its field-level presence through the active involvement of the States, co-operatives, FPOs and SHGs to ensure a more inclusive and efficient procurement system.

Supply shifts reshape spices outlook

Our Bureau
Kochi

India's key spice markets are entering a mixed cycle in 2025-26, with chilli production set to decline sharply, turmeric output rebounding after last year's price spike, and ginger navigating export volatility amid China's growing dominance.

Crop intelligence presented at the International Spice Conference (ISC 2026) points to a year of supply recalibration and price sensitivity across all three commodities.

India, the world's largest chilli producer at about 2 million tonnes (mt), is facing a 35-40 per cent production drop this season due to reduced acreage and weather variability in Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Karnataka.

Sowing was extended into October-November, and arrivals so far have been below

expectations, tightening spot availability. Although carry-forward stocks are 8-10 per cent higher year-on-year, effective market supply could still be lower by nearly 30 per cent because of acreage cuts.

After a weak phase earlier in 2025 due to high inventories, prices have firmed since January as arrivals disappointed. Export demand remains steady, with China emerging as a key buyer.

TURMERIC IS SUPPLY POSITIVE

Turmeric markets, which rallied sharply in 2024-25 following a smaller 2023 crop and depleted stocks, are now moving into a supply positive phase.

India, which accounts for nearly 80 per cent of global output, is expected to see production rise about 15 per cent in 2026, driven by a 20 per cent increase in acreage, particularly in Maharashtra.

However, excess rainfall has reduced yields by around 5 per cent in some regions. Prices have corrected about 16 per cent since mid-2024 as output prospects improved and expectations of a larger crop were priced in.

Despite this, inventories remain relatively tight after exports rose 11 per cent last year and imports fell sharply. Trade sources say stock rebuilding will be critical to reduce speculative volatility.

GINGER UNDER PRESSURE

India remains the world's second-largest ginger producer at around 2 mt, but output has declined nearly 12 per cent this season due to lower acreage.

With nearly 90 per cent consumed domestically, export exposure is limited, but this also restricts stock flexibility.

Exports remain volatile and heavily dependent on Bangladesh, which accounts for about 80 per cent of shipments.

Dry ginger exports surged in 2025, tightening domestic availability even as production recovered.

CHINA'S DOMINANCE

However, India's pricing power is increasingly influenced by China, which produces nearly 6 mt and dominates global fresh exports.

As China expands supply and logistics capacity, Indian prices remain sensitive to global release cycles, while compliance gaps continue to limit access to the premium Western markets.

'Trust to drive next decade of food industry'

V Sajeev Kumar
Kochi

The next decade in food and nutrition will be defined not merely by volume growth, but by the ability of companies to build verifiable trust across supply chains, according to Martin Sonntag, Chief Executive Officer of natural colours major Oterra.

"As the bar rises globally on safety, sustainability and ethical sourcing, only transparent systems and relentless improvement will sustain trust," he said on the sidelines of the International Spice Conference (ISC 2026) after delivering the keynote on 'Shaping the Next Decade of Food & Nutrition: Collaboration, Trust and Responsibility'.

He added that food safety, environmental accountability and ethical sourcing had moved from aspirational goals to baseline market-entry requirements.

The global food and beverage market, with nearly €6 trillion in annual consumer spending, drives over €100 billion in ingredient purchases each year (excluding meat and dairy).

Martin Sonntag, CEO, Oterra

However, the supplier base remains fragmented, creating opportunities for consolidation and integrated models that improve traceability, compliance and consistent quality.

Oterra, which reported €417 million in revenue in 2023-24, operates in over 40 locations worldwide, serves 110-plus countries and supplies more than 2,200 customers.

The company follows a backward-integrated model, spanning breeding, contract farming and extraction and processing of natural colours, aimed at reducing supply chain risk and ensuring compliance from origin to finished product.

KEY INDUSTRY TRENDS

Sonntag outlined seven megatrends shaping the industry — premiumisation, affordability pressures, health and longevity, expanding consumer choice, responsible growth, tighter regulation across food chains, and rapid digitalisation.

Tightening regulations in the EU and the US, along with sustainability reporting frameworks and due-diligence mandates, are pushing companies from reactive compliance to proactive risk management, he said.

For spice-origin economies such as India, this shift has direct commercial implications.

While exports have grown, stricter residue limits, contaminant checks and traceability requirements are tightening across key markets.

Exporters face a dual challenge — defend volumes while investing in systems that cut rejections, mitigate reputational risk and secure long-term contracts.

Climate risk, according to him, is increasingly material to ingredient businesses.

Oterra has conducted greenhouse gas analysis in turmeric farming to create de-carbonisation roadmaps and is working with farmers on water efficiency, crop rotation and regenerative practices.

Sonntag said future growth will favour companies that combine scale with responsibility and embed trust across the entire value chain.

Cargill opens ₹300-crore dairy feed plant, second in Punjab

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Cargill Animal Nutrition & Health on Thursday inaugurated a modern dairy feed plant at Wazirabad in Punjab, built on an investment of ₹300 crore.

The facility will give dairy farmers access to science-based, world-class feed solutions at scale, the company said. Spread over 15 acres with an annual production capacity of 4,00,000 tonnes, it is Cargill's largest dairy feed plant in South Asia and its second in Punjab after Bathinda.

The unit is expected to generate over 1,000 direct and indirect jobs and help meet rising demand from the state's core dairy markets.

Products from the plant will be sold under the global Provimi and Purina brands, catering to dairy farmers, producers and feed mills.

BETTER PRODUCTIVITY

Located in a high-density dairy region, the Wazirabad facility brings production closer to farming communities in one of North India's most productive milk belts.

Equipped with advanced automation, it will manufacture a wide range of feed for calves and milking animals.

The company said consistent availability of safe, quality feed will help improve milk yields, animal health and farmer incomes, while strengthening the overall dairy value chain.

The plant was inaugurated by Sanjeev Arora, State Minister for Industries & Commerce, along with the Cargill leadership.

INVESTMENT PUSH

"Investments from global companies like Cargill will further strengthen the state's industrial ecosystem and create employment opportunities for local communities, supporting rural livelihoods," Arora said.

Ravinder Balain, President, Cargill India and Senior Managing Director, Cargill Animal Nutrition & Health (India), said the expanded manufacturing presence would ensure reliable access to high-quality, low-toxin feed compliant with BIS standards, improving supply reliability and farm profitability, while supporting local employment.

Go for longs in lead futures

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

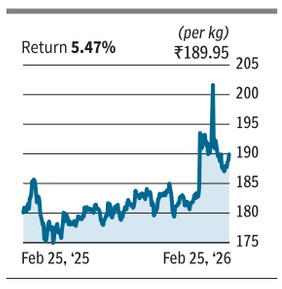
Lead futures, which saw considerable volatility between the final week of January and mid-February, have been trading flat for more than a week now. The February contract is currently trading at ₹187 (per kg), and the March futures is now around ₹190 (per kg).

COMMODITY CALL.

Since the February contract is nearing expiry on February 27, we are considering the March contract for analysis and trade recommendation.

The March lead futures has formed a base at ₹188, per the recent price action.

The chart shows some positive bias and so, although there might not be a



sharp rally, we might see the price gradually moving up to ₹194 in the short term. A breakout of ₹194 will open the door for a rally to ₹200.

On the other hand, if lead futures breach the support at ₹188, they might decline to ₹180. Overall, it has a support at ₹188, and there is a chance for a rebound in price.

TRADE STRATEGY

Go long on lead futures (March) at ₹189.50. Target and stop-loss can be ₹194 and ₹187.50, respectively.

Brio Hydroponics to have 100 Vexotics brand stores by March 2027

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Gujarat-based Brio Hydroponics plans to have 100 stores under its Vexotics brand, an agri-retail brand for marketing exotic herbs, leafy greens and micro-greens focusing on pesticide-free and nutrient-rich produce, by March 2027, according to Praveen Patel, Founder, Brio Hydroponics.

"We have established our footprint with organised retail chains like Reliance Fresh and Star Bazaar, where Vexotics has been onboarded as a vendor. Under Vexotics, we now cater to HoReCa (hotel, restaurants and catering), B2C (business to consumer), B2B (business-to-business), shops, merchants and exporters," he

Praveen Patel, Founder, Brio Hydroponics

told *businessline* in an online interaction.

STRUCTURED ECOSYSTEM

Brio wanted to retain full control over the growth of Vexotics, while scaling systematically across different channels. "Given the scale at which we were expanding, it became important to build a structured ecosystem — covering branding, distribution, B2B, B2C and HoReCa — in a well-organised manner. That's why we established Vexotics as an independent company, built a separate leadership team and today we are growing well in terms of both scale and speed," said Patel.

The company's focus is on premium, residue-free produce for high-net-worth investors and quality-conscious middle-class consumers — fresh food grown in controlled environments, without chemicals and residues, available throughout the year.

On the progress of the company's 100-acre hydroponic parks, he said they were developing 100 individual units. "The first phase of 30 acres is operational, and the response has been encouraging," he said.

NTPC, CEA at loggerheads over two-shift operations, minimum technical load for TPPs

NTPC'S FEAR. Operating units at less than 55% minimum technical load not feasible, particularly due to issues like poor coal quality

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

NTPC differs with the Central Electricity Authority (CEA) on enabling two-shift operations at thermal power plants (TPPs) as well as running units at technical minimum loads below 55 per cent to avoid curtailment of renewable energy (RE) and ensure grid security.

The findings are part of a draft report by a 12-member committee formed by the CEA in May last year to study potential damage to TPPs due to flexible operations.

The committee was formed on instructions of the Union Power Secretary after NTPC in a meeting in May 2025 expressed "serious concerns" over two-shift operations and 40 per cent load flexing, citing adverse impact on unit health.

During the meeting, the State-run power generation behemoth, with a cumulative installed capacity of almost 84 GW, said that operating units below 55 per cent minimum technical load (MTL) is technically not feasible, particularly due to issues such as poor coal quality. The company is "already experiencing" high boiler tube leakages, frequent flame failures, and a significant increase in generator and turbine failures over the past three years. Repeated ramp-ups and ramp-downs are accelerating wear and reducing the lifespan of thermal units.

PANEL'S POINTS. The findings are part of a draft report by a 12-member panel formed by the CEA last year to study potential damage to TPPs due to flexible operations

INDIA'S 500 GW TARGET

"NTPC added that consequently they are not in a position to support two-shift operations," the draft report said. The committee held three meetings — in July, August and October 2025 — with the CEA, NTPC, Damodar Valley Corporation (DVC), BHEL, Grid India, Intertek, the US India Strategic Partnership Forum (USISPF).

During the meeting, Grid India said that achieving India's target of 500 GW of RE capacity and 50 per cent non-fossil energy by 2030 is contingent upon significantly enhancing grid flexibility through a combination of flexible thermal operation (40 per cent MTL), two-shift operation, battery energy storage systems (BESS), and pumped storage projects (PSPs). During the meeting, Grid India informed that CERC, in a March 2025 *suo motu* order, directed to conduct pilot projects for two-shift operation of TPPs, and tasked the national load despatch centre (NLDC) to identify suitable candidate units.

SHORTCOMING

During the meeting, NTPC said that it is witnessing an increased incidence of Boiler Tube Leakages (BTL), which, according to NTPC, are attributable to thermal fatigue arising from low-load and flexible operating conditions, it added.

With regards to grid balancing and minimisation of equipment damage, multiple ramp-up and ramp-down cycles per unit per day should be avoided, as such operating patterns aggravate thermal stresses and fatigue damage. The committee members requested NTPC on May 2, 2025 (first meeting) to submit operational and technical data of any unit which was operating flexibly up to 55 per cent MTL leading to damage. NTPC finally submitted the data on October 7, 2025 for Farakka Unit-2 (210 MW) and Jhajjar Unit-3 (210 MW).

"NTPC's analysis correlates all failures to flexible operation, ignoring other dominant causes such as frequent start-ups and shutdowns, sub-optimal O&M practices, improper preservation or forced cooling, coal quality deviation and human and procedural errors," the committee said after evaluating NTPC data. The committee also requested NTPC to identify an old unit of capacity 210 MW for 2-shift operation pilot study/test. However, they are reluctant and no response has been received since the first meeting held on July 2, 2025 till finalisation of the report, it added.

"This continued non-availability of pilot units has hindered progress on examination of feasibility, empirical validation of damage mechanisms, delayed formulation of a regulatory compensation framework for two-shift operation," the draft report said.

TN CM lays foundation stone for ₹931-cr DRAM memory modules manufacturing unit

Our Bureau
Chennai

Tamil Nadu CM MK Stalin on Thursday laid the foundation stone for ADATA Semiconductor's DRAM memory modules and flash drives at the Sipcot Industrial Park.

ADATA Semiconductor Pvt Ltd, a wholly-owned subsidiary of Taiwan-based ADATA Technology signed an investment MoU with the State government on January 8, 2024. The ₹931 crore project is expected to generate 823 jobs, according to Guidance Tamil Nadu, a state-run investment facilitating agency. As a global leader in memory technology and the first Taiwanese company to establish memory module manufacturing in India, ADATA's investment marks a significant milestone in Tamil Nadu's semiconductor journey under the India Semiconductor Mission. The proposal also assumes significance as it comes at a time when DRAM memory shortage has been disrupting the entire smartphone and electronics sector.

Contributing over 41 per cent of India's electronics exports, Tamil Nadu continues to advance its high-tech

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ED files prosecution nod against P Chidambaram in PMLA cases

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The Enforcement Directorate on Thursday said it wants an expeditious trial against Congress leader P Chidambaram in two money laundering cases, Aircel-Maxis deal and INX Media, as it has submitted the required sanction for prosecution against the former Union Finance minister before a designated court.

The federal probe agency had filed a chargesheet in the Aircel-Maxis case in 2018 and in the INX Media case in 2020 at the special Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) court in Delhi (Rouse Avenue) and the court took their separate cognisance in 2021.

However, in November 2024, the Supreme Court directed (in the ED vs Bibhu Prasad Acharya case) that sanction for prosecution is mandatory in a PMLA chargesheet, similar to such an approval furnished while filing a chargesheet under the Criminal Procedure Code (CrPC). "To counter such delay and to comply with the judgement of the Supreme Court, ED has swiftly initiated remedial actions by seeking prosecution sanctions in all such prosecution complaints involving public servants," the ED said in a statement.

Shivamuruga Textile Mills Private Limited,
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TENDER NOTICE

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Item No	Particulars	Qty in Nos	EMD in Rs.	Appx. Value Rs. In Lakhs
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3	Air Compressor	1	21215/-	22.43
4	Dryer, Filter and Pipeline	Set	18030/-	18.03
5	Folding Machine and Inspection Machine	Set	11270/-	11.27
6	Beams	24	18110/-	18.11
7	Electrical Fittings	1	34570/-	49.14

Detailed Tender/Technical specifications for the above machinery and equipment can be obtained at office of SPV mentioned above. The tender document can also be downloaded from the website www.tansidco.tn.gov.in;

Date of commencement of tender : 27.02.2026 at 12.00 p.m.
Last date of issue of tender : 29.03.2026 at 12.00 p.m.
Date of Pre-Bid Meeting : 16.03.2026 at 4.00 p.m.
Last date of receipt of tender : 30.03.2026 at 2.00 p.m.
Date of opening sealed tender at SPV office, Perundurai. : 30.03.2026 at 4.00 p.m.

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9:30 AM - 5:00 PM

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SESSION LINE-UP

10.40 AM
Inaugural Address
Devesh Chaturvedi
Secretary, Department of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare, Government of India

11.00 AM
Special Address
Shaji K. V.
Chairman, NABARD

Session 1 : 11:15 AM
Silent Architects of the Rural Economy
Sarbani Bose, CoE Lead, Gender Equality, PRADAN
Chhavi Rajawat, Former Sarpanch, Soda Village, Rajasthan (2010-2020)
Sanjiv Kanwar, Managing Director, Yara South Asia and Country Head, Yara India
Kalyani Singh, Entrepreneur, Better Life Farming Alliance
Moderated by Shishir Sinha, Associate Editor, *the hindu businessline*

Session 2 : 12:00 NOON
Seeds of Funding
Anupam Gupta, CBO, Kissandhan
Ravi Kumar, Lead-Smallholder Farming, South-East Asia, Bayer AG
Ajay Kumar Jha, Deputy General Manager (Product Development and Marketing), State Bank of India
Moderated by Subramani Ra Mancombu, Consulting Editor, *the hindu businessline*

Session 3 : 12:45 PM
From Field Work to Entrepreneurship
Aruna Debbarma, Lakhpati Didi, Tripura Rural Livelihood Mission
Vaishali Ghuge, Member, Swayam Shikshan Prayog
Moderated by Richa Mishra, Resident Editor, Hyderabad, *the hindu businessline*

Session 4 : 3:00 PM
Precious Metals: Beyond Aam Aadmi's Reach
Kavita Chacko, Research Head, India, World Gold Council
Jateen N Trivedi, VP, Commodity and Currency Research, LKP Securities
Tarun Kanwar, Director, Navrattan Jewellers, Delhi.
Moderated by Lokeshwarri S K, Data Editor, *the hindu businessline*

Session 5 : 3:45 PM
Fireside Chat
Brahmani Nara, Executive Director, Heritage Foods,
with Raghuvir Srinivasan, Editor, *the hindu businessline*

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Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
20 Microns [5]	174.92	176.35	174.10	178.50	174.10	41.72	284.10	160.05	11	177.15
360 One WAM	1131.80	1128.30	1134.60	1142.90	1119.10	628.62	1273.80	790.50	-	-
3i Infotech	13.97	13.99	13.95	14.12	13.85	508.41	27.45	13.85	-	-
3M India	36440.00	36455.00	36545.00	36900.00	36225.00	1.68	38300.00	25714.35	125	36397.45
5PAISA	325.15	320.80	320.05	332.00	316.35	36.30	431.80	287.95	23	320.45
63 MoonsTech [2]	605.25	604.85	605.00	617.95	599.00	111.31	1130.00	541.50	66	605.25
A										
A2Z Infra	17.51	18.81	17.47	19.18	16.62	2517.11	23.25	12.32	-	18.80
Aadhar Hsg	457.25	475.20	461.00	477.90	454.10	647.33	547.80	361.60	-	-
Aarey Drugs	71.75	78.65	72.99	78.92	72.70	431.04	100.00	31.35	-	-
Aarti Drugs	369.70	369.40	371.40	373.15	367.10	94.12	574.95	312.50	18	368.50
Aarti Ind [5]	456.35	455.70	455.50	457.90	453.20	401.31	494.00	338.20	45	455.45
Aarti Pharm	708.30	719.70	709.00	723.90	702.05	104.96	971.00	574.45	-	-
Aavas	1285.90	1291.30	1286.00	1306.00	1280.00	440.85	2238.35	1246.55	16	1292.55
AB Capital	353.10	356.15	354.00	359.00	351.50	5866.53	369.25	150.00	31	355.90
AB InfraBuil	18.31	18.96	18.50	19.76	17.52	1825.19	224.98	17.50	-	-
AB Real Est	1262.40	1291.30	1262.40	1310.90	1262.40	196.52	2537.90	1186.00	-	-
AB Sun Life	911.50	912.85	915.00	932.70	907.00	401.51	934.60	556.45	-	-
ABB [2]	6167.50	6133.00	6170.00	6205.50	6110.50	283.88	6299.80	4590.05	78	6123.85
ABB Powerpro	24986.00	25401.00	24973.00	25470.00	24932.00	93.34	25470.00	10400.00	-	-
Abbott (I)	26410.00	26355.00	26540.00	26540.00	26265.00	1.91	35921.55	26006.30	37	26335.70
ABFRL	68.91	68.55	69.07	69.90	68.05	1372.45	107.71	59.82	-	68.50
ACC	1623.90	1613.10	1628.00	1630.00	1610.10	104.05	2123.30	1594.50	12	1613.20
ACCELYA	1191.00	1214.40	1184.00	1219.00	1184.00	14.05	1524.55	1145.25	16	1214.35
ACME Solar	233.92	234.92	233.92	235.80	232.00	250.99	324.30	172.63	-	-
Action Cons [2]	871.20	894.25	871.20	916.70	871.20	516.23	1390.00	775.00	24	893.65
Acutaas Chem	2165.90	2185.10	2165.90	2200.00	2142.00	169.56	2553.65	1040.50	-	-
Adani Ent [1]	2231.70	2216.40	2230.00	2232.40	2200.10	915.34	2612.75	1850.00	110	2214.95
Adani Green	964.15	965.95	964.15	973.50	956.55	911.14	1179.20	758.00	216	965.30
Adani Ports [2]	1528.70	1550.60	1537.60	1554.60	1526.00	1353.29	1584.00	1036.35	180	1550.60
Adani Pwr [2]	140.54	141.34	141.00	142.00	140.50	6526.44	182.75	94.41	27	141.40
Adani T Gas	515.15	516.10	517.50	519.90	514.00	174.55	798.00	507.05	-	-
Adani Wilm	190.73	189.41	191.10	191.62	188.08	1421.52	291.20	188.08	-	-
Adani.E.Sol	1013.00	1023.95	1023.20	1036.20	1009.00	1114.74	1067.70	639.45	-	-
ADF Foods [2]	204.54	201.43	204.50	207.00	199.90	105.98	301.00	168.80	24	202.55
AdityaBirlaL	104.42	102.90	105.00	106.22	102.20	516.71	175.00	100.86	-	-
AdityaInfote	1575.70	1610.00	1600.00	1664.90	1600.00	625.36	1745.10	1015.00	-	-
AdityaVisi	480.90	490.30	477.70	500.00	475.00	182.23	598.70	327.60	-	-
AdorWelding	1058.70	1066.40	1059.80	1075.80	1055.10	4.03	1260.00	788.00	-	-
Advait Ener	1678.50	1731.30	1680.50	1750.00	1680.50	28.16	1885.00	1351.00	-	-
Advance Agro	128.31	125.84	130.25	130.44	125.20	147.73	154.00	102.00	-	-
Advent Hotel	197.65	196.99	197.00	200.50	196.00	69.31	345.05	167.77	-	-
Advenzymes [2]	304.25	300.40	306.25	308.50	297.05	92.19	366.55	257.85	27	300.95
Aegis Log [1]	727.45	698.75	729.95	729.95	696.20	595.64	946.50	639.50	38	698.90
Aegis VopakT	235.69	234.38	235.00	237.34	230.02	497.78	302.00	198.00	-	-
Aequs	143.04	142.28	142.73	144.09	141.16	362.13	165.40	131.14	-	-
Aeroflex Ind	227.38	229.32	228.85	231.99	226.00	1442.12	234.99	148.01	-	-
AeroflexEnt	78.42	78.01	79.21	79.99	77.25	150.37	113.90	72.14	-	-
Aether Ind	970.90	961.40	968.00	976.10	953.00	136.36	1083.60	725.00	-	-
Afcons Infra	307.75	297.10	308.00	309.00	295.15	882.40	498.70	294.50	-	-
Affle [2]	1373.60	1329.60	1375.00	1380.30	1325.00	326.04	2186.80	1221.05	147	1329.20
Afford Robo	191.58	181.17	191.58	193.48	177.37	75.23	534.40	157.53	-	-
Agarwal ind	550.95	552.20	551.50	564.80	550.90	18.70	1113.95	550.00	21	551.95
AGI Greenpac	555.85	555.40	558.90	562.40	549.15	282.71	1009.00	545.15	-	-
AGI Infra	307.35	308.95	309.95	317.20	306.05	1619.62	1408.00	224.70	-	-
Ahluwalia Co [2]	753.75	760.40	753.75	774.05	750.10	102.82	1129.20	626.75	19	759.50
AIA Engg [2]	3912.10	3921.30	3912.10	3974.60	3859.80	19.88	4200.00	3000.60	28	3921.90
Ajanta Pharm [2]	3021.30	2978.90	3035.00	3054.00	2970.00	161.36	3052.20	2022.05	40	2981.35
Ajax Engg	490.50	488.90	494.00	495.00	485.00	82.02	756.20	465.00	-	-
Ajmera [2]	131.74	132.00	132.15	135.09	129.20	241.90	221.23	129.50	24	131.45
Akme Fin	7.19	7.14	7.07	7.31	7.00	3354.49	90.70	3.92	-	-
Akums Drugs	478.65	482.25	478.90	489.95	478.90	91.60	622.95	405.00	-	-
Akzo Ind	3091.00	3028.50	3091.00	3091.00	2955.00	36.37	3909.25	2649.05	37	3029.55
Alankit [1]	8.95	8.67	8.86	9.10	8.60	319.78	18.07	8.55	-	8.70
ALEM PHARMA [2]	739.90	729.60	738.00	748.90	726.05	137.61	1107.80	725.45	28	728.95
Alembic Ltd [2]	92.10	91.14	92.19	92.88	90.10	372.34	125.70	85.55	17	91.19
Algoquant Fi	59.92	59.79	59.99	60.89	58.52	1365.59	71.01	56.00	-	-
AlivusLife	907.55	920.05	911.05	931.75	902.90	66.78	1225.10	819.00	-	-
Alkem labs [2]	5625.00	5752.00	5635.00	5764.50	5622.50	84.23	5933.00	4498.90	31	5750.75
ALKYL AMINES [2]	1490.40	1491.40	1485.00	1498.50	1474.00	30.52	2448.80	1474.05	42	1489.90
Allcargo Glo [2]	8.56	8.55	8.57	8.68	8.54	3324.70	16.18	8.14	-	8.57
ALLIED DIGIT [5]	117.88	120.97	118.00	122.43	118.00	138.73	226.50	110.60	50	120.85
AlliedBlend	489.95	487.50	487.00	494.55	481.55	111.59	696.80	279.00	-	-
Alok Ind	14.50	14.50	14.45	14.63	14.25	4882.46	23.50	14.00	-	-
Amagi Media	386.45	388.70	388.00	396.00	379.50	152.89	438.40	318.00	-	-
AmantaHealth	100.65	104.84	100.00	106.80	100.00	131.29	154.40	97.75	-	-
Amar.Raj.Enr	848.10	853.70	861.00	861.00	847.15	205.33	1109.00	810.10	-	-
Amber	8044.50	7942.50	8044.50	8044.50	7919.00	204.01	8625.00	5404.00	192	7943.75
Ambuja Cem [2]	511.10	512.15	513.00	515.80	510.00	1099.25	625.00	455.00	35	512.20
Anand RathiW	3055.90	3073.10	3045.00	3092.00	3045.00	215.91	4250.90	1594.00	-	-
AnandRathiS	505.20	504.45	506.95	511.45	501.00	126.19	794.85	431.00	-	-
Anant Raj [2]	537.55	535.90	538.00	547.00	535.00	1074.85	744.10	366.15	67	536.05
Anant Raj Gl	150.99	149.83	152.00	152.89	147.28	342.74	206.10	103.22	-	-
Andhra Paper	68.36	69.07	68.90	71.24	68.31	224.35	90.00	61.16	-	-
Andhra Sug [2]	72.32	72.48	72.35	73.35	71.66	84.96	87.99	63.27	9	72.76
AngelOne	2489.90	246.50	251.00	254.90	241.40	7992.02	3285.00	241.40	-	-
Anlon Health	108.35	108.19	109.99	112.49	106.29	166.57	172.75	90.78	-	-
AntelopusSel	540.95	511.90	541.00	542.35	502.80	542.26	767.95	357.00	-	-
AnthemBiosci	704.10	703.50	713.00	713.95	693.00	89.83	873.50	579.15	-	-
Antony W Hdg	513.55	508.35	509.40	513.90	502.35	71.67	693.00	408.05	-	-
Anup Engg	1586.20	1613.30	1586.20	1634.40	1575.00	77.78	3633.05	1570.10	-	-
Anupam Ras.	1269.50	1251.70	1269.50	1269.50	1247.00	188.08	1407.00	601.00	-	-
Apar Ind	10579.00	10807.00	10600.00	10882.00	10475.00	94.20	11035.50	4270.00	44	10790.60
Apcotex Ind [2]	371.25	367.10	369.60	372.45	362.35	11.72	443.35	286.65	23	366.85
Apex	419.95	423.25	424.90	427.00	416.30	416.19	486.10	179.20	42	422.40
APL Apollo [2]	2230.60	2226.40	2241.00	2247.70	2200.00	413.83	2300.90	1365.40	125	2226.25
APOLLO [1]	239.10	248.25	239.00	258.15	239.00	5518.82	354.65	101.05	91	248.20
Apollo Hosp. [5]	7783.00	7775.00	7800.00	7831.00	7729.00	361.76	8099.00	6002.15	77	7778.55
Apollo Pipes	340.30	347.20	338.60	351.05	335.95	469.41	494.95	252.10	-	-
Apollo Tyres [1]	463.25	460.85	463.00	464.75	456.05	503.06	540.30	368.00	26	461.10
Aptech Ltd	87.46	86.38	87.50	89.32	85.00	230.26	182.40	75.00	24	86.61
Aptus V Hsg	247.30	245.70	247.00	250.45	243.15	1247.20	364.00	234.40	-	-
AQYLON NEXUS	1330.80	1264.30	1354.90	1354.90	1264.30	20.08	2247.00	435.10	-	-
Archean Chem	590.15	596.00	593.30	599.00	578.50	124.69	727.60	461.25	-	-
Arfin IndiaL	70.89	72.33	71.85	73.93	69.05	980.06	84.01	31.43	-	-
Arih Super	259.85	265.00	256.00	271.50	256.00	154.35	468.15	251.00	-	264.05
Arih.Capital	80.29	80.45	80.93	80.99	78.21	474.00	120.00	58.15	-	-
Arisinfra So	110.38	114.81	113.50	122.30	112.40	3790.61	208.50	82.18	-	-
Arkade Dev	114.75	115.93	114.50	116.93	114.10	154.69	213.69	107.96	-	-
Arman Fin	1610.50	1591.70	1610.50	1642.50	1576.30	22.17	1849.95	1111.00	38	1594.60
Arrow green	413.95	408.60	419.40	419.40	406.50	17.25	816.15	404.00	14	407.55
Artemis Med	232.21	234.84	232.21	237.00	229.62	105.20	306.15	207.71	-	-
Arvind Fash [4]	439.55	436.45	439.55	442.65	434.10	106.69	579.05	338.00	-	436.40
Arvind Ltd	357.10	353.20	357.00	359.85	348.45	421.58	404.95	271.55	33	352.30
ArvindSmart	534.75	532.55	533.00	538.50	522.05	41.43	756.00	504.10	106	533.80
Asahi Ind. [1]	931.40	938.80	933.00	943.00	926.80	48.60	1072.95	576.60	80	940.25
Ashapura [2]	546.95	542.55	549.85	556.00	540.00	380.37	924.70	302.00	38	543.00
Ashiana hous [2]	322.80	325.50	324.35	330.70	321.15	91.29	374.00	248.75	27	326.30
Ashok Leylan [1]	211.61	211.92	211.65	212.89	210.32	7744.47	215.35	95.20	34	211.90
Ashoka [5]	137.80	138.71	138.00	141.85	136.52	980.63	230.70	136.70	19	138.80
Asian Energy	305.55	305.90	308.60	310.00	298.00	105.33	391.65	215.00	-	-
Asian granit	73.58	73.01	73.75	75.25	72.40	5248.78	78.78	39.58	58	72.98
Asian Paints [1]	2416.40	2394.90	2416.10	2422.20	2382.00	588.74	2985.50	2125.00	57	2395.00
ASK Auto.	426.90	424.30	428.00	430.45	422.45	58.43	578.50	333.30	-	-
Asso Alcohol	816.45	800.70	816.60	828.95	793.00	38.18	1477.95	774.05	-	-
ASTECFE	620.65	627.85	616.00	637.25	616.00	17.91	990.87	555.40	-	624.75
ASTERDM	642.60	649.45	643.35	651.00	632.75	277.14	732.00	386.15	102	649.40
Astra Micro [2]	955.25	991.30	959.90	1001.15	954.85	636.66	1195.65	584.20	64	992.10
Astral Poly [1]	1683.20	1684.20	1683.20	1693.90	1669.00	615.18	1693.75	1232.00	79	1683.90
Astrazeneca [2]	8869.00	8849.00	8826.50	8949.00	8810.00	2.56	10653.05	6501.60	106	8850.60
Atal RealTe	25.61	25.46	25.65	26.19	25.25	2038.73	29.20	11.15	-	-
AtherEnergy	706.30	700.30	710.45	710.50	686.00	2048.53	790.00	288.15	-	-
Atlanta Elec	884.35	883.60	901.95	901.95	878.45	56.41	1097.85	707.60	-	-
ATUL AUTO [5]	477.70	502.80	477.10	523.95	477.10	2600.92	554.20	381.70	30	503.15
ATUL.	6540.00	6528.50	6540.00	6609.00	6486.00	12.29	7793.00	4882.00	37	6536.10
AU SFB	982.10	972.70	982.10	983.95	967.45	3615.18	1038.75	479.00	31	973.10
Aurionpro So	894.70	864.65	900.00	917.15	861.30	169.34	1663.15	862.05	43	864.40
Aurob Pharm [1]	1211.50	1220.70	1217.10	1250.90	1213.50	2372.71	1278.00	994.35	33	1222.00
Authum Inv	492.65	489.95	491.00	493.45	486.85	123.96	3318.70	472.00	-	-
Auto Axles	2051.30	2030.20	2056.40	2070.00	2012.60	9.83	2125.95	1533.15	19	2023.60
Avadh Sugar	323.80	333.20	320.90	334.70	320.55	73.18	586.35	307.75	9	333.40
Avalon Tech	988.50	1024.50	979.00	1029.95	979.00	179.97	1318.00	640.10	-	-
Avantel	143.87	146.05	144.30	148.38	143.87	670.48	215.00	102.20	-	-
Avanti Feeds [1]	1355.60	1335.55	1355.60	1358.90	1327.65	576.72	1489.45	582.00	32	1336.10
AvenueSai	17.23	16.81	17.31	17.44	16.70	8592.43	23.64	14.75	-	-
Awfis Space	298.30	297.35	298.30	306.00	294.35	146.90	718.95	291.70	-	-
Axis Bank [2]	1403.00	1395.50	1403.00	1405.70	1386.00	8979.55	1418.30	992.00	18	1394.70
AXISCADES [5]	1496.40	1470.90	1498.30	1529.90	1463.50	82.15	1778.55	662.25	195	1470.90
Aye Finance	119.99	126.84	119.51	128.50	117.20	1159.50	149.50	117.35	-	126.80
Azad Engg	1735.80	1731.30	1736.00	1760.00	1717.90	167.20	1899.00	1159.45	-	-
B										
Baazar Style	317.10	304.95	318.05	320.40	304.20	252.90	392.00	204.05	-	-
BAJAJ AUTO	10097.00	10110.00	10146.50	10187.00	10029.50	177.81	10186.60	7088.25	31	10108.80
Bajaj Cons [1]	397.05	402.85	397.05	404.00	393.85	340.69	408.65	151.95	33	402.75
Bajaj Elect [2]	368.60	372.60	369.10	375.00	368.85	67.53	710.00	367.30	93	373.10
Bajaj Fin [1]	1021.05	1012.95	1020.75	1031.20	1006.05	4336.26	1102.45	810.21	39	1012.75
Bajaj Finser [1]	2049.30	2041.30	2057.00	2063.80	2028.00	493.13	2194.65	1733.15	230	2041.35
Bajaj HCare	339.60	331.80	335.10	340.65	329.10	175.63	745.00	329.10	-	-
Bajaj Hindus [1]	14.93	15.54	14.93	15.75	14.90	9192.87	29.62	14.89	-	15.56
Bajaj Holdng	11166.00	10951.00	11184.00	11224.00	10880.00	109.42	14873.20	10406.00	45	10956.40
Bajaj HouFin	87.78	87.57	88.00	88.02	87.25	3115.37	136.96	86.67	-	-
Bajel Proj.	161.73	160.44	164.15	164.15	159.50	57.25	263.90	142.34	-	-
Balaji Amine [2]	1101.80	1088.60	1104.00	1112.10	1083.70	43.64	1946.00	1060.35	25	1091.10
Balaji Tele. [2]	102.38	108.65	102.79	109.92	102.06	925.61	139.99	49.18	22	109.06
Balkrish Ind [2]	2517.00	2462.40	2508.10	2508.10	2432.40	137.62	2815.40	2157.20	37	2461.60
BalmerLawrie	180.14	180.81	180.00	181.59	179.51	100.68	238.00	146.70	13	180.70
BalramChini [1]	466.90	461.30	465.00	471.00	458.20	341.33	627.00	393.40	22	461.40
Balu Forge	444.95	489.40	452.00	489.40	452.00	2791.98	784.00	341.05	-	-
Banco Prod [2]	639.70	631.25	644.80	644.85	624.20	156.10	879.60	292.95	26	631.55
Bandhan Bk	182.88	186.10	183.00	190.23	182.78	19052.65	192.45	134.05	30	186.10
Bank of Maha	74.08	75.65	74.75	75.90	73.15	42042.41	75.86	38.11	9	75.62
BartronicInd	10.69	10.44	10.70	10.84	10.34	792.18	19.00	10.10	-	-
BASF India	3526.50	3529.40	3522.00	3560.00	3518.10	8.70	5418.20	3515.00	40	3522.60
Bata India [5]	797.50	794.65	800.00	810.00	792.50	97.31	1343.95	792.05	54	795.40
Bayer Crop	4727.90	4667.60	4751.50	4765.00	4656.00	8.42	6539.95	4276.85	31	4679.95
BCL Ind.	27.82	28.20	27.82	28.54	27.80	475.80	49.30	26.07	-	-
BDL [5]	1240.80	1273.40	1245.00	1277.40	1245.00	903.68	2096.00	908.90	80	1272.50
Belrise Inds	184.99	185.39	185.99	186.00	181.01	4012.54	193.74	89.15	-	-
BEML [5]	1719.20	1709.00	1717.00	1728.70	1692.20	130.16	2437.43	1173.18	56	1708.55
BergerPaints [1]	456.05	459.25	458.25	462.45	456.15	210.87	604.60	449.00	50	458.85
Beta Drugs	1030.30	1046.20	1032.10	1068.50	1032.10	8.22	2010.00	990.10	-	-
Bhagynagar [2]	152.03	151.11	153.95	157.40	150.00	80.82	194.00	63.01	-	150.95
Bhandari Hos [1]	3.05	2.97	3.09	3.13	2.95	793.90	5.80	2.94	-	2.97
BHANSALI ENG [1]	81.28	80.91	81.28	82.45	80.50	308.27	123.60	79.25	12	80.94
BHARAT BIJLE [5]	2420.10	2429.70	2420.10	2455.00	2416.10	15.51	3472.55	2372.60	21	2429.15
Bharat Elect [1]	439.30	449.05	440.60	449.90	440.00	13738.21	461.40	243.50	55	449.00
Bharat Forge [2]	1902.00	1912.00	1902.10	1919.90	1884.80	1444.60	1919.00	919.10	68	1912.20
Bharat Gears	108.34	108.73	108.00	110.96	107.00	33.80	154.35	65.00	13	109.00
Bharat Rasay [5]	1520.20	1544.50	1520.90	1568.90	1500.00	20.13	3030.25	1500.00	18	1547.95
Bharat Wire	177.68	177.65	177.00	180.27	175.00	480.07	248.70	122.40	16	177.50
BharatCoking	33.28	33.42	33.28	34.15	33.05	10604.21	45.09	32.20	-	-
BharatSeats	195.64	194.26	198.55	202.39	191.10	253.17	239.45	69.84	-	-
Bharti Airte [5]	1913.40	1929.60	1914.00	1935.00	1904.50	10795.03	2174.70	1561.00	50	1928.50
Bharti Hexa	1656.20	1658.50	1650.00	1668.90	1650.00	75.70	2052.90	1234.00	-	-
BHEL [2]	261.95	264.85	263.00	265.50	259.75	6496.83	305.85	176.00	115	264.85
Bigbloc [2]	51.50	50.68	52.00	53.00	50.21	119.43	80.60	48.10	-	50.29
Bikaji Fds	624.70	631.10	624.70	633.90	624.55	168.38	818.70	600.00	-	-
Billionbrain	164.44	164.94	165.00	165.20	161.50	14639.71	193.80	112.00	-	-
Biocon [5]	395.85	394.85	394.85	401.05	389.20	5257.00	424.95	290.80	329	394.05
BIRLA CORPN.	999.90	988.90	1004.90	1004.90	982.10	52.31	1537.15	901.85	24	991.65
Birlanu Ltd	1522.30	1513.10	1522.00	1565.00	1505.00	11.56	2428.30	1500.10	-	-
Birlasoft	371.75	383.75	371.95	388.00	371.20	2131.69	474.00	331.00	-	-
Bk of baroda [2]	315.85	324.45	316.00	325.50	316.00	20502.41	325.55	190.70	9	324.50
Bk of India	175.58	177.20	175.58	177.90	174.75	8488.76	178.20	92.74	8	177.10
BL kashyap [1]	48.05	48.38	48.00	49.24	47.81	232.36	80.07	42.71	-	48.25
Black Box	545.45	544.85	546.00	563.00	531.00	581.34	613.80	320.85	-	-
Bliss GVS [1]	219.02	217.37	219.90	223.50	214.67	1197.41	244.05	105.05	30	217.50
BLS [1]	290.20	279.25	290.95	291.90	278.00	2027.35	428.30	246.05	-	278.75
BLS e-Svc	156.80	155.82	157.04	158.95	154.90	100.88	232.50	131.31	-	-
Blue Jet Hlt	399.75	398.10	395.05	414.00	395.00	697.56	1027.80	352.55	-	-
Blue Star [2]	1942.20	1964.90	1945.00	1975.00	1930.70	239.18	2266.70	1521.20	98	1965.70
BlueDart Exp	5622.00	5612.00	5645.00	5668.00	5569.00	5.00	7222.35	5196.00	46	5612.55
BluestoneJew	422.10	432.45	421.05	437.85	418.10	258.27	793.00	399.80	-	-
BluspringEnt	54.04	52.90	54.50	55.49	52.62	158.45	100.88	52.62	-	-
BMW Ventures	60.37	61.68	61.80	62.40	59.61	616.27	78.00	50.02	-	-
Bodal Chem [2]	46.62	46.28	46.99	47.69	45.50	269.46	81.50	45.36	22	46.20
Bom Dyeing [2]	113.39	114.63	113.50	115.49	113.50	374.88	196.50	108.45	-	114.65
BombayBurma [2]	1764.00	1725.00	1756.30	1763.90	1712.60	33.49	2156.10	1521.00	199	1726.75
Borosil	241.25	236.20	244.45	244.45	235.50	92.96	397.95	235.50	-	-
Borosil.Ren.	473.60	465.25	475.00	483.00	463.95	276.98	721.00	441.45	-	-
Borosil.Sci.	104.70	105.70	105.00	107.98	105.00	51.54	190.79	99.53	-	-
Bosch Home	1405.50	1421.20	1417.40	1438.00	1405.00	12.06	1893.00	1270.00	-	-
BOSCH	36570.00	36740.00	36590.00	36825.00	36200.00	16.22	41894.30	25938.20	47	36732.75
BPCL	381.05	386.00	380.00	387.00	378.55	4800.19	391.85	234.15	7	385.90
BPL	53.98	55.69	55.06	57.99	54.35	179.61	100.30	49.66	5	55.91
BrainbeesSol	210.50	220.45	211.50	223.25	211.10	7352.62	438.70	207.05	-	-
Brigade	714.35	716.15	718.10	731.90	714.15	115.52	1332.35	704.75	43	715.90
BrigadeHotel	62.63	61.82	62.22	62.48	61.51	51.65	91.77	58.02	-	-
Britannia [1]	6158.00	6137.00	6158.00	6187.00	6070.00	245.32	6336.95	4506.50	61	6137.35
BSE Ltd	2772.70	2800.90	2784.00	2832.00	2752.00	4270.95	7588.00	2021.50	-	-
BYKE Hosp	43.42	43.50	43.01	45.34	43.01	117.86	102.30	42.96	39	44.05
C										
Camlin Fine [1]	141.00	139.35	140.10	144.38	138.00	573.15	334.70	128.10	-	139.15

For BSE/NSE live quotes, scan the QR code or click the link https://bit.ly/2FpossK

CHENNAI
businessline.
FRIDAY - FEBRUARY 27 - 2026

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
PayTM	1133.20	1122.80	1134.50	1142.00	1103.50	2783.13	1381.80	651.50	-	-
PB Fintech	1519.40	1524.80	1514.80	1533.70	1508.30	1276.79	1978.00	1311.35	-	-
PC Jeweller [1]	10.07	10.03	10.11	10.24	10.01	20301.90	19.65	8.66	-	10.04
PCBL	306.50	300.50	307.40	309.65	299.10	850.49	444.15	254.50	-	-
PDS	303.95	300.30	302.45	305.50	298.20	120.51	466.00	289.95	-	-
Penland Ltd [2]	17.44	17.67	17.17	18.00	17.17	303.28	46.00	17.09	-	17.58
PENNAR IND [5]	140.63	149.92	140.00	151.25	140.00	1419.37	279.80	139.50	20	150.25
PERSISTENT [5]	4731.00	4781.50	4765.00	4933.00	4746.50	1104.88	6597.00	4163.80	48	4776.00
Petronet LNG	313.90	317.00	314.00	317.65	312.60	3103.86	326.50	263.70	13	317.05
Pfizer Ltd.	5146.20	5091.20	5160.00	5170.80	5064.10	6.74	5987.65	3742.90	31	5093.05
PG Electro [1]	621.70	624.65	621.70	631.70	619.00	1039.23	1008.00	471.15	143	624.45
PGIL [5]	1539.20	1553.30	1539.30	1568.00	1539.30	23.18	1993.30	884.00	94	1552.75
Phoenix Mill [2]	1694.00	1715.90	1699.70	1720.80	1668.30	377.39	1965.00	1403.00	210	1716.00
PhysicsWall	91.80	89.30	92.00	92.09	88.10	10455.14	161.99	88.10	-	-
PI INDUS.LTD [1]	3093.50	3134.20	3099.90	3148.00	3094.10	94.51	4329.00	2952.05	29	3131.35
PiccadilyAgr	575.15	577.80	579.95	583.00	562.40	134.68	805.50	533.15	-	-
Pidilite [1]	1497.60	1516.90	1495.00	1525.00	1487.10	738.38	1575.00	1310.08	67	1516.90
Pine Labs	198.73	190.11	199.00	200.00	189.00	1121.53	284.00	189.00	-	-
Piramal Fin	1772.30	1764.00	1800.00	1828.50	1755.20	107.91	1954.50	1260.00	-	-
Piramal Phr	161.06	162.42	161.19	164.59	159.80	3340.01	240.95	148.31	-	-
Pitti Engg [5]	885.25	915.90	883.90	919.95	883.85	58.49	1121.00	677.20	33	916.60
Pix Transm	1452.70	1445.20	1453.00	1470.00	1432.90	12.60	1799.60	1220.10	-	-
PlatinumInd	223.04	226.03	223.04	231.90	223.04	62.98	342.40	213.00	-	-
Plaza Wires	37.46	37.99	37.41	38.79	37.10	58.95	65.34	34.63	-	-
PN Gadgil Jw	547.00	544.50	547.00	550.95	541.00	64.14	701.40	473.80	-	-
Pnb Gilts	78.41	78.03	78.41	79.00	77.70	147.11	119.84	73.55	6	78.21
PNB Housng	849.15	847.70	836.05	869.15	836.05	440.57	1141.85	746.10	10	848.05
PNC Infra [2]	212.49	211.67	212.50	218.04	210.05	305.70	331.80	205.60	15	211.55
Pokarna Ltd [2]	919.95	919.45	929.90	951.85	908.95	65.15	1359.05	692.55	-	919.85
Poly Medicu [5]	1299.20	1258.70	1285.10	1301.90	1255.00	187.77	2936.70	1242.25	37	1259.70
Polycab Ind.	8348.50	8506.00	8348.50	8539.50	8345.00	629.66	8539.50	4555.00	-	-
Polyplex	824.40	839.50	828.70	845.30	810.00	63.95	1396.80	775.00	39	834.60
PonawallaFin	461.05	464.20	473.00	475.55	461.25	3087.47	570.40	267.20	-	-
Pondy Oxides	1152.90	1164.50	1156.00	1189.60	1151.10	232.58	1578.00	490.00	-	-
Popular Veh.	84.88	90.51	85.75	92.50	84.27	245.43	163.00	83.00	-	-
Power Finan	423.60	420.60	423.90	426.90	416.85	5228.53	443.95	330.05	7	420.35
Power grid	307.25	303.25	307.10	307.70	301.40	14249.52	321.75	247.50	18	303.50
Power Trad	165.59	163.96	165.48	166.24	163.51	939.10	206.90	134.85	12	164.10
POWERMECH	2137.60	2115.80	2130.80	2149.30	2106.00	34.99	3415.45	1698.85	22	2121.25
Prabha Energ	178.20	176.91	183.95	183.95	176.01	82.22	315.90	146.47	-	-
Praj Ind.ltd [2]	301.60	310.10	302.95	316.95	300.50	3248.03	591.90	273.05	36	310.25
Prakash Ind.	136.81	135.74	137.10	140.50	134.71	307.52	191.00	110.00	7	135.75
Prakash Pipe	200.04	203.70	201.00	207.45	200.75	41.96	473.90	186.41	-	-
Precam	138.04	138.60	138.58	142.47	137.35	209.55	263.30	130.60	47	138.95
Precision Wr [1]	302.37	306.98	303.00	312.20	302.00	1589.40	312.05	118.35	43	306.95
Premier Enr	729.40	725.25	734.00	741.60	713.95	2431.01	1163.90	660.00	-	-
Premier Expl [2]	512.70	541.90	513.20	544.00	513.20	1095.44	682.90	308.95	62	541.70
prestige Est	1420.70	1428.50	1426.90	1440.70	1411.60	521.65	1812.40	1048.30	641	1427.10
Pricol Ltd [1]	624.30	617.70	626.00	639.10	615.25	339.14	694.95	381.50	48	617.50
Prime Focus [1]	270.80	266.51	271.45	274.40	264.20	2897.91	294.05	85.00	-	267.20
Prince Pipe	249.61	251.33	249.90	254.80	248.15	129.22	387.70	229.05	-	-
Prism Cement	125.88	126.15	126.40	126.61	125.00	88.03	172.15	108.00	-	126.20
Privi Speclt	2968.30	2997.20	2990.00	3032.00	2967.50	64.06	3440.50	1368.15	-	-
Procter&Gam	11443.00	11453.00	11465.00	11471.00	11398.00	2.60	14536.60	11308.35	43	11463.25
ProstarmInfo	152.22	150.05	153.02	154.90	146.62	215.42	253.49	108.00	-	-
Protean EGov	582.90	598.05	584.95	615.00	584.10	415.10	1484.50	580.00	-	-
Prozone Rlty	49.91	50.81	49.11	52.00	49.11	755.72	72.77	27.30	-	-
Prudent Corp	2539.70	2469.00	2521.60	2543.50	2438.40	80.40	3098.00	1570.00	-	-
PSPPROJECT	751.10	740.60	752.95	754.60	733.05	21.88	1030.80	614.05	81	740.00
PTC Ind.	18047.00	17949.00	18047.00	18232.00	17843.00	9.40	19387.00	9799.90	-	-
PTCFIN SER	31.01	30.69	31.15	31.27	30.50	434.56	44.49	27.20	6	30.73
Pudumjee Pap [1]	81.50	83.83	81.90	91.00	81.76	910.91	148.05	80.46	9	84.07
PUN.CHEM	1094.50	1141.70	1094.50	1155.90	1064.70	18.14	1664.95	685.30	22	1136.35
Punjab Natio [2]	130.54	130.48	130.69	132.65	129.09	25782.45	135.15	85.50	9	130.45
PUNJABNSIND	25.78	26.19	25.90	26.30	25.69	3395.42	50.49	25.29	15	26.19
Puravankara [5]	213.99	206.76	215.63	215.90	204.10	458.52	338.50	205.00	-	206.70
PVR Inox	1035.15	1032.35	1035.15	1037.40	1021.55	166.08	1249.70	830.00	-	-
Q										
Quadrant Fut	287.15	297.40	288.00	302.05	288.00	370.57	604.75	248.55	-	-
QualityPower	899.45	902.20	904.95	910.00	888.00	611.94	1082.00	267.80	-	-
QUESS	196.86	194.22	196.30	200.85	193.01	150.12	378.10	191.00	13	193.60
Quickheal	167.78	165.62	168.39	171.46	164.60	169.25	416.00	164.80	132	165.60
R										
RACL Geartch	1429.10	1425.40	1469.80	1469.80	1407.50	44.29	1691.90	658.05	-	-
RadhikaJew	66.96	66.34	66.95	67.30	66.06	119.79	111.50	65.32	-	-
Radiant CMS	37.77	37.04	37.95	38.35	36.95	219.91	73.80	36.50	-	-
RadiKhait [2]	2721.10	2700.80	2721.10	2725.00	2672.50	190.24	3695.00	1989.65	68	2699.00
Rail Tel	317.55	312.60	319.15	320.00	310.60	807.19	478.95	265.50	-	-
RAIN [2]	152.63	154.52	153.78	157.03	151.10	2605.13	175.95	99.85	-	154.45
Rainbow Ch.	1210.50	1207.80	1215.00	1221.60	1199.10	56.68	1645.70	1090.00	-	-
Rajoo Engine	63.33	63.06	63.34	63.99	62.51	244.21	145.88	58.68	-	-
Rajratan Glo	420.95	421.75	420.95	432.05	418.05	62.56	540.00	260.00	-	-
Rallis India [1]	276.85	275.35	276.90	280.50	272.80	227.90	385.60	196.00	29	275.25
Ram Ratna Wr	318.30	317.25	321.30	321.60	310.45	37.67	785.95	268.00	-	-
Rama Newsp	37.16	38.48	37.50	39.00	35.20	193.00	45.19	22.89	-	38.69
Rama Phos.	127.42	130.28	129.01	132.59	127.81	44.44	217.19	80.85	-	-
Rama Stl [1]	7.32	7.13	7.40	7.42	6.96	18671.80	14.92	6.96	-	7.15
Ramco Systm	459.05	451.90	459.50	465.90	441.00	100.65	681.80	270.00	76	449.55
Ramco Cem [1]	1151.40	1140.20	1151.40	1154.90	1118.70	87.11	1214.00	788.75	142	1140.00
Ramco Inds. [1]	296.25	294.30	298.75	298.75	291.55	73.81	398.05	216.70	26	295.80
Rashi Perip.	341.00	368.50	346.10	370.20	345.15	568.44	408.70	245.15	-	-
Rashtr.chem.	128.75	127.87	129.00	129.64	127.30	500.95	166.55	108.05	23	127.80
RatanindiaEn	29.81	30.15	30.00	30.70	29.84	2658.32	69.70	29.35	-	-
Rategain Tr.	509.10	512.65	511.00	520.45	505.30	376.86	741.60	412.85	-	-
Ratnamn Met [2]	2411.50	2364.50	2423.20	2433.30	2352.00	13.06	3044.10	1900.05	29	2362.80
Ratnaveer Pr	152.26	152.79	152.90	156.37	152.20	1300.60	177.00	115.99	-	-
Ravindra Enr	145.07	146.64	144.50	147.62	141.27	74.61	191.77	93.41	-	-
Raymond	397.60	405.20	398.65	414.00	398.10	351.97	782.00	361.60	98	405.10
Raymond Life	897.90	898.60	897.90	916.30	894.50	27.86	1411.90	865.30	-	-
RaymondReal	427.30	428.30	433.00	442.00	425.85	92.06	1050.00	407.80	-	-
RBLBank	329.80	326.85	332.00	334.00	324.60	4339.17	340.30	150.65	30	327.00
RBZ Jeweller	124.35	126.14	124.00	127.08	124.00	39.98	179.00	122.50	-	-
RECLTD	354.00	354.10	354.90	357.50	351.15	3258.96	450.35	331.10	5	353.85
Redington [2]	242.55	244.55	242.90	245.50	238.30	1345.95	334.90	181.25	16	244.60
Redtape	124.14	122.11	124.14	124.72	121.12	272.05	167.97	107.53	-	-
Refex Refrig [2]	229.12	226.30	230.35	230.35	222.41	523.67	534.00	209.80	15	227.05
RegaalResour	68.35	69.78	67.90	71.00	66.11	1775.18	145.70	57.27	-	-
Relax Foot [1]	353.95	354.15	355.80	356.00	350.70	37.77	531.45	350.35	52	354.20
Reli Indlnf	708.25	708.45	707.05	719.00	701.45	49.41	1047.20	680.55	105	705.85
Reliance	1398.50	1406.80	1398.50	1412.90	1391.90	16683.86	1611.20	1115.55	48	1405.45
Religare ent	207.16	209.58	207.89	215.42	206.95	2330.82	314.15	202.45	-	209.35
Remsons Ind [2]	112.61	112.29	111.50	113.52	110.80	57.99	157.00	102.30	38	112.15
Renaiss.Glo	128.25	145.80	131.07	147.90	129.12	83583.91	147.90	101.55	-	-
REPCO HOME	384.35	382.95	385.60	385.60	380.80	109.77	463.60	307.95	6	383.65
RestaurBrand	63.70	63.63	63.60	64.30	63.60	1441.52	89.50	59.40	-	-
Rhetan TMT L	26.26	26.05	26.37	26.53	25.93	2997.17	27.69	20.32	-	-
RHI Magnesit	435.45	439.65	435.45	445.55	431.50	420.82	547.90	378.05	-	-
Rico Auto [1]	127.96	131.23	127.80	132.25	127.45	3697.82	142.30	49.50	51	131.05
Rishabh Ins	421.50	428.55	421.50	437.45	421.50	28.82	490.00	201.50	-	-
RITES	218.63	215.63	218.00	218.88	215.00	308.73	316.15	192.30	26	215.75
RK Forgings [2]	542.60	545.75	542.60	548.50	541.80	81.52	862.05	473.35	40	546.15
RK Swamy	98.74	98.65	100.02	100.90	97.85	74.71	248.04	97.50	-	-
RMDrip&Spr	97.95	78.36	78.36	78.36	78.36	484.00	807.45	69.10	-	-
Rolex Rings	140.87	137.12	140.87	140.96	134.68	566.71	1660.00	99.79	-	-
Rossari Bio	493.25	494.45	490.00	497.00	490.00	38.48	766.00	490.00	-	-
ROSSELL IND [2]	45.59	47.52	46.40	47.70	45.00	61.69	86.65	40.25	10	47.52
Rossell Tech	668.15	724.55	672.00	731.00	666.00	125.71	840.00	231.15	-	-
Roto Pumps	57.99	57.89	58.30	58.98	57.60	353.86	310.25	54.12	-	-
Route Mobile	491.15	502.20	492.80	514.30	484.60	321.94	1158.00	484.60	-	-
RPG lifesc [8]	1914.20	1909.30	1920.00	1933.00	1879.40	6.01	2715.90	1772.05	30	1910.90
RPOWER	25.54	25.24	25.16	25.39	24.90	28675.95	76.49	24.90	-	25.23
RPSG Vent.	659.55	683.60	660.20	690.65	660.20	35.92	1027.00	652.75	-	-
RR Kabel	1508.20	1519.20	1515.50	1555.00	1500.00	351.13	1562.60	853.55	-	-
RSystems Int [1]	295.85	293.00	296.00	303.00	290.60	52.41	496.95	273.90	14	292.90
RTNPOWER	8.36	8.29	8.32	8.49	8.24	8271.44	16.94	7.88	-	8.30
Rubicon Rese	788.60	787.65	785.90	799.00	782.35	128.21	822.00	570.75	-	-
Rudra Global	17.84	21.40	18.07	21.40	17.67	1444.00	29.70	17.25	-	-
RUPA & CO [1]	138.16	140.44	138.16	141.48	138.16	79.18	233.45	137.55	16	140.55
Rushil Deco [1]	18.18	17.82	18.11	18.56	17.25	1465.60	33.80	17.50	-	17.52
RVNL	317.60	318.30	319.00	321.00	316.30	6016.16	447.80	301.20	-	-
S										
S&W Solar	201.80	200.86	201.50	206.20	199.66	933.68	348.90	176.60	-	-
SaatvikGreen	380.95	371.65	386.80	389.85	367.00	150.79	567.00	345.00	-	-
Sadhana Nit.	2.16	2.06	2.06	2.06	2.06	673.03	27.59	1.66	-	-
Safari Ind	1867.50	1859.30	1869.00	1891.50	1850.00	13.16	2507.10	1670.15	-	-
Sagar Cemnt [2]	193.09	192.93	193.27	196.45	191.30	25.27	300.00	155.05	-	193.75
Sagility Ind	42.75	40.38	42.90	43.20	40.13	41486.71	57.89	37.60	-	-
Sai Life Sci	923.80	964.50	923.80	966.10	920.15	550.45	983.35	636.10	-	-
Sai Silks	111.41	114.64	111.88	115.75	111.50	601.83	223.03	106.55	-	-
Sakar Health	520.60	514.30	520.60	535.00	496.20	91.84	569.95	210.10	-	-
SAKSOFT [1]	148.07	144.89	148.21	152.00	142.81	363.01	254.15	119.55	26	144.90
Sakuma [1]	1.85	1.79	1.85	1.88	1.78	1313.65	3.82	1.60	-	1.80
SALASAR [1]	7.89	7.92	8.00	8.09	7.89	2154.83	11.53	6.89	-	7.93
Salzer Elec	658.90	657.55	658.90	683.20	651.45	104.87	1167.50	527.00	22	660.80
SambhvStee	101.16	100.79	102.00	102.65	100.50	541.80	149.40	81.42	-	-
Samhi Hotels	167.04	165.06	167.00	167.00	163.42	313.53	254.50	121.10	-	-
Samman Cap.	157.94	153.67	157.75	158.20	153.06	7296.85	192.95	97.61	-	-
Samvard.Moth	133.24	135.31	133.24	135.65	132.74	10959.04	162.25	89.70	-	-
Sanathan Tex	401.75	397.40	403.70	403.80	394.40	23.30	560.20	286.95	-	-
Sandhar	498.75	499.70	503.00	506.15	491.05	133.24	600.10	329.00	17	498.30
Sandur Mang.	213.07	219.87	214.40	222.00	208.89	4362.05	557.75	156.30	-	-
Sanghvi Move [1]	262.00	265.05	262.00	274.60	262.00	291.90	412.90	205.00	16	264.95
Sangi Ind	61.12	61.19	60.50	61.83	60.50	363.37	71.80	50.10	-	61.08
Sanofi Cons.	4009.20	4564.40	4240.00	4811.00	4231.00	1144.99	5894.50	3975.00	-	-
Sanofi ind	4134.70	4015.30	4045.00	4051.00	3957.10	131.81	6717.50	3951.30	27	4014.65
Sansera Engg	2353.40	2289.00	2353.40	2358.30	2265.90	157.81	2396.00	972.20	-	-
Sanstar	85.90	86.13	86.30	87.59	85.98	173.21	107.29	80.00	-	-
Sapphire Fd	214.37	207.78	212.52	215.79	207.10	170.24	368.00	179.40	-	-
Sarda EnMin [1]	532.20	518.90	536.00	536.80	516.80	311.08	639.95	397.10	20	518.45
Saregama (I) [1]	332.60	329.75	334.90	335.55	327.00	144.59	603.00	316.90	32	329.25
SARLA PER F [1]	82.65	82.10	82.80	84.64	81.61	60.46	127.90	68.00	10	82.00
SarveshwarFd	3.88	3.83	3.89	3.91	3.80	2327.49	9.45	3.80	-	-
SASKEN COMM	1153.60	1139.60	1153.60	1165.50	1134.00	8.94	1710.25	1132.90	29	1137.50
Satia Ind.	64.56	64.63	64.00	65.55	64.00	89.14	97.50	58.00	-	-
SATIN	153.94	154.76	154.93	158.40	152.06	119.23	176.00	131.40	8	154.55
Saurash.Cem.	65.41	68.28	66.75	69.48	65.99	148.66	89.00	65.01	-	-
SBC Exports	32.12	32.19	32.12	32.40	32.10	10375.68	32.49	10.95	-	-
SBFC Fin.	96.25	96.93	96.15	97.30	95.60	604.89	123.00	82.00	-	-
SBI Cards	788.75	775.40	784.00	785.00	765.00	735.26	1027.25	725.15	-	-
SBILIFE	2073.60	2082.80	2080.00	2103.40	2063.30	567.10	2132.90	1380.00	84	2082.60
SchlossBanga	439.90	441.00	442.00	445.45	438.60	71.68	474.40	382.50	-	-
SE INVESTM [1]	35.27	36.26	35.20	36.40	34.93	8640.06	41.50	29.40	16	36.26
SecmarkCons	122.04	137.56	139.92	145.99	132.45	314.35	174.63	75.00	-	-
Senco Gold	318.70	316.05	319.00	322.55	314.00	337.91	405.70	227.40	-	-
Senores Phar	772.70	774.55	774.10	792.10	763.20	194.45	876.50	440.30	-	-
SEPC	7.77	7.68	7.84	8.19	7.63	29786.04	17.49	7.63	-	-
Servote.Pwr	73.63	75.11	74.00	76.62	74.00	417.98	168.50	57.51	-	-
Seshaasai Te	239.94	245.65	239.90	253.86	239.90	116.25	437.45	227.01	-	-
SFL [5]	552.95	553.25	553.00	557.65	549.00	53.16	778.20	498.05	83	552.80
SG Mart L	438.75	446.85	441.15	447.90	437.75	176.29	448.00	313.10	-	-
SGFinserveLt	394.05	389.25	392.30	396.90	385.05	41.20	452.80	323.00	-	-
Sh Renu Sug [1]	23.16	23.97	23.15	24.20	23.15	4906.14	35.84	22.86	-	23.95
Sh.T.Balajee	29.96	28.87	30.22	30.71	28.11	183.96	63.55	28.11	-	-
Shadowfax Te	118.43	121.20	118.70	124.00	117.18	1625.66	127.75	98.55	-	-
Shaily Eng	1941.50	1990.20	2028.50	2028.70	1978.50	535.79	2799.90	1372.65	-	-
SHAKTI PUMPS	527.80	526.80	530.10	542.00	525.05	629.64	1047.00	518.70	20	527.00
SHALBY	157.59	155.44	158.40	159.34	154.66	115.35	274.50	151.20	23	155.35
SHALIMAR PAI [2]	56.05	57.08	56.08	58.07	55.96	57.71	118.91	54.10	-	57.10
Shankara Bld	110.43	115.53	110.43	119.72	110.43	452.63	311.50	98.50	5	115.10
Shankara Bui	1029.60	1004.95	1048.80	1050.20	985.45	27.19	1050.20	636.00	-	-
ShantiGoIInt	209.73	208.12	211.39	211.85	207.10	244.06	274.10	184.10	-	-
Sharda Crop	1189.00	1179.00	1192.90	1194.80	1155.60	135.18	1297.80	440.05	21	1172.70
SHARDA MOTOR [2]	957.55	952.35	952.80	971.00	949.05	24.54	1258.00	625.00	17	954.60
ShareInd Sec	130.14	133.72	130.98	136.75	130.98	850.41	219.00	127.50	-	-
ShDigvijCem	71.92	71.30	71.60	71.79	70.60	83.11	107.70	64.99	-	-
Shilchar Tec	3765.40	3874.70	3771.40	3947.40	3771.40	31.69	4350.00	2852.50	-	-
SHILPA MEDIC [1]	327.45	339.75	327.45	344.50	327.45	799.68	501.60	260.00	60	340.50
Shipping Cor	265.32	268.20	266.90	272.40	266.32	3406.37	280.35	138.25	12	268.15
Shipping Cor	45.36	45.09	45.00	45.65	44.55	836.08	60.34	42.85	-	-
Shivalik Bi	459.80	459.50	459.80	469.85	456.00	58.36	605.00	342.00	-	-
Shivalik Ras	273.35	292.50	276.10	294.90	275.00	63.46	744.60	265.65	-	-
SHK	149.79	149.68	152.05	154.40	147.98	289.10	275.20	135.35	91	149.90
SHOPPER STOP [5]	320.15	315.55	320.00	320.00	312.00	76.23	588.50	309.20	-	315.40
Shree Cement	26865.00	26745.00	26865.00	27020.00	26605.00	12.43	32508.20	25389.00	56	26734.15
Shree Rama [5]	55.33	55.39	55.05	57.63	55.05	134.25	71.55	31.07	13	55.44
ShreejiShipp	401.90	399.95	408.00	408.00	398.00	291.19	421.95	222.00	-	-
SHREEPUSHK	314.40	317.55	313.00	321.40	311.50	42.19	476.60	221.10	24	316.70
Shringar Hou	249.12	245.56	250.50	252.20	244.61	569.79	266.50	177.51	-	-
Shriram Fin	1085.90	1104.60	1089.00	1108.00	1085.10	5231.41	1108.00	566.50	-	-
Shriram Pist	3166.20	3146.40	3176.00	3183.10	3125.00	28.74	3407.20	1662.55	-	-
Shriram Prop	78.94	79.95	78.94	80.89	78.45	330.41	105.58	63.13	-	-
ShyamMetalic	861.60	856.35	865.95	866.05	844.50	149.77	1001.00	688.50	-	-
Siemens Ener	2997.80	2920.30	2999.90	3020.60	2875.00	530.90	3625.00	2115.00	-	-
Siemens Ltd. [2]	3350.80	3336.90	3365.00	3373.80	3328.40	153.44	3411.50	2271.44	78	3333.10
Sigachi Ind	20.21	20.17	20.27	20.60	19.97	2919.37	59.59	18.92	-	-
Sigma Advan	166.25	158.69	166.25	167.60	157.94	191.65	231.00	49.06	-	-
Sigma Solve	37.56	38.36	37.00	39.44	37.00	74.75	655.00	37.00	-	-
SignatureGlo	947.55	950.20	945.00	954.00	934.50	253.63	1309.50	775.20	-	-
Silver Tou.	1432.90	1443.40	1439.80	1453.90	1414.00	39.71	1690.20	610.00	-	-
Sirca Paint	459.35	458.25	460.80	470.00	456.10	269.46	539.00	230.69	-	-
SIS [5]	293.15	301.90	292.95	305.35	288.90	135.28	401.20	288.25	14	302.95
Siyaram Silk [2]	535.20	533.85	535.75	542.95	530.55	22.20	849.65	494.05	12	533.60
SJS Enter.	1845.60	1819.60	1850.00	1856.00	1806.70	59.77	1930.00	808.15	-	-
SJVN	75.16	74.06	75.09	75.09	73.75	2560.66	107.50	68.17	32	74.02
SKF Ind(Ind)	2541.30	2452.70	2544.20	2577.40	2399.90	27.81	2766.00	2311.20	-	-
SKF INDIA	1820.20	1791.00	1834.40	1850.00	1775.20	89.70	2395.85	1627.67	25	1794.85
SKIPPER [1]	366.15	368.85	366.55	374.95	366.30	128.94	588.30	327.40	23	368.20
SKM Egg pro [5]	168.40	169.04	168.49	171.18	167.10	102.20	232.35